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Preface

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List of Notations

The following table lists the notation used throughout this report, organized by topic.

Symbol	Meaning
General	
$\mathbb{N}$	Set of all natural numbers i.e. positive integers
$\mathbb{Z}$	Set of all integers
$\mathbb{R}$	Set of real numbers
$\mathbb{C}$	Set of complex numbers
S^1	$\{z \in \mathbb{C} : \lvert z\rvert = 1\}$. The multiplicative group of complex numbers of absolute value 1
ζ_m	A primitive m-th root of unity
Finite Fields	
$\mathbb{F}_q$	Finite field with q elements
$\mathbb{F}_q^*$	Multiplicative group of nonzero elements of $\mathbb{F}_q$
$\mathbb{F}_p$	Prime field with p elements
$(\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)}$	Subgroup of d-th powers in $\mathbb{F}_q^*$
$[E : \mathbb{F}_q]$	Degree of the extension $E/\mathbb{F}_q$
E, F, L, K	Generic notation for finite fields or finite extensions of finite fields
Characters of Finite Abelian Groups	
G	A finite abelian group with identity element 1_G
Z_k	Cyclic multiplicative group of order k
χ_0	Trivial character of G: $\chi_0(g) = 1$ for all $g \in G$
$\overline{\chi}$	Conjugate (and inverse) character of χ: $\overline{\chi}(g) = \overline{\chi(g)}$
$\mathrm{Hom}(A, B)$	Set of all group homomorphisms from A to B
$\widehat{G} = \mathrm{Hom}(G, S^1)$	Dual group of G; the group of all characters of G
$\mathrm{Ann}(\chi)$	Annihilator of character χ: $\{g \in G : \chi(g) = 1\}$, a subgroup of G
$\mathrm{Ann}(H)$	Annihilator of subgroup $H \leq G$: $\{\chi \in \widehat{G} : \chi(h) = 1\ \forall h \in H\}$, a subgroup of $\widehat{G}$
ev_g	Evaluation character of $\widehat{G}$ defined by $\mathrm{ev}_g(\chi) = \chi(g)$
Maps on Finite Fields	
$\mathrm{Tr} : \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{F}_p$	Absolute trace function
$\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$	Trace function from E to $\mathbb{F}_q$

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Symbol	**Meaning**
$\mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$	Norm function from E to $\mathbb{F}_q$
$\sigma : \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{F}_q$	Frobenius automorphism: $\sigma(\alpha) = \alpha^p$
Additive Characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$	
χ, τ	Generic notation for additive characters
χ_1	Canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$: $\chi_1(\alpha) = e^{2\pi i \,\mathrm{Tr}(\alpha)/p}$
χ_β	Additive character defined by $\chi_\beta(\alpha) = \chi_1(\beta\alpha)$, for $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$
$\boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$	Set of all additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$
$\chi^{(r)}$	Additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ lifted to E by $\chi^{(r)} = \chi \circ \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ with $[E : \mathbb{F}_q] = r$
Multiplicative Characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$	
ψ, λ	Generic notation for multiplicative characters
ψ_0	Trivial multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$
ψ_j	Multiplicative character defined by $\psi_j(g^k) = e^{2\pi i jk/(q-1)}$, for $0 \le j \le q-2$
η	Quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ (for odd q): $\eta(\alpha) = 1$ if α is a square in $\mathbb{F}_q^*$, and -1 otherwise
$\boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$	Set of all multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q^*$
$\boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q^{(e)}$	Set of multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ of exponent e
$\mathrm{ord}(\psi)$	Order of ψ: smallest positive integer d with $\psi^d = \psi_0$
$\left(\frac{\alpha}{q}\right)$	Legendre symbol; equals $\eta(\alpha)$ for $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$
$\psi^{(r)}$	Multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ lifted to E by $\psi^{(r)} = \psi \circ \mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ with $[E : \mathbb{F}_q] = r$
Exponential Sums	
$G(\psi, \chi)$	Gaussian sum: $\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha)\,\chi(\alpha)$, for $\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$, $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$
$J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$	Generalized Jacobi sum: $\sum_{\substack{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1+\cdots+\alpha_k=\alpha}} \lambda_1(\alpha_1)\cdots\lambda_k(\alpha_k)$, for $\lambda_i \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$
$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$	Jacobi sum; the special case $\alpha = 1$ of J_α
$J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$	Jacobi sum at 0; the special case $\alpha = 0$ of J_α
Dirichlet L-functions over $\mathbb{F}_q[X]$	
$\zeta(s)$	Riemann-Zeta function for $s \in \mathbb{C}$
$L(s, \chi)$	Dirichlet L-function: $\sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h)\,\mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s}$, for a multiplicative character χ
$\overline{L}(z, \chi)$	Power series associated to $L(s, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h)\, z^{\deg(h)}$, satisfying $\overline{L}(q^{-s}, \chi) = L(s, \chi)$
Φ	Set of all monic polynomials in $\mathbb{F}_q[X]$
$\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)$	Set of irreducible monic polynomials in Φ
L_k	k-th coefficient of $z \frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\, \deg(h) \mid k} \deg(h)\, \chi(h)^{k/\deg(h)}$

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Chapter 2

Some Basics of Finite Fields

Chapter 3

Exponential Sums over Finite Fields

Exponential sums are important tools in number theory for solving problems involving integers. These sums have many applications in Analytic Number Theory.

In this chapter we will set up exponential sums for finite fields by special group homomorphisms called *characters*. Since a finite field has two different inherent group structure; one is additive and the other is multiplicative we obtain two different characters. Exponential sums are formed by using the values of one or more characters and possibly combining them with weights or with other function values.

3.1 Characters of Finite Abelian Groups

Let G be a finite abelian group with the identity element 1_G. Let S^1 be the set of complex numbers with absolute value 1. Then consider the multiplicative group S^1 with the operation of multiplication.

Definition 3.1.1: Character χ of G

A character χ of G is a group homomorphism $\chi : G \longrightarrow S^1$ to the multiplicative group S^1 i.e. for all $g_1, g_2 \in G$

$$\chi(g_1 \cdot g_2) = \chi(g_1) \cdot \chi(g_2)$$

So if χ is any character of G then $\chi(1_G) = 1$. Since by definition for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g)^{|G|} = \chi(g^{|G|}) = \chi(1_G) = 1$$

the values of χ are $|G|^{th}$ roots of unity. Also we have for any $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g)\chi(g^{-1}) = \chi(g \cdot g^{-1}) = \chi(1_G) = 1$$

so $\chi(g^{-1}) = \chi(g)^{-1} = \overline{\chi(g)}$.

There are some special characters of G which have specific name. The character χ_0 defined by $\chi_0(g) = 1$ for all $g \in G$ is called the *trivial character*. For any character χ of G, the character $\overline{\chi}$ defined by $\overline{\chi}(g) = \overline{\chi(g)}$ for all $g \in G$ is called the *conjugate character* of χ.

Given any finitely many characters of G, $\chi_1, \ldots, \chi_n$ we can define the product character $\chi = \chi_1 \cdot \chi_2 \cdots \chi_n$ such that for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g) = \chi_1(g) \cdot \chi_2(g) \cdots \chi_n(g)$$

Hence for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g) \cdot \overline{\chi}(g) = |\chi(g)|^2 = 1$$

Hence the $\overline{\chi}$ is also the inverse character of χ. Hence the set of all characters of G forms a group, $\mathrm{Hom}(G, S^1)$ under multiplication whose identity element is the trivial character χ_0.

Definition 3.1.2: Dual Group to G

For a finite abelian group G, the group of all characters of G with the identity element χ_0 is called the dual group *to G and is denoted by $\widehat{G}$ i.e. $\widehat{G} := \mathrm{Hom}(G, S^1)$.*

Observation 3.1. *The dual group $\widehat{G}$ is a finite abelian group. So we can talk about characters of $\widehat{G}$ too.*

Since the values of characters of G can only be $|G|^{th}$ roots of unity, the dual group $\widehat{G}$ is a finite abelian group.

Lemma 3.1.1 Charaters of Cyclic Group

If G is a finite cyclic group of order n and let g be the generator of G, then for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ define the function

$$\chi_j(g^k) = e^{2\pi i \frac{j \cdot k}{n}} \quad \forall\, k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$$

Then $\widehat{G} = \{\chi_j : j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$.

Proof: Certainly for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ defines a character of G. On the other hand suppose, $\chi \in \widehat{G}$. Then $\chi(g)$ must be an nth root of unity. Hence there exists $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ such that $\chi(g) = e(j/n)$. Therefore $\chi = \chi_j$. Hence $\widehat{G} = \{\chi_j : 0 \le j \le n-1\}$. ■

Observation 3.2. *The characters defined in above lemma forms a cyclic group with χ_1 being the generator of $\widehat{G}$.*

Remark: When $G = (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^*$, the characters of G described by $\chi_j(\alpha) = e^{2\pi i \frac{\alpha \cdot j}{n}}$ like in Lemma 3.1.1 are precisely the classical *Dirichlet characters* modulo n, which are of fundamental importance in analytic number theory.

Corollary 3.1.2 Isomorphism of a Cyclic Group with its Dual

If G is a finite cyclic group of order n with g being the generator then $G \cong \widehat{G}$ by the isomorphism $\varphi : g^j \mapsto \chi_j$ for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$.

Now we will show that we can extend a character of any subgroup to a character of the group.

Theorem 3.1.3 Extending Characters from Subgroup to Group

Let H be a subgroup of the finite abelian group G and let χ_H be a character of H. Then χ_H can be extended to a character of G that is there exists a character $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ with $\chi(h) = \chi_H(h)$ for all $h \in H$.

Proof: Let H be a proper subgroup of G. Let $\alpha \in G \setminus H$. Then let H_1 be the group generated by H and α i.e. $H_1 = \langle H, a \rangle$. Let m be the smallest positive integer such that $\alpha^m \in H$. Then for all $g \in H_1$, g can be written uniquely as $g = \alpha^j \cdot h$ where $0 \le j < m$ and $h \in H$.

Let ω be a complex number such that $\omega^m = \chi_H(\alpha^m)$. Then for all $g \in H_1$ where $g = \alpha^j \cdot h$, $h \in H$ define the function $\chi_1(g) = \omega^j \chi_H(h)$. Then for any $g_1, g_2 \in H_1$ where $g_1 = \alpha^i \cdot h_1$, $g_2 = \alpha^j \cdot h_2$, we have $g_1 \cdot g_2 = \alpha^{j+k} \cdot h_1 \cdot h_2 = \alpha^{j+k \bmod m} \cdot h_1 \cdot h_2$. Hence

$$\chi_1(g_1 \cdot \chi_2) = \omega^{j+k \bmod m} \chi_H(h_1) \cdot \chi_H(h_2) = \alpha^j \chi_H(h_1) \cdot \omega^k \chi_H(h_2) = \chi_1(g_1) \cdot \chi_1(g_2)$$

Hence χ_1 is a character of H_1. And also for all $h \in H$ we have $\chi_1(h) = \chi_H(h)$.

So if $H_1 = G$ we are done. Otherwise we can continue this process above until we get G. This process we have to do finitely many times as G is a finite group. ■

Therefore if we have two distinct elements $g_1, g_2 \in G$, $g_1 \neq g_2$ then take the subgroup generated by the element $h = g_1 \cdot g_2^{-1} \neq 1$. Since this subgroup is a cyclic subgroup generated by h, by Lemma 3.1.1 we get a character χ' of the cyclic subgroup such that $\chi'(h) \neq 1$. Then by Theorem 3.1.3 we get a character χ of G such that $\chi(h) = \chi'(h) \neq 1$ and hence $\chi(g_1) \neq \chi(g_2)$. Therefore we have the following observation

Observation 3.3. *For any two distinct elements $g_1, g_2 \in G$, $g_1 \neq g_2$ we can get a character $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ such that $\chi(g_1) \neq \chi(g_2)$.*

Now consider any character χ of G. If $g \in G$ such that $\chi(g) = 1$ then $\chi(g^{-1}) = 1$. Hence the set of all elements $g \in G$ such that $\chi(g)$ forms a group. This group is called the *annihilator* of χ and is denoted by $\mathrm{Ann}(\chi)$.

Similarly suppose H is a subgroup of G. Then if $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ is a character of G such that $\chi(h) = 1$ for all $h \in H$ then $\overline{\chi}(h) = 1$ for all $h \in H$. Hence the set of all characters $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ such that $\chi(h) = 1$ for all $h \in H$ forms a group. This group is called the *annihilator* of H and is denoted by $\mathrm{Ann}(H)$. Since in both cases the notation Ann is used usually the context will make it clear whether we are talking about the annihilator of a character or the annihilator of a subgroup.

Definition 3.1.3: Annihilator

Let G be a finite abelian group. For any character $\chi \in \widehat{G}$, the annihilator *of χ, $\mathrm{Ann}(\chi) = \{g \in G : \chi(g) = 1\}$ which is a subgroup of G.*

For any subgroup H of G, the annihilator *of H, $\mathrm{Ann}(H) = \{\chi \in \widehat{G} : \chi(h) = 1 \text{ for all } h \in H\}$ which is a subgroup of $\widehat{G}$.*

Now every element of $\widehat{G}$ is a function χ which takes an element of G and maps to a complex number in S^1. Similarly we can think of every element of as a function from $\widehat{G}$ to S^1. In fact for every element $g \in G$ define the homomorphism $\mathrm{ev}_g : \widehat{G} \to S^1$ where $\mathrm{ev}_g(\chi) = \chi(g)$. Hence ev_g is a character of $\widehat{G}$ for all $g \in G$.

Theorem 3.1.4

Let G be a finite abelian group.

(i) If $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ be any nontrivial character then

$$\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0 \tag{3.1}$$

(ii) If $g \in G$ with $g \neq 1_G$ then

$$\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) = 0 \tag{3.2}$$

Proof: Since χ is nontrivial there exists $h \in G$ such that $\chi(h) \neq 1$. Then

$$\chi(h) \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = \sum_{g \in G} \chi(h \cdot g) = \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$$

Hence we have

$$(\chi(h) - 1) \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0$$

Since we know $\chi(h) \neq 1$ we have $\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0$.

Now from the discussion above for any $g \in G$ and $\chi \in hG$ we have $\chi(g) = \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi)$. Hence

$$\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) = \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi)$$

Since $g \neq 1_G$, there is a $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ such that $\chi(g) \neq 1$. Hence ev_g is a nontrivial character of $\widehat{G}$. Hence by the first part of the theorem we have $\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi) = 0$. ■

The above theorem leaves the case when χ is the trivial character. Then for all $g \in G$, $\chi(g) = 1$. Hence we have $\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = |G|$. Hence we have the following corollary

Observation 3.4. *For any finite abelian group G. Then*

(i) Let χ is a character of G.

$$\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = \begin{cases} |G| & \text{if } \chi = \chi_0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{3.3}$$

(ii) $|G| = \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$

So now by counting in two ways for the sum $\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$ we get the following theorem:

Theorem 3.1.5

For any finite abelian group G, we have $|G| = |\widehat{G}|$.

Proof: From Observation 3.4(ii) we have

$$|G| = \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = \sum_{g \in G} \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) = |\widehat{G}|$$

Hence we have the result. ■

From above theorem and Observation 3.4(i) we get the *orthogonality relations for characters.*

Observation 3.5. *Let G be a finite abelian group.*

(i) Let χ, τ are characters of G. Then

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) \cdot \overline{\tau(g)} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } \chi = \tau \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

(ii) If $g, h \in G$ are any two elements then

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) \cdot \overline{\chi(h)} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } g = h \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Since we already showed that for every element $g \in G$, ev_g is a character of $\widehat{G}$. Theorem 3.1.5 gives us the possibility that G and $\widehat{G}$ are isomorphic. In Lemma 3.1.1 we already showed that for cyclic groups G and $\widehat{G}$ are isomorphic. In the next few results we will show that this is the case for all finite abelian groups.

By Fundamental Theory of Finite Abelian Groups every finite abelian group G can be written as a direct product of finitely many cyclic groups. Hence it is enough to show that if G_1 and G_2 are two finite abelian groups and $G = G_1 \times G_2$ then $\widehat{G}$ is isomorphic to the direct product of $\widehat{G}_1$ and $\widehat{G}_2$.

Theorem 3.1.6 Isomorphism of Product of Dual Groups with Dual of Their Product

Let G_1 and G_2 be two finite abelian groups and let $G = G_1 \times G_2$. Then $\widehat{G} \cong \widehat{G}_1 \times \widehat{G}_2$.

Proof: Since G is the direct product of G_1 and G_2, G consists of pairs (g_1, g_2) where $g_1 \in G_1$ and $g_2 \in G_2$. So consider the map $\varphi : \widehat{G}_1 \times \widehat{G}_2 \to \widehat{G}$ where for any $\chi_1 \in \widehat{G}_1$ and $\chi_2 \in \widehat{G}_2$, $\chi := \varphi(\chi_1, \chi_2)$ is the character of G defined by the following:

$$\text{for all } (g_1, g_2) \in G \qquad \chi(g_1, g_2) = \chi(g_1, 1) \cdot \chi(1, g_2) = \chi_1(g_1) \cdot \chi_2(g_2)$$

Hence φ is a homomorphism. Now we will show that φ is an isomorphism.

Let $\chi \in \widehat{G}$. Then define $\chi_1(g_1) := \chi(g_1, 1)$ for all $g_1 \in G_1$ and similarly define $\chi_2(g_2) := \chi(1, g_2)$ for all $g_2 \in G_2$. Then χ_1 is a character of G_1 and χ_2 is a character of G_2. And also for any $(g_1, g_2) \in G$ we have

$$\chi_1(g_1) \cdot \chi_2(g_2) = \chi(g_1, 1) \cdot \chi(1, g_2) = \chi(g_1, g_2)$$

Hence $\varphi(\chi_1, \chi_2) = \chi$. Hence φ is an isomorphism. Therefore $\widehat{G} \cong \widehat{G}_1 \times \widehat{G}_2$. ■

Theorem 3.1.7 Isomorphism of Group with its Dual

For any finite abelian group G, G is isomorphic to $\widehat{G}$.

Proof: By Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups, G can be written as a direct product of finitely many cyclic groups i.e. there exists cyclic groups $Z_{n_1}, Z_{n_2}, \ldots, Z_{n_k}$ such that

$$G \cong Z_{n_1} \times Z_{n_2} \times \cdots \times Z_{n_k}$$

Hence by repeated use of Theorem 3.1.6 we have $\widehat{G} \cong \widehat{Z}_{n_1} \times \widehat{Z}_{n_2} \times \cdots \times \widehat{Z}_{n_k}$. Since by Lemma 3.1.1 for all $i \in \{1, 2, \ldots, k\}$, $\widehat{Z}_{n_i} \cong Z_{n_i}$ we have $\widehat{G} \cong Z_{n_1} \times Z_{n_2} \times \cdots \times Z_{n_k} \cong G$ Hence we have the result. ■

3.2 Characters of Finite Fields

In a finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$ there are two inherent group structures–namely, the additive group and the multiplicatve group. The nonzero elements of $\mathbb{F}_q$ forms a cyclic group of $q-1$ elements under multiplication and the whole $\mathbb{F}_q$ forms a group of q elements under addition.

3.2.1 Additive Characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$

We first turn to the additive group of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Characters of the additive group $\mathbb{F}_q$ are called *additive characters* of $\mathbb{F}_q$. We denote the set of all additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ by $\boldsymbol{\chi}_q$.

Suppose p be the characteristic of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then the prime field contained in $\mathbb{F}_q$ is $\mathbb{F}_p$. Let $\mathrm{Tr} : \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{F}_p$ be the absolute *trace function* from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_p$. Then define the function χ_1 by

$$\chi_1(\alpha) = e^{2\pi i \frac{\mathrm{Tr}(\alpha)}{p}} \quad \forall\, \alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$$

Then χ_1 is an additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ since for all $\alpha_1, \alpha_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $\mathrm{Tr}(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) = \mathrm{Tr}(\alpha_1) + \mathrm{Tr}(\alpha_2)$ and hence $\chi_1(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) = \chi_1(\alpha_1) \cdot \chi_1(\alpha_2)$. This character χ_1 is called the *canonical additive character* of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Theorem 3.2.1 Structure of Additive Characters

For $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$, define the function χ_β with $\chi_\beta(\alpha) = \chi_1(\beta \cdot \alpha)$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Then χ_β is an additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and every additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ is obtained this way i.e. for all $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$, there exists $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we

have $\chi(\alpha) = \chi_\beta(\alpha)$.

Proof: Now for any $\alpha_1, \alpha_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q$, we have

$$\chi_\beta(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) = \chi_1(\beta(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2)) = \chi_1(\beta \cdot \alpha_1) \cdot \chi_1(\beta \cdot \alpha_2) = \chi_\beta(\alpha_1) \cdot \chi_\beta(\alpha_2)$$

Hence χ_β is an additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Now we will show that for any two distinct $\beta_1, \beta_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $\beta_1 \neq \beta_2$ there exists an $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\chi_{\beta_1}(\alpha) \neq \chi_{\beta_2}(\alpha)$. Suppose that is not the case. Then for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$,

$$\chi_{\beta_2}(\alpha) = \chi_{\beta_2}(\alpha) \iff \chi_1(\beta_1 \cdot \alpha) = \chi_1(\beta_2 \cdot \alpha) \iff \chi_1((\beta_1 - \beta_2)\alpha) = 1.$$

Now $\chi_1((\beta_1 - \beta_2)\alpha) = 1$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ if and only if $\mathrm{Tr}((\beta_1 - \beta_2)\alpha) = 0$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Since $\mathrm{Tr}(X) = X + X^p + \cdots + X^{p^{r-1}}$ where $q = p^r$. Since Tr is $\mathbb{F}_p$–linear, $\mathrm{Tr}((\beta_1 - \beta_2)X)$ has p^r roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$ which is more than the degree p^{r-1}. Hence $\mathrm{Tr}((\beta_1 - \beta_2)X)$ is the zero polynomial. Therefore $\beta_1 = \beta_2$. So for any two distinct $\beta_1, \beta_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $\beta_1 \neq \beta_2$ there exists an $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\chi_{\beta_1}(\alpha) \neq \chi_{\beta_2}(\alpha)$.

Hence for every $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we have a distinct additive character. Therefore we have q additive characters. Since there are q additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ by Theorem 3.1.5 every additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ can be obtained the above way. ■

The orthogonality relations in Observation 3.5 when applied to additive characters and along with Theorem 3.2.1 gives the following result.

Theorem 3.2.2 Orthogonality of Additive Characters

(i) For any $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$, the corresponding additive character is χ_a. Then

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_a(\gamma) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } a \neq 0 \\ q & \text{if } a = 0 \end{cases}$$

(ii) For any two additive characters χ_a, χ_b where $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$,

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_a(\gamma) \cdot \overline{\chi_b}(\gamma) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } a \neq b \\ q & \text{if } a = b \end{cases}$$

(iii) For any two elements $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$,

$$\sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_c(\alpha) \cdot \overline{\chi_c(\beta)} = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \alpha \neq \beta \\ q & \text{if } \alpha = \beta \end{cases}$$

3.2.2 Multiplicative Characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$

Characters of the multiplicate group $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ are called *multiplicative characters* of $\mathbb{F}_q$. We denote the set of all multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ by $\boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$. Since $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ is a cyclic group of order $q-1$ by Lemma 3.1.1 we have the following:

Lemma 3.2.3 Structure of Multiplicative Characters

The group of multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ is a cycic group of order $q-1$ and are given by $\{\psi_j : 0 \leq j \leq q-2\}$ where if g is the generator of $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ then for all $k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, q-2\}$ we have $\psi_j(g^k) = e^{2\pi i \frac{jk}{q-1}}$ where ψ_0 is the identity element

of the group and the trivial character.

Every multiplicative character ψ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ has the property that $\psi^{q-1} = \psi_0$. Let ψ is generator of the cyclic group of multiplicative characters. Then ψ is called the *principal character*. For any multiplicative character ψ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ we say ψ is of *order* d if $\psi^d = \psi_0$ and d is the smallest positive integer with this property. We use $\operatorname{ord}(\psi)$ to denote the order of ψ. Hence $d \mid q-1$. We say ψ is of *exponent* e is $\psi^e = \psi_0$. Clearly $d \mid e$ where d is the order of ψ. Let $\mathcal{M}_q^{(e)}$ denote the set of all multiplicative characters of $\mathcal{M}_q$ of exponent e.

Remark: For odd q a special multiplicative character of interest is the *quadratic character*. It is denoted by η. It only takes the value ± 1. So $\operatorname{ord}\eta = 2$. For all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, $\eta(\alpha) = 1$ if α is a *quadratic residue* and -1 if α is a non-quadratic residue. Therefore for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$, we have $\eta(\alpha) = \alpha^{(q-1)/2}$. The *Legendre symbol* $\left(\frac{\alpha}{q}\right)$ for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ is defined by $\eta(\alpha) = \left(\frac{\alpha}{q}\right)$

For any multiplicative character ψ of $\mathbb{F}_q$, the value of $\psi(-1)$ is of special interest. We obviously have $\psi(-1) = \pm 1$. Let $\operatorname{ord}(\psi) = m$. Then $m \mid q-1$. Hence values of ψ are m^{th} roots of unity. Therefore $\psi(-1)$ can be -1 if m is even. Let g be a primitive element of $\mathbb{F}_q$ i.e. $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ is generated by g. Hence $\psi(g) = \zeta_m$ where ζ_m is the mth root of unity. If m is even

$$\psi(-1) = \psi\left(g^{(q-1)/2}\right) = \zeta_m^{(q-1)/2}$$

Now

$$\zeta_m^{(q-1)/2} = -1 \iff \frac{q-1}{2} \equiv \frac{m}{2} \bmod m \iff \frac{q-1}{m} \equiv 1 \bmod 2$$

So m should be even and $\frac{q-1}{m}$ should be odd. Therefore we have the following two observations.

Observation 3.6. *For any multiplicative character $\psi \in \mathcal{M}_q$, $\psi(-1) = -1$ if and only if $\frac{q-1}{m}$ is odd and m is even.*

Observation 3.7. *If $\psi \in \mathcal{M}_q$ is the principle multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ then $\psi(-1) = -1$.*

Suppose $d \mid q-1$. Then for every multiplicative character ψ of exponent d and for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, we have $\psi(\alpha^d) = \psi^d(\alpha) = 1$. Hence $\psi(\alpha) = 1$ if $\alpha \in (\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)}$. Conversely if $\psi(\alpha) = 1$ for every $\alpha \in (\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)}$ then $\psi^d = \psi_0$. Hence ψ is a character of exponent d then $\psi(\alpha)$ depends only on the cosets of $\mathbb{F}_q^* / (\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)}$. Therefore there are precisely d such characters of exponent d.

Theorem 3.2.4 Character Sum over dth-Power Characters

Suppose $d \mid q-1$. Then

$$\sum_{\psi \in \mathcal{M}_q^{(d)}} \chi(\alpha) = \begin{cases} d & \text{if } \alpha \in (\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)} \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Proof: The characters of exponent d are characters of the group $\mathbb{F}_q^* / (\mathbb{F}_q^*)^{(d)}$. Hence this follows from Observation 3.4. ■

Again, the orthogonality relations in Observation 3.5 when applied to multiplicative characters gives the following:

Theorem 3.2.5 Orthogonality of Multiplicative Characters

(i) For any multiplicative character ψ of $\mathbb{F}_q$

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \psi \neq \psi_0 \\ q-1 & \text{if } \psi = \psi_0 \end{cases}$$

(ii) For any two multiplicative characters ψ and λ of $\mathbb{F}_q$,

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha) \cdot \overline{\lambda(\alpha)} = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \psi \neq \lambda \\ q-1 & \text{if } \psi = \lambda \end{cases}$$

(iii) For any two elements $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$,

$$\sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \psi(\alpha) \cdot \overline{\psi(\beta)} = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \alpha \neq \beta \\ q-1 & \text{if } \alpha = \beta \end{cases}$$

Therefore the multiplicative characters form an orthonormal basis on all complex valued functions from $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ to $\mathbb{C}$. So we have the observation

Observation 3.8. *obs:mult-char-fourier-basis The set of multiplicative characters $\boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ forms an orthonormal basis for the vector space W of all complex valued functions $\varphi\colon \mathbb{F}_q^* \to \mathbb{C}$.*

Usually we extend the definition of multiplicative characters to the whole $\mathbb{F}_q$ so that we can define special character sums over the whole field. Let ψ is a multiplicative character then $\psi(0)$ is defined to be 0 if ψ is nontrivial multiplicative character and $\psi(0) = 1$ if ψ is the trivial character.

3.2.3 Lifting of Characters to Finite Extension

Let E be a finite extension field of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let χ_1 and μ_1 be the canonical additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and E respectively. Let $\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ be the trace function from E to $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Then χ_1 and μ_1 are related by the identity

$$\chi_1(Tr_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha)) = \mu_1(\alpha) \quad \forall\, \alpha \in E$$

Since the trace function satisfies transitivity property we have $\mathrm{Tr}_E = \mathrm{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q} \circ \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$. Hence for all $\alpha \in E$, $\mu_1(\alpha) = \chi_1(\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha))$.

Similarly if ψ_1 and λ_1 are principle multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and E respectively then,

$$\lambda_1(\alpha) = \psi_1(\mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha)) \quad \forall\, \alpha \in E^*$$

where $\mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ is the *norm function* from E to $\mathbb{F}_q$.

In the opposite way for any additive character χ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ or multiplicative character ψ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ we can lift the characters to an additive and multiplicative character of E respectively by taking $\chi \circ \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ and $\psi \circ \mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ respectively. We denote these by $\chi^{(r)} := \chi \circ \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ and $\psi^{(r)} := \psi \circ \mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}$ where $r = [E : \mathbb{F}_q]$.

In the following sections we will be working with hybrid character sums which are formed by taking product of multiple characters of both kind. Hence we will be using χ, τ to denote additive characters and ψ, λ to denote multiplicative characters.

3.3 Gaussian Sums

Having studied additive and multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ separately, we now turn to hybrid sums that interleave both types. The first and most fundamental such object is the *Gaussian sum.* A Gaussian sum is formed by taking the product of a multiplicative character and an additive character and summing over all nonzero elements of $\mathbb{F}_q$. The interplay between the two kinds of characters gives remarkable algebraic and analytic properties, and they will serve as the key tool throughout this chapter. We define them as follows.

Definition 3.3.1: Gaussian Sum

Let ψ be a multiplicative character and χ be an additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then the Gaussian Sum *associated to ψ and χ is defined as*

$$G(\psi, \chi) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha) \cdot \chi(\alpha)$$

Hence the absolute value of the Gaussian sum is at most $q-1$. But later we will see that the Gaussian sum in most cases is much smaller, $\sqrt{q}$ to be precise.

Theorem 3.3.1 Evaluation of Gaussian Sums

Let ψ be a multiplicative character and χ be an additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$G(\psi, \chi) = \begin{cases} q-1 & \text{if } \psi = \psi_0, \chi = \chi_0 \\ -1 & \text{if } \psi = \psi_0, \chi \neq \chi_0 \\ 0 & \text{if } \psi \neq \psi_0, \chi = \chi_0 \end{cases} \tag{3.4}$$

If ψ is non-trivial multiplicative character and χ is non-trivial additive character then $|G(\psi, \chi)| = \sqrt{q}$.

Proof: If $\psi = \psi_0$ and $\chi = \chi_0$ then for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have $\psi(\alpha) = 1$ and $\chi(\alpha) = 1$. Hence $G(\psi_0, \chi_0) = q-1$.

Now suppose $\psi = \psi_0$ and χ is non-trivial additive character. Then by Theorem 3.2.2(i)

$$G(\psi_0, \chi) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha) - \chi(0) = -1$$

Let ψ be a non-trivial multiplicative character and $\chi = \chi_0$. Then for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have $\chi(\alpha) = 1$. Hence by Theorem 3.2.5(i)

$$G(\psi, \chi_0) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha) = 0$$

So now assume both ψ and χ are non-trivial multiplicative and additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ respectively. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}
|G(\psi, \chi)|^2 &= \overline{G(\psi, \chi)} \cdot G(\psi, \chi) \\
&= \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\psi(\alpha)} \cdot \overline{\chi(\alpha)} \right) \cdot \left(\sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\beta) \cdot \chi(\beta) \right) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\psi(\alpha)} \cdot \overline{\chi(\alpha)} \cdot \psi(\beta) \cdot \chi(\beta) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\beta \cdot \alpha^{-1}) \cdot \chi(\beta - \alpha) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma) \cdot \chi(\alpha(\gamma - 1)) && [\text{Take } \gamma = \beta \cdot \alpha^{-1}] \\
&= \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma) \cdot \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(\alpha(\gamma - 1)) \right) \\
&= \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma) \cdot \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha(\gamma - 1)) \right) - \chi(0) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma) \\
&= \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma) \cdot \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha(\gamma - 1)) \right) && [\text{By } \textit{Theorem } 3.2.5(i)]
\end{aligned}$$

Hence by Theorem 3.2.2(i)

$$\sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha(\gamma-1)) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \gamma \neq 1 \\ q & \text{if } \gamma = 1 \end{cases}$$

Therefore $|G(\psi,\chi)|^2 = \psi(1)q = q$ and so we have the required result. ■

Now under various transformations of the additive or multiplicative characters Gaussian sums gives some useful identities. We will see some of these below.

Lemma 3.3.2 Gaussian Sum Identities

Gaussian sums for the finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$ satisfy the following identities. For any $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$ let χ_a be the additive character defined as in Theorem 3.2.1. Let $\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ be any multiplicative character and $\chi \in \boldsymbol{X}_q$ be any additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then we have the following identities

(i) $G(\psi,\chi_{ab}) = \overline{\psi(a)} \cdot G(\psi,\chi_b)$ *for any* $a \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ *and* $b \in \mathbb{F}_q$.

(ii) $G(\psi,\overline{\chi}) = \psi(-1) \cdot G(\psi,\chi)$.

(iii) $G(\overline{\psi},\chi) = \psi(-1)\overline{G(\psi,\chi)}$.

(iv) $G(\psi,\chi) \cdot G(\overline{\psi},\chi) = \psi(-1)q$ *if* ψ *and* χ *are non-trivial multiplicative and additive characters of* $\mathbb{F}_q$ *respectively.*

(v) $G(\psi^p,\chi_b) = G(\psi,\chi_{\sigma(b)})$ *for any* $b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ *where* $p = \mathrm{char}(\mathbb{F}_q)$ *and* $\sigma(X) = X^p$ *be the Frobenius map of* $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Proof:

(i) For any $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we have $\chi_{ab}(\gamma) = \chi_1(ab\cdot\gamma) = \chi_b(a\cdot\gamma)$. Hence

$$G(\psi,\chi_{ab}) = \sum_{\gamma\in\mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma)\cdot\chi_{ab}(\gamma) = \sum_{\gamma\in\mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\gamma)\cdot\chi_b(a\cdot\gamma)$$

Now take $d = a\cdot\gamma$. Then $\gamma = a^{-1}\cdot d$. Hence

$$G(\psi,\chi_{ab}) = \sum_{d\in\mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(a^{-1}\cdot d)\cdot\chi_b(d) = \psi(a^{-1}) \sum_{d\in\mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(d)\cdot\chi_b(d) = \overline{\psi(a)}\cdot G(\psi,\chi_b)$$

Hence we have the first identity.

(ii) Now we have $\chi = \chi_b$ for some suitable $b \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Therefore $\overline{\chi} = \chi_{(-1)\cdot b}$. So by the first identity we have $G(\psi,\overline{\chi}) = \overline{\psi(-1)}\cdot G(\psi,\chi_b) = \psi(-1)\cdot G(\psi,\chi)$. The last equality holds because $\psi(-1) = \pm 1$.

(iii) Now again we have $\overline{\chi} = \chi_b$ for some suitable $b \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Hence $\chi = \chi_{(-1)\cdot b}$. Again by using the first identity we have

$$G(\overline{\psi},\chi) = G\left(\overline{\psi},\chi_{(-1)\cdot b}\right) = \overline{\psi(-1)}\cdot G(\overline{\psi},\chi_b) = \psi(-1)\cdot G(\overline{\psi},\overline{\chi})$$

Now from the definition of Gaussian sums we have $G(\overline{\psi},\overline{\chi}) = \overline{G(\psi,\chi)}$. Hence we have the required identity.

(iv) Using part (ii) and (iii) we have

$$G(\psi,\chi)\cdot G(\overline{\psi},\chi) = G(\psi,\chi)\cdot\psi(-1)\overline{G(\psi,\chi)} = \psi(-1)\cdot|G(\psi,\chi)|^2$$

Since ψ and χ are non-trivial multiplicative and additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ respectively by Theorem 3.3.1 we have $|G(\psi,\chi)|^2 = q$. Hence we have the required identity.

(v) If Tr is the absolute trace function from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_p$ then for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we have $\mathrm{Tr}(\alpha) = \mathrm{Tr}(\alpha^p)$. Hence $\chi_1(\alpha) = \chi_1(\alpha^p)$. Hence for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$, we get $\chi_b(\alpha) = \chi_1(b \cdot \alpha) = \chi_1(b^p \cdot \alpha^p) = \chi_{\sigma(b)}(\alpha^p)$. Therefore

$$G(\psi^p, \chi_b) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi^p(\alpha) \cdot \chi_b(\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha^p)\chi_{\sigma(b)}(\alpha^p) = G(\psi, \chi_{\sigma(b)})$$

Therefore we have the required result.

■

Now we can use Gaussian Sums in a variety of context. For any multiplicative character ψ we can express the value of ψ at any nonzero $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ using Gaussian sums and additive characters. And similarly for any additive character χ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ we can express the value of χ at any nonzero $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ using Gaussian sums and multiplicative characters.

Now by Theorem 3.2.2(iii) for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\psi(\alpha) &= \frac{1}{q} \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\beta) \sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_c(\alpha)\overline{\chi_c(\beta)} \\
&= \frac{1}{q} \sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_c(\alpha) \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\beta) \cdot \overline{\chi}_c(\beta) \\
&= \frac{1}{q} \sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_c(\alpha) \cdot G(\psi, \overline{\chi}_c) \\
&= \frac{1}{q} \sum_{\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q} G(\psi, \overline{\chi})\chi(\alpha)
\end{aligned}$$

This may be thought of as the *Fourier expansion* of ψ in terms of the additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$, with Gaussian sums appearing as Fourier coefficients.

We can do similar thing for multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. By using Theorem 3.2.5(iii) we get

$$\chi(\alpha) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q} G(\overline{\psi}, \chi)\chi(\alpha)$$

This can be interpreted as the Fourier expansion of the multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with the Gaussian sums as Fourier coefficients. Hence we have the observations:

Observation 3.9. *For any multiplicative character ψ and additive character χ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have*

(i) $\psi(\alpha) = \frac{1}{q} \sum_{\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q} G(\psi, \overline{\chi})\chi(\alpha)$

(ii) $\chi(\alpha) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q} G(\overline{\psi}, \chi)\psi(\alpha)$

We now a another special formula for Gaussian sums for 2-degree extension of finite fields and it has a lot of application. But this has a restriction on the underlying field.

Theorem 3.3.3 Stickelberger's Theorem

Let q be a prime power and $\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ be a non-trivial multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$ of order m such that $m \mid q-1$. Let χ_1 be the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$. Then

$$G(\psi, \chi_1) = \begin{cases} q & \text{if } m \text{ is odd or } \frac{q+1}{m} \text{ is even} \\ -q & \text{if } m \text{ is even and } \frac{q+1}{m} \text{ is odd} \end{cases}$$

Proof: For brevity of notations we write $E = \mathbb{F}_{q^2}$. Let γ be a primitive element of E. So set $g = \gamma^{q+1}$. Therefore $g^{q-1} = 1$ and so we get g as primitive element of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Therefore for all $\alpha \in E^*$ there exists unique $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, q-1$ and $k \in \{0, \ldots, q+1\}$ such that $\alpha = g^j \cdot \gamma^k$. Hence $\psi(g) = \psi^{q+1}(\gamma) = 1$ as $\mathrm{ord}(\psi) = m \mid q+1$. Therefore we have

$$\begin{aligned} G(\psi, \chi_1) &= \sum_{j=0}^{q-2} \sum_{k=0}^{q} \psi(g^j \cdot \gamma^k) \cdot \chi_1(g^j \cdot \gamma^k) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{q} \psi^k(\gamma) \sum_{j=0}^{q-2} \chi_1(g^j \cdot \chi^k) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{q} \psi^k(\gamma) \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi_1(\alpha \cdot \chi^k) \end{aligned}$$

Let τ_1 is the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ then for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ and $k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, q\}$ we get

$$\chi_1(\alpha \cdot \gamma^k) = \tau_1\left(\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha \cdot \gamma^k)\right) = \tau_1\left(\alpha \cdot \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k)\right)$$

Hence we get

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi_1(\alpha \cdot \chi^k) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \tau_1\left(\alpha \cdot \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k)\right) = \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if } \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k) \neq 0 \\ q-1 & \text{if } \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k) = 0 \end{cases}$$

Now since $[E : \mathbb{F}_q] = 2$ we have $\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k) = \gamma^k + \gamma^{k \cdot q}$. Therefore

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma^k) = 0 \iff \gamma^k = -\gamma^{k \cdot q} \iff \gamma^{k(q-1)} = -1$$

So if q is odd then $\gamma^{k(q-1)} = -1 \iff k = \frac{q+1}{2}$ and therefore we have

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi_1(\alpha \cdot \chi^k) = \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if } k \neq \frac{q+1}{2} \\ q-1 & \text{if } k = \frac{q+1}{2} \end{cases}$$

And by using Theorem 3.2.2

$$G(\psi, \chi_1) = q \cdot \psi^{q+1/2}(\gamma) - \sum_{k=0}^{q} \psi^k(\gamma) = q \cdot \psi^{(q+1)/2}$$

Recall that ψ has order m and $m \mid q+1$. Therefore $\psi^{(q+1)/2}(\gamma) = \pm 1$. Now if $\frac{q+1}{m}$ is even then we can rewrite

$$\psi^{(q+1)/2}(\gamma) = (\psi^m(\gamma))^{(q+1)/2m} = 1$$

So suppose $\frac{q+1}{m}$ is odd, say $\frac{q+1}{m} = 2\ell + 1$ for some $\ell \geq 0$. Since q is odd, $q+1$ is even, and as $(q+1)/m$ is odd the factor of 2 in $q+1$ must lie entirely in m; in particular m is even. Writing $\frac{q+1}{2} = m\ell + \frac{m}{2}$, we get

$$\psi^{(q+1)/2}(\gamma) = (\psi^m(\gamma))^{\ell} \cdot \psi^{m/2}(\gamma) = \psi^{m/2}(\gamma).$$

Now $\psi^{m/2}(\gamma)$ is a square root of unity since order of $\psi = m$ and γ is primitive element of E we have $\psi^{(q+1)/2}(\gamma) = -1$. Therefore $G(\psi, \chi_1) = (-1)^{(q+1)/m} \cdot q$. So we have the theorem. ■

We can give a relation between Gaussian sums a multiplicative and additive character and Gaussian sum of lifted characters. To build that relation we need the theory of L-functions in section 3.5. Later we proved the Davenport-Hasse Theorem which gives this relation.

Before going into this in the next section we will define another hybrid sum called *Jacobi Sums*. Like Gaussian sum this also has many important applications. In the later sections we will use both Gaussian sums and Jacobi Sums to prove many interesting results

3.4 Jacobi Sums

Jacobi sums form another class of exponential sums which are of great importance in algebraic number theory. Jacobi sums are defined on product of many multiplicative characters.

Let $\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ is a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. So we extend the definition of ψ following subsection 3.2.2 by setting $\psi(0) = 1$ if ψ is the trivial character and $\psi(0) = 0$ if ψ is a non-trivial character. From now on by default we will always use this extended definition of multiplicative characters.

So now let $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ be k multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ be fixed. Then define the sum

$$J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1+\cdots+\alpha_k=\alpha}} \lambda_1(\alpha_1) \cdot \lambda_2(\alpha_2) \cdots \lambda_k(\alpha_k)$$

Thus in the above sum there are q^{k-1} terms. Now if $\alpha \neq 0$ then define $\beta_i = \alpha^{-1} \cdot \alpha_i$. Then $\beta_1 + \cdots + \beta_k = 1$ and the above summations gives us

$$\begin{aligned} J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) &= \sum_{\substack{\beta_1,\ldots,\beta_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \beta_1+\cdots+\beta_k=1}} \lambda_1(\alpha \cdot \beta_1) \cdots \lambda_k(\alpha \cdot \beta_2) \\ &= (\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k)(\alpha) \sum_{\substack{\beta_1,\ldots,\beta_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \beta_1+\cdots+\beta_k=1}} \lambda_1(\beta_1) \cdots \lambda_k(\beta_2) \\ &= (\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k)(\alpha) \cdot J_1(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \end{aligned}$$

Because of this relation it is enough to consider only the sums $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ and $J_1(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$. The second sum is called the *Jacobi sum* and it has more important applications and so we use a slightly simpler notation.

Definition 3.4.1: Jacobi Sum

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then the Jacobi sum is defined by

$$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1+\cdots+\alpha_k=1}} \lambda_1(\alpha_1) \cdots \lambda_k(\alpha_k)$$

Now we want to find the value of $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ and $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$. If $k = 1$ then $J(\lambda) = \lambda(1) = 1$ for any $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ of $\mathbb{F}_q$. And $J_0(\lambda) = 0$ if λ is non-trivial and its 1 if λ is trivial multiplicative character. Therefore, Jacobi sums are only of interest when $k \geq 2$. Now first we have the following observation

Observation 3.10. *By the definition of the Jacobi sums $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ and $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ are independent of the order in which the characters λ_i are listed.*

3.4.1 Evaluating Jacobi Sums

We begin with the degenerate cases where at least one character is trivial, then build up to the general absolute-value formula via the key connection to Gaussian sums.

Lemma 3.4.1 Jacobi Sums with Trivial Characters

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ are multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

(i) If $\lambda_1 = \cdots = \lambda_k = \psi_0$ where ψ_0 is the trivial multiplicative character then

$$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = q^{k-1}$$

(ii) If some but not all λ_i's are trivial then

$$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = 0$$

Proof:

(i) Since all λ_i's are trivial for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $\lambda(\alpha) = 1$. Hence each term of both the Jacobi sums give 1. Now the sum is over q^{k-1} choices of $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k) \in \mathbb{F}_q^k$. Hence $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = q^{k-1}$.

(ii) WLOG suppose $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_t$ are non-trivial multiplicative characters where $1 \leq t < k$ and $\lambda_{t+1}, \ldots, \lambda_k$ are all trivial. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) &= \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_k = 1}} \lambda_1(\alpha_1) \cdots \lambda_k(\alpha_k) \\ &= \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_k = 1}} \lambda_1(\alpha_1) \cdots \lambda_t(\alpha_t) \end{aligned}$$

Now for any fixed $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_t \in \mathbb{F}_q$ there are q^{k-t-1} solutions of $(\alpha_{t+1}, \ldots, \alpha_k)$ such that $\alpha_{t+1} + \cdots + \alpha_k = 1 - (\alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_t)$. Therefore we get

$$\begin{aligned} J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) &= q^{k-h-1} \sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_t \in \mathbb{F}_q} \lambda_1(\alpha_1) \cdots \lambda_t(\alpha_t) \\ &= q^{k-h-1} \prod_{i=1}^{t} \left(\sum_{\alpha_i \in \mathbb{F}_q} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \right) \\ &= 0 && \text{[By } \textit{Theorem } 3.2.5(i)\text{]} \end{aligned}$$

With a very similar argument for $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ we get the identity.

■

Before going to the case where all λ_i's are non-trivial we will show that a relation between $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ and $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$. This will show that studying $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ suffices to study all kinds of Jacobi sums.

Lemma 3.4.2 Relation between J_0 and J

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \mathcal{M}_q$ are multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with λ_k is non-trivial. Then

$$J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i \text{ is non-trivial} \\ \lambda_k(-1) \cdot (q-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1}) & \text{if } \prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i \text{ is trivial} \end{cases}$$

Proof: For $k = 1$, we already showed $J_0(\lambda_1) = \lambda_1(0) = 0$ as λ_1 is non-trivial by hypothesis. So suppose $k \geq 2$. Then we

have

$$\begin{aligned}
J_0(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k) &= \sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q} J_{-\alpha}(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})\cdot\lambda_k(\alpha)\\
&= \sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q}\left(\prod_{i=1}^{k-1}\lambda_i\right)(-\alpha)\cdot J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})\cdot\lambda_k(\alpha)\\
&= J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})\sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q}\left(\prod_{i=1}^{k-1}\lambda_i\right)(-\alpha)\cdot\lambda_k(\alpha)\\
&= \left(\prod_{i=1}^{k-1}\lambda_i\right)(-1)\cdot J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})\sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q}\left(\prod_{i=1}^{k}\lambda_i\right)(\alpha)
\end{aligned}$$

Now by Theorem 3.2.5(i) if $\prod_{i=1}^{k}\lambda_i$ is nontrivial then the sum 0, so the first case is shown and if $\prod_{i=1}^{k}\lambda_i$ is trivial then the last sum is $q-1$. Now since $\prod_{i=1}^{k}\lambda_i$ is trivial $\prod_{i=1}^{k-1}\lambda_i = \overline{\lambda_k}(-1) = \lambda_k(-1)$. So we have

$$J_0(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k) = \lambda_k(-1)\cdot(q-1)\cdot J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})$$

Hence we have the lemma. ■

Hence the only case for $J_0(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k)$ for which we still don't know the absolute value is the case when all λ_i's are non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^{k}\lambda_i$ is trivial. Since we understand Gaussian sums very well we will first build an important connection between Jacobi sums and Gaussian sums that will allow us to calculate the absolute value of Jacobi sums.

Theorem 3.4.3 Jacobi–Gaussian Sum Relation

Let $\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ are non-trivial multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ is a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

(i) If $\prod_{i=1}^{k}$ is non-trivial then

$$J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k) = \frac{G(\lambda_1,\chi)\cdot G(\lambda_2,\chi)\cdots G(\lambda_k,\chi)}{G(\lambda_1\cdots\lambda_k,\chi)}$$

(ii) If $\prod_{i=1}^{k}$ is trivial then

$$\begin{aligned}
J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k) &= -\lambda_k(-1)\cdot J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_{k-1})\\
&= -\frac{1}{q}\prod_{i=1}^{k} G(\lambda_i,\chi)
\end{aligned}$$

Proof: Since each λ_i's are non-trivial we have $\lambda_i(0) = 0$. By definition of

$$G(\lambda_i,\chi) = \sum_{\alpha_i\in\mathbb{F}_q^*}\lambda_i\alpha\cdot\chi(\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha_i\in\mathbb{F}_q}\lambda_i\alpha\cdot\chi(\alpha)$$

So now we will try to express the product of Gaussian sums as product of a Jacobi and a Gaussian sum.

$$\begin{aligned}
G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_k, \chi) &= \prod_{i=1}^{k} \left(\sum_{\alpha_i \in \mathbb{F}_q} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \cdot \chi(\alpha_i) \right) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \right) \cdot \chi \left(\sum_{i=1}^{k} \alpha_i \right) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha) \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_k = \alpha}} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \right) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha) \cdot J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \qquad (3.5)
\end{aligned}$$

Now if $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial then by Lemma 3.4.2 we get $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = 0$. Now since for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have $J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = \left(\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i \right)(\alpha) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$. Therefore we have

$$\prod_{i=1}^{k} G(\lambda_i, \chi) = J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i \right)(\alpha) \cdot \chi(\alpha) = J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \cdot G\left(\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i, \chi \right)$$

Since χ is non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial we have $G(\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k, \chi) \neq 0$ by Theorem 3.3.1. So we have the first result.

Now if $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is trivial, then for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have $J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$. Hence rewriting the equation in (3.5) we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\prod_{i=1}^{k} G(\lambda_i, \chi) &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha) \cdot J_\alpha(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \\
&= J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) + J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(\alpha) \\
&= J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) + (q-1) J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) && [\text{By } \textit{Theorem } 3.2.2(i)] \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k \in \mathbb{F}_q} \prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \\
&= \prod_{i=1}^{k} \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \lambda_i(\alpha_i) \right) = 0 && [\text{By } \textit{Theorem } 3.2.5(i)]
\end{aligned}$$

Since λ_k is non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is trivial using Lemma 3.4.2 we have

$$\lambda_k(-1) \cdot (q-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1}) + (q-1) J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = 0 \iff J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = -\lambda_k(-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1})$$

So we already got the first expression for the second case. Since $\prod_{i=1}^{k-1} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial by induction hypothesis we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\lambda_k(-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1}) &= \lambda_k(-1) \frac{G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_{k-1}, \chi)}{G(\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_{k-1}, \chi)} \\
&= \lambda_k(-1) \frac{G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_k, \chi)}{G(\overline{\lambda_k}, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda_k, \chi)} && [\text{Since } \lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k \text{ trivial, } \lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_{k-1} = \overline{\lambda_k}] \\
&= \lambda_k(-1) \frac{G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_k, \chi)}{\lambda_k(-1) q} && [\text{By } \textit{Lemma } 3.3.2(iv)] \\
&= \frac{1}{q} \cdot G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_k, \chi)
\end{aligned}$$

Hence we obtain the second expression. Therefore we have the theorem. ■

Now we have all the results to calculate the absolute value of the Jacobi sum for non-trivial multiplicative characters. So we have the following theorem.

Theorem 3.4.4 Absolute Value of Non-trivial Jacobi Sums

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be non-trivial multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = \begin{cases} q^{(k-1)/2} & \text{If } \prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i \text{ is non-trivial} \\ q^{(k-2)/2} & \text{If } \prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i \text{ is trivial} \end{cases}$$

Proof: Suppose $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is non-trivial. Then for any non-trivial additive character $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ of $\mathbb{F}_q$ by Theorem 3.4.3 we get

$$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = \frac{G(\lambda_1, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda_2, \chi) \cdots G(\lambda_k, \chi)}{G(\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k, \chi)}$$

Since each λ_i non-trivial by Theorem 3.3.1 we get $|G(\lambda_i, \chi)| = q^{1/2}$ for all $i \in [k]$ and $|G(\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k, \chi)| = q^{1/2}$. Hence we get

$$|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = \frac{\prod_{i=1}^k |G(\lambda_i, \chi)|}{|G(\lambda_1 \cdots \lambda_k, \chi)|} = q^{(q-1)/2}$$

Now suppose $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is trivial. Then again by Theorem 3.4.3 we have

$$J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = -\lambda_k(-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1})$$

Now since $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is trivial and λ_k is non-trivial we have $\prod_{i=1}^{k-1} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial. Hence by using the first case we have $|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1})| = q^{(k-2)/2}$. Hence $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = q^{(k-2)/2}$. Therefore we have the result. ■

Using the value of $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ we can also get the absolute value of $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)$ when all λ_i's are non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is trivial.

Corollary 3.4.5 Absolute Value of J_0 for Non-trivial Characters

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be non-trivial multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is trivial. Then

$$|J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = (q-1)q^{(k-2)/2}$$

Proof: Using Lemma 3.4.2 we have $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = \lambda_k(-1) \cdot (q-1) \cdot J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1})$. Now since $\prod_{i=1}^k \lambda_i$ is trivial and λ_k is non-trivial we have $\prod_{i=1}^{k-1} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial. Therefore by Theorem 3.4.4 we have $|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_{k-1})| = q^{(k-2)/2}$. Therefore together we have the corollary. ■

Combining Lemma 3.4.1, Lemma 3.4.2, Theorem 3.4.4, and the corollary above, we obtain a complete description of the absolute values of Jacobi sums in all cases.

Theorem 3.4.6 Complete Evaluation of Jacobi Sums

Let $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

(i) If λ_i is trivial for all $i \in [k]$ then $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = q^{k-1}$.

(ii) If some but not all λ_i's are trivial then $J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = 0$.

(iii) If all λ_i's are non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is non-trivial then $|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = q^{(k-1)/2}$ and $J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k) = 0$.

(iv) If all λ_i's are non-trivial and $\prod_{i=1}^{k} \lambda_i$ is trivial then $|J(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = q^{(k-2)/2}$ and $|J_0(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k)| = (q-1)q^{(k-2)/2}$.

3.4.2 The Davenport–Hasse Relations

The case $k = 2$ is the one that appears in most arithmetic applications. The central result here is the Davenport–Hasse product formula, which expresses a high power of a Gaussian sum as a product of Jacobi sums. We first establish a useful preliminary identity.

Lemma 3.4.7 Gaussian Sum Power via Jacobi Products

Let λ be a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ of order $m \geq 2$ and let χ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$G(\lambda, \chi)^m = \lambda(-1) \cdot q \cdot J(\lambda, \lambda) \cdot J(\lambda, \lambda^2) \cdots J(\lambda, \lambda^{m-2})$$

Proof: If $m = 2$ then $\overline{\lambda} = \lambda$ and so $G(\lambda, \chi)^2 = G(\lambda, \chi) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi)$ and the right hand side becomes $\lambda(-1) \cdot q$ which we already have from Lemma 3.3.2(iv). So now suppose $m \geq 3$.

Then from Theorem 3.4.3 we have for all $i \in [m-2]$

$$J(\lambda, \lambda^i) = \frac{G(\lambda, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda^i, \chi)}{G(\lambda^{i+1}, \chi)}$$

Therefore taking product of all $J(\lambda, \lambda^i)$ for all $i \in [m-2]$ we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\prod_{i=1}^{m-2} J(\lambda, \lambda^i) &= \prod_{i=1}^{m-2} \frac{G(\lambda, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda^i, \chi)}{G(\lambda^{i+1}, \chi)} \\
&= G(\lambda, \chi)^{m-2} \frac{G(\lambda, \chi)}{G(\lambda^{m-1}, \chi)} \\
&= \frac{G^{m-1}(\lambda, \chi)}{G(\lambda^{m-1}, \chi)}
\end{aligned}$$

Since $\mathrm{ord}(\lambda) = m$ we have $\lambda^{m-1} = \overline{\lambda}$. Therefore we have

$$\prod_{i=1}^{m-2} J(\lambda, \lambda^i) = \frac{G^{m-1}(\lambda, \chi)}{G(\lambda^{m-1}, \chi)} = \frac{G^m(\lambda, \chi)}{G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda, \chi)} = \frac{G^m(\lambda, \chi)}{\lambda(-1) \cdot q}$$

Therefore we have the lemma. ■

Now we give another result of relation between Gaussian sums for the $k = 2$ case. This gives relation between two Gaussian sums on non-trivial multiplicative characters of different orders using Jacobi sums. We will not prove this theorem as it is far too complicated to be included in here.

Theorem 3.4.8 Davenport–Hasse Product Formula

Let $\psi, \lambda \in \mathcal{M}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\mathrm{ord}(\lambda) = m \geq 2$ and ψ^m is non-trivial. Let $\chi_b \in \mathcal{X}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ as defined in Theorem 3.2.1. Then

$$\frac{G(\psi, \chi_b)^m}{G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb})} = \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} J(\psi, \lambda^j).$$

Over the prime field $\mathbb{F}_p$ the Davenport–Hasse relation admits a more explicit form, in which the root of unity appearing on the right hand side is written in terms of a primitive root modulo p. This form appears as Theorem 3 in the paper of Huard, Spearman and Williams.

Theorem 3.4.9 Davenport–Hasse Relation over $\mathbb{F}_p$, [HSW95, Theorem 3]

Let $m \geq 2$ and $n \geq 1$ be integers, let p be an odd prime with $p \equiv 1 \bmod mn$, and set $f = (p-1)/mn$. Let g be a primitive root modulo p, and for any integer $l \not\equiv 0 \bmod p$ let $\mathrm{ind}_g(l)$ denote the least nonnegative integer with $g^{\mathrm{ind}_g(l)} \equiv l \bmod p$. Set $\beta_{mn} = e^{2\pi i/mn}$ and let $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_p$ be the multiplicative character of order mn determined by $\lambda(g) = \beta_{mn}$. Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_p$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_p$. Then for every $t = 1, \ldots, m-1$,

$$\frac{G(\lambda^{tn}, \chi) \cdot \prod_{j=1}^{n-1} G(\lambda^{mj}, \chi)}{\prod_{j=0}^{n-1} G(\lambda^{mj+t}, \chi)} = \beta_{mn}^{nt \cdot \mathrm{ind}_g(n)},$$

equivalently,

$$\prod_{j=1}^{n-1} \frac{J(\lambda^{mj}, \lambda^t)}{J(\lambda^{tj}, \lambda^t)} = \beta_{mn}^{nt \cdot \mathrm{ind}_g(n)}.$$

As an application of the Davenport–Hasse product formula, together with the evaluation of Jacobi sums in Theorem 3.4.6, we obtain the following closed form for the product of Gaussian sums on the m characters $\psi \cdot \lambda^i$ twisting ψ by the powers of λ. The two cases reflect the parity of m, with the even case picking up an extra quadratic Gaussian sum $G(\eta, \chi_b)$ where η is the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Corollary 3.4.10

Let $\psi, \lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\mathrm{ord}(\lambda) = m \geq 2$ and ψ^m is non-trivial. Let $\chi_b \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ as defined in Theorem 3.2.1.

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j, \chi_b) = \begin{cases} q^{(m-1)/2} G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb}) & \text{if } m \text{ is odd} \\ (-1)^{(q-1)(m-2)/8} \cdot q^{(m-2)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_b) \cdot G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb}) & \text{if } m \text{ is even} \end{cases}$$

Proof: Since $\mathrm{ord}(\lambda) \geq 2$ and ψ^m is non-trivial we have $\psi \cdot \lambda^j$ is non-trivial for all $j \in [m-1]$. By Davenport-Hasse Product Formula we have

$$\frac{G(\psi, \chi_b)^m}{G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb})} = \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} J(\psi, \lambda^j)$$

Now by using Theorem 3.4.3 on the right hand side of this expression we get

$$\frac{G(\psi, \chi_b)^m}{G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb})} = \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} \frac{G(\psi, \chi_b) \cdot G(\lambda^j, \chi_b)}{G(\psi \cdot \lambda^i, \chi_b)} = G(\psi, \chi_b)^{m-1} \prod_{i=1}^{j} \frac{G(\lambda^j, \chi_b)}{G(\psi \cdot \lambda^i, \chi_b)}$$

So together we have

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j, \chi_b) = G(\psi^m, \chi_{mb}) \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) \tag{3.6}$$

Notice we already obtained the left hand side and one term in the right hand side correctly. So now the value at right only depends on the product of $G(\lambda^j, \chi_b)$'s.

Now if m is odd then we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) &= \prod_{j=1}^{(m-1)/2} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) G(\lambda^{m-j}, \chi_b) \\
&= \prod_{j=1}^{(m-1)/2} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda^j}, \chi_b) && [\text{As } \operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = m = \text{odd}] \\
&= \prod_{j=1}^{(m-1)/2} \lambda^j(-1) \cdot q && [\text{By } \textit{Lemma } 3.3.2(iv)] \\
&= q^{(m-1)/2} \prod_{j=1}^{(m-1)/2} \lambda^j(-1)
\end{aligned}$$

Since m is odd by Observation 3.6 we have $\lambda(-1) = 1$. Therefore

$$\prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) = q^{(m-1)/2}$$

So we have the first case together with (3.6). Now for the remaining case of m being even we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) &= G(\lambda^{m/2}, \chi_b) \prod_{j=1}^{(m-2)/2} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) G(\lambda^{m-j}, \chi_b) \\
&= G(\eta, \chi_b) \prod_{j=1}^{(m-2)/2} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda^j}, \chi_b) && [\text{As } \operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = m = \text{even}] \\
&= G(\eta, \chi_b) \prod_{j=1}^{(m-2)/2} \lambda^j(-1) \cdot q && [\text{By } \textit{Lemma } 3.3.2(iv)] \\
&= q^{(m-2)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_b) \prod_{j=1}^{(m-2)/2} \lambda^j(-1)
\end{aligned}$$

Again by Observation 3.6 since m is even if $\frac{q-1}{m}$ is odd then $\lambda(-1) = 1$ and if $\frac{q-1}{m}$ is even then $\lambda(-1) = 1$. Hence we can write $\lambda(-1) = (-1)^{(q-1)/m}$. Therefore

$$\prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi_b) = (-1)^{(q-1)(m-2)/8} \cdot q^{(m-2)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_b)$$

So together with (3.6) we have the result. ■

Corollary 3.4.11

Let $\psi, \lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = m \geq 2$ and ψ^m is non-trivial. Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be any non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j) = \psi^{-m}(m) \cdot G(\psi^m, \chi) \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi)$$

where for any $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $\chi_m(\gamma) = \chi(m \cdot \gamma)$ similar to as defined in Theorem 3.2.1.

Proof: By Davenport-Hasse Product Formula we have

$$\frac{G(\psi, \chi)^m}{G(\psi^m, \chi)} = \prod_{j=1}^{m} J(\psi, \lambda^j)$$

Now using Theorem 3.4.3 for any $j \in \{m-1\}$ we have

$$J(\psi, \lambda^j) = \frac{G(\psi, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda^j, \chi}{G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j, \chi)}$$

So replacing $J(\psi, \lambda^j)$ we get

$$\frac{G(\psi, \chi)^m}{G(\psi^m, \chi)} = \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} \frac{G(\psi, \chi) \cdot G(\lambda^j, \chi}{G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j, \chi)} = G(\psi, \chi)^{m-1} \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} \frac{G(\lambda^j, \chi}{G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j, \chi)}$$

So we get the final relation

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j) = G(\psi^m, \chi_m) \prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi) \tag{3.7}$$

Now by Lemma 3.3.2(i) we have $G(\psi^m, \chi_m) = \psi^{-m}(m) G(\psi^m, \chi)$. So replacing $G(\psi^m, \chi_m)$ we get the theorem. ■

Since for the trivial multiplicative character $\psi_0 \in \mathcal{M}_q$ we have $\lambda^0 = \psi_0$. Therefore $\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi) = -\prod_{j=1}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi)$ by Theorem 3.3.1. Therefore from (3.7) we have

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j) = -G(\psi^m, \chi_m) \prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi)$$

So we get the following observation:

Observation 3.11. *Let $\psi, \lambda \in \mathcal{M}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = m \geq 2$ and ψ^m is non-trivial. Let $\chi \in \mathcal{X}_q$ be any non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then*

$$\prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\psi \cdot \lambda^j) = -\psi^{-m}(m) \cdot G(\psi^m, \chi) \prod_{j=0}^{m-1} G(\lambda^j, \chi)$$

3.4.3 Application: Fermat's Two-Square Theorem

A classical application of the arithmetic of Jacobi sums is a short representation-theoretic proof of a celebrated theorem of Fermat: every prime $p \equiv 1 \bmod 4$ is a sum of two integer squares. The key point is that when λ is a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_p$ of order 4, the Jacobi sum $J(\lambda, \eta)$ lies in the ring of Gaussian integers $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ and has absolute value exactly $\sqrt{p}$.

Theorem 3.4.12 Fermat's Two-Square Theorem

Let p be an odd prime with $p \equiv 1 \bmod 4$. Then there exist integers $A, B \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $p = A^2 + B^2$.

Proof: Let $\lambda, \eta \in \mathcal{M}_q$ are multiplicative characters such that $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = 4$ and η is the quadratic character. Since $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = 4$, λ takes values in $\{\pm 1, \pm i\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and since η takes values in $\{\pm 1\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}$, the Jacobi sum

$$J(\lambda, \eta) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p} \lambda(\alpha) \cdot \eta(1-\alpha) \in \mathbb{Z}[i].$$

Write $J(\lambda, \eta) = A + iB$ with $A, B \in \mathbb{Z}$. Since λ and η are both non-trivial and $\lambda \cdot \eta = \lambda^3$ is also non-trivial (as $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda) = 4$), Theorem 3.4.4 gives $|J(\lambda, \eta)| = p^{1/2}$; equivalently $A^2 + B^2 = p$. ■

We give another proof of this theorem in subsection 3.9.2 during the discussion of Jacobsthal Sums in section 3.9.

3.5 L-functions

The characters of cyclic groups defined in Lemma 3.1.1 are precisely the classical *Dirichlet characters*. Dirichlet characters are of paramount importance in analytic number theory: they appear in the study of primes in arithmetic progressions, the distribution of prime ideals, and the analytic continuation of L-functions. In the finite-field setting, the multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$ play an analogous role, and the associated L-functions encode deep arithmetic information about character sums over $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Before specialising to the function-field setting, it is helpful to pause and describe the general analytic framework into which all of these objects fit. The central analytic device is a *Dirichlet series*

Definition 3.5.1: Dirichlet Series

Let $a(n)$ be a sequence of complex numbers and $s \in \mathbb{C}$ be any complex number. Then a series of the form

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_n}{n^s}, \qquad s \in \mathbb{C},$$

is called a Dirichlet series.

Two very familiar Dirichlet series organize a vast section of analytic number theory:

1. **Zeta functions** arise when the coefficients are the trivial ones, $a_n \equiv 1$, so that the Dirichlet series simply counts the size of some arithmetic object. The prototype is the *Riemann zeta function* $\zeta(s) = \sum_n n^{-s}$, which encodes the multiplicative structure of $\mathbb{Z}$.

2. L**-functions** arise when the coefficients are *twisted* by a character χ, giving $L(s,\chi) = \sum_{h:\text{ monic}} \chi(h)/\mathfrak{n}(h)^s$. The character χ is what allows one to isolate arithmetic information that a zeta function averages over. Since L-functions are defined using polynomials over a finite fields and then we can talk about the prime analogue in polynomial rings i.e. irreducible polynomials. Taking the trivial character $\chi \equiv 1$ recovers ζ up to finitely many Euler factors, so zeta functions are the "character-free" special case of L-functions.

The rest of this section unfolds this dictionary in two parallel worlds. First we recall the classical story over $\mathbb{Q}$ — the Riemann zeta function, its zeros, and its L-function generalisations — so that the relevant analytic phenomena are in view. Like in the case we go to $\mathbb{Q}$ the fraction field of $\mathbb{Z}$, we develop the function-field $\mathbb{F}_q(X)$ analog: the zeta function associated to $\mathbb{F}_q[X]$ and its twists by multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. The zeta function turns out to be a rational function of q^{-s}, and the analog of the Riemann Hypothesis is a theorem (due to Weil) rather than an open problem.

3.5.1 The Classical Riemann Zeta Function

The prototype of everything that follows is the *Riemann zeta function*.

Definition 3.5.2: Riemann Zeta Function

For any complex number $s \in \mathbb{C}$, the zeta functions at s is

$$\zeta(s) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n^s}$$

which converges absolutely in the right half-plane $\Re(s) > 1$. In fact for $s \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\Re(s) > 1$ the product $\prod_{n=2}^{\infty} \zeta(n)$ also converges. Most proofs in this subsection are omitted, especially those relying on contour integration or the Mellin transform; the emphasis is on statements together with their arithmetic meaning.

Theorem 3.5.1 Euler Productfor $\zeta(s)$

For $s \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\Re(s) > 1$,

$$\zeta(s) = \prod_{p \text{ prime}} \frac{1}{1 - p^{-s}}.$$

Proof: Since $\mathbb{Z}$ is a UPD (unique factorization domain) every positive integer n can be written uniquely as a product of powers of positive prime numbers.

$$\zeta(s) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n^s} = \prod_{p:\text{ prime}} \left(\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{p^{i \cdot s}} \right) = \prod_{p:\text{ prime}} (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}$$

So we have the lemma. ■

The identity is the analytic translation of *unique factorisation*: expanding each geometric factor $(1 - p^{-s})^{-1} = \sum_{k \geq 0} p^{-ks}$ and multiplying reproduces the sum over positive integers. Since $\zeta(s)$ has a pole at $s = 1$ (the harmonic series diverges), the product must have infinitely many factors — giving an analytic proof of the infinitude of primes. Dirichlet series evaluated on certain "natural points" encode interesting algebraic and arithmetic information.

The Euler product is the first of many important properties of $\zeta(s)$. The next is that $\zeta(s)$ has a meromorphic continuation to the entire plane; we recall the relevant definitions (zero, pole, meromorphic function) in Appendix A.1. The special values of ζ encode deep arithmetic: $\zeta(2n)$ for $n \geq 1$ is a rational multiple of π^{2n}, expressible via Bernoulli numbers. Odd values are much harder — Apéry (1979) proved $\zeta(3)$ is irrational, while the arithmetic nature of $\zeta(5), \zeta(7), \ldots$ remains unknown. The negative-integer values $\zeta(0), \zeta(-1), \ldots$ make sense only *after* analytic continuation: naively $\zeta(-1) = 1 + 2 + 3 + \cdots$, yet the continuation assigns it the value $-\frac{1}{12}$. To study $\zeta(s)$ and its analytic continuation we use the Gamma function

$$\Gamma(s) = \int_0^{\infty} e^{-t} t^{s-1} dt$$

The analytic continuation is most cleanly stated for the *completed zeta function.*

Theorem 3.5.2 Analytic Continuation of the Completed Zeta Function

Define the completed zeta function by

$$\xi(s) = \tfrac{1}{2} s(s-1)\, \Gamma\left(\tfrac{s}{2}\right) \pi^{-s/2} \zeta(s).$$

Then $\xi(s)$, originally defined for $\Re(s) > 1$, has an analytic continuation to an entire function and satisfies the ***functional equation*** *$\xi(s) = \xi(1 - s)$.*

From now on whenever we say zeta function we often mean the analytic continuation of zeta function by default. Now we will study the zeros of zeta function and why they are important. The Gamma function has poles at all negative integers. From the functional equation of the zeta function it has zeros at all the poles of $\Gamma(s/2)$ i.e. at all negative even integers. These zeros are called *trivial zeros* of ζ. The $\zeta(s)$ has positive value for all $s \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\Re(s) > 1$. Therefore all other zeros lie in the *critical strip* $0 \leq \Re(s) \leq 1$; the functional equation forces them to be symmetric under $s \mapsto 1 - s$, and conjugation $s \mapsto \bar{s}$ forces reflection symmetry across the real axis. Hence

Theorem 3.5.3 Trivial Zeros and Symmetry of Non-trivial Zeros

The only zeros of $\zeta(s)$ where $s \in \mathbb{C}$ for $\Re(s) < 0$ are at $s = -2n$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$. In the critical strip the zeros lie symmetrically around the critical line $\Re(s) = 1/2$ i.e. if $a + ib$ is a zero so is $1 - a + ib$.

regarding the zeros of the zeta functionThe line $\Re(s) = 1/2$ is the *critical line*, and the most famous open problem in mathematics is:

***Riemann Hypothesis**: Every non-trivial zero of $\zeta(s)$ satisfies $\Re(s) = 1/2$.*

While Hardy in 1914 showed that there are infinitely many zeros on the critical line the problem of every non-trivial zero being on the critical line is a major open problem in mathematics.

Theorem 3.5.4 Hardy, 1914

Infinitely many non-trivial zeros of $\zeta(s)$ lie on the critical line $\Re(s) = 1/2$.

Another interesting property, first noted in Riemann's original paper is the product expansion of zeta function using the non-trivial zeros.

Theorem 3.5.5 Hadamard Product

There exist constants $A, B \in \mathbb{C}$ such that

$$\xi(s) = e^{A+Bs} \prod_{\rho} \left(1 - \frac{s}{\rho}\right) e^{s/\rho},$$

where the product runs over all non-trivial zeros ρ of ζ.

This is the "zero-side" factorisation of ξ, to be contrasted with the Euler product as the "prime-side" factorisation. Together they are the source of the famous duality between primes and zeros: equating the two factorisations — typically after taking logarithmic derivatives — converts statements about primes into statements about zeros and vice versa.

Zeros ↔ primes. Taking the logarithmic derivative of the Euler product we obtain,

$$-\frac{\zeta'(s)}{\zeta(s)} = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n^s},$$

where $\Lambda(n) = \log p$ if $n = p^k$ and 0 otherwise (the *von Mangoldt function*). Therefore we can see how the non-trivial zeros of $\zeta(s)$ and the primes are very related.

3.5.2 Dirichlet L-function

The function-field world has its own zeta function, obtained by replacing $\mathbb{Z}$ with the polynomial ring $\mathbb{F}_q[X]$ and the primes with monic irreducible polynomials. The notational parallel with the classical case is exact, but the analytic behavior is dramatically simpler: the resulting zeta function is a *rational* function of q^{-s}, with no mystery in its analytic continuation, and (as will be developed in later sections) a fully-proven analog of the Riemann Hypothesis.

Let $\Phi \subseteq \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ denote the set of all monic polynomials, and let $\Phi_d \subseteq \Phi$ be the subset of polynomials of degree exactly d, for each $d \in \mathbb{N}$. A basic count gives $|\Phi_d| = q^d$: a degree-d monic polynomial is determined by its d lower-order coefficients, each of which is a free element of $\mathbb{F}_q$. This simple combinatorial fact is what makes the function-field zeta function so much more tractable than its classical counterpart.

For any polynomial $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$, the quotient ring $\mathbb{F}_q[X] \,/\, \langle f \rangle$ is a finite $\mathbb{F}_q$-algebra of size $q^{\deg(f)}$. We define the *norm* of f to be

$$\mathfrak{n}(f) = \left| \mathbb{F}_q[X] \Big/ \langle f \rangle \right| = q^{\deg(f)},$$

by direct analogy with the norm of an ideal in the ring of integers of a number field. This norm is the direct replacement for the size of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ (namely n) that appears in the classical Riemann zeta function.

To define L-functions in the function field setting we first need to extend multiplicative characters to the polynomial ring. Let $G \subseteq \mathbb{F}_q(X)$ be the group of rational functions $h_1(X)/h_2(X)$ where $h_2 \neq 0$ and $h_1, h_2 \in \Phi$ where $\Phi \subseteq G$ is the set of

all monic polynomials over $\mathbb{F}_q$. From now on we use $h(X) \in G$ to denote monic polynomials. Let $\overline{G}$ be the subgroup of G such that $h_1 \cdot h_2 \in \overline{G}$ whenever $h_1, h_2 \in \overline{G}$. For a character χ on $\overline{G}$ we extend χ to all of G by setting $\chi(r) = 0$ for all $r \notin \overline{G}$, after which χ remains multiplicative on G. This allows us to sum χ over all monic polynomials.

Definition 3.5.3: Dirichlet L-function

Let χ be a character on $\overline{G}$ extended to G as above. For a complex number $s = a + ib \in \mathbb{C}$ with $a > 1$, the Dirichlet L-function *associated to χ is defined by*

$$L(s, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s}$$

where the sum runs over all monic polynomials $h \in \Phi \subseteq G$ and $\mathfrak{n}(h) = q^{\deg(h)}$ is the norm of h.

Again this sum is absolutely convergent for $\Re(s) > 1$. Like in the case of Riemann-Zeta functions we can express $L(s, \chi)$ in a Euler product form using only irreducible polynomials.

Theorem 3.5.6 Euler Product for $\zeta(s)$

For $s \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\Re(s) > 1$ we have

$$L(s, \chi) = \prod_{\substack{h \in \Phi \\ h \text{ irreducible}}} (1 - \chi(h) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s})^{-1}$$

Proof: Since $\Re(s) > 1$ we have

$$L(s, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s} = \prod_{\substack{h \in \Phi \\ h \text{ irreducible}}} \left(\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \chi(h^i) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h^i)^{-s} \right) = \prod_{\substack{h \in \Phi \\ h \text{ irreducible}}} (1 - \chi(h) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s})^{-1}$$

Hence we have the lemma. ■

So let $\chi : G \to \mathbb{C}$ be a multiplicative complex valued function over the G where G is as defined above which also satisfies $|\chi(r)| \leq 1$ for all $r \in G$ and $\chi(1) = 1$. Then for any $s \in \mathbb{C}$ with $\Re(s) > 1$ we can rewrite

$$L(s, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h) \cdot \mathfrak{n}(h)^{-s} = \sum_{d=0}^{\infty} \left(\sum_{h \in \Phi_d} \chi(h) \right) q^{-d \cdot s}$$

Since for any $h \in \Phi$ we have $\mathfrak{n}(q)^s = (q^s)^{\deg(h)}$ we can consider the corresponding power series

$$\overline{L}(z, \chi) = \sum_{h \in \Phi} \chi(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)}$$

hence $\overline{L}(q^{-s}, \chi) = L(s, \chi)$. Now using Theorem 3.5.6 for $\overline{L}(z, \chi)$ we have

$$\overline{L}(z, \chi) = \prod_{\substack{h \in \Phi \\ h \text{ irreducible}}} \left(1 - \chi(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)}\right)^{-1}$$

Now we do some operations on the power series $\overline{L}(z, \chi)$ to get some expressions which help us later in proving some properties of exponential character sums. So for brevity of notations we use $\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)$ to denote the set of irreducible polynomials of Φ. We have $\log \overline{L}(z, \chi) = -\sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \log\left(1 - \chi(h) z^{\deg(h)}\right)$. So by differentiating we get

$$\frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z, \chi) = -\sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \frac{-\chi(h) \cdot \deg(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)-1}}{1 - \chi(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)}} = \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \frac{\chi(h) \cdot \deg(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)-1}}{1 - \chi(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)}}$$

So

$$\begin{aligned} z \cdot \frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z,\chi) &= \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \frac{\chi(h) \cdot \deg(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)-1}}{1 - \chi(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)}} \\ &= \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \chi(h) \cdot \deg(h) \cdot z^{\deg(h)} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \chi^k(h) \cdot z^{k \cdot \deg(h)} \\ &= \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi)} \deg(h) \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \chi^k(h) \cdot z^{k \cdot \deg(h)} \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \left(\sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi), \\ \deg(h) \mid k}} \deg(h) \cdot \chi(h)^{k/\deg(h)} \right) z^k \end{aligned} \tag{3.8}$$

So define $L_k := \sum_{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\ \deg(h) \mid k} \deg(h) \cdot \chi(h)^{k/\deg(h)}$. Hence we have $z \cdot \frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z,\chi) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} L_k \cdot z^k$.

Now suppose there exists a positive integer $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $d > N$ we have $\sum_{h \in \Phi_d} \chi(g) = 0$. Then we have

$$L(s,\chi) = \sum_{d=0}^{N} \left(\sum_{h \in \Phi_d} \chi(d) \right) q^{-d \cdot s}, \qquad \overline{L}(z,\chi) = \sum_{d=0}^{N} \left(\sum_{h \in \Phi_d} \chi(d) \right) z^d$$

Since now $\overline{L}(z,\chi)$ is not an infinite power series anymore, instead a degree N polynomial over $\mathbb{C}$ there exists complex numbers $w_1, \cdots, w_N \in \mathbb{C}$ such that $\overline{L}(z,\chi) = (1 - w_1 z)(1 - w_2 z) \cdots (1 - w_N z)$. Now applying $z \cdot \frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z,\chi)$ on this expression we get

$$\begin{aligned} z \cdot \frac{d}{dz} \log \overline{L}(z,\chi) &= -\sum_{i=1}^{N} \frac{w_i z}{1 - w_i z} \\ &= -\sum_{i=1}^{N} w_i z \left(\sum_{j=0}^{\infty} w_i^j z^j \right) \\ &= -\sum_{i=1}^{N} \left(\sum_{j=1}^{\infty} w_i^j \right) z^i \end{aligned} \tag{3.9}$$

Therefore by comparing coefficients of (3.9) with (3.8) we get $L_k = -\sum_{i=1}^{N} w_i^k$. for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$. So we have the following theorem

Theorem 3.5.7

Let $\chi : G \to \mathbb{C}$ be a multiplicative function with $|\chi(r)| \leq 1$ for all $r \in G$ and $\chi(1) = 1$, and suppose there exists a positive integer $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\sum_{h \in \Phi_d} \chi(h) = 0$ for every $d > N$. Then $\overline{L}(z,\chi)$ is a polynomial of degree at most N over $\mathbb{C}$, and there exist complex numbers $w_1, \ldots, w_N \in \mathbb{C}$ such that

$$\overline{L}(z,\chi) = \prod_{i=1}^{N} (1 - w_i z), \qquad \textit{and} \qquad L(s,\chi) = \prod_{i=1}^{N} \left(1 - w_i q^{-s}\right).$$

Moreover, for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$L_k = \sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi) \\ \deg(h) \mid k}} \deg(h) \cdot \chi(h)^{k/\deg(h)} = -\sum_{i=1}^{N} w_i^k.$$

3.6 Lifting of Gaussian and Jacobi Sums

So using the discussion on *Dirichlet L-functions* we can relate Gaussian sums in $\mathbb{F}_q$ with Gaussian sum of lifted characters to any finite extension of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Theorem 3.6.1 Davenport-Hasse Theorem

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be an additive character and $\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, not both of them trivial. Suppose χ and ψ are lifted to characters $\chi^{(r)}$ and $\psi^{(r)}$ respectively of the finite extension field E of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with $[E\colon \mathbb{F}_q] = r$. Then

$$G(\psi^{(r)}, \chi^{(r)}) = (-1)^{r-1} G(\psi, \chi)^r$$

Proof: Like previous section G is the set of all rational functions $r(X) = {}^{h_1}/_{h_2}$ where $h_1, h_2 \in \Phi$, h_2 non-zero. Let $\overline{G}$ be the subgroup of G consisting of rational functions $r(X) = \frac{h_1(X)}{h_2(X)}$ having $h_1(0), h_2(0) \neq 0$. Then define the multiplicative function $\lambda : G \to \mathbb{C}$ such that for all $r \in G$, $|\lambda(r)| \leq 1$ and $\lambda(1) = 1$ in the following way:

If $r(X) \in G$ where $r(X) = \frac{h_1(X)}{h_2(X)}$ and in the common splitting field E of h_1, h_2, they factor as:

$$h_1(X) = \prod_{i=1}^{d_1} (X - \alpha_i) \qquad \text{and} \qquad h_1(X) = \prod_{j=1}^{d_2} (X - \beta_j)$$

where $\alpha_i, \beta_j \in E$ for all $i \in [d_1]$, $j \in [d_2]$ then

$$\lambda(r) = \psi\left(\prod_{i=1}^{d_1} \alpha_i \cdot \prod_{j=1}^{d_2} \beta_j^{-1}\right) \cdot \chi\left(\sum_{i=1}^{d_1} \alpha_i - \sum_{j=1}^{d_2} \beta_j\right)$$

Now for any monic polynomial $h \in \Phi$ let $h(X) = X^n - c_1 \cdot X^{n-1} + \cdots + (-1)^n c_n$ where $c_i \in \mathbb{F}_q$ for all $i \in [n]$. Then we have $\lambda(h) = \psi(c_n) \cdot \chi(c_1)$. Clearly λ is a multiplicative map on G. Now for a given (c_1, c_k) pair there are q^{n-2} polynomials where same (c_1, c_n) occurs. Hence

$$\sum_{h \in \Phi_k} \lambda(h) = q^{n-2} \sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_n \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(c_n) \cdot \chi(c_1) = q^{n-2} \left(\sum_{c_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}\right)\left(\sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(c_1)\right)$$

Since ψ and χ are non-trivial by Theorem 3.2.2 and Theorem 3.2.5 we have $\sum_{h \in \Phi_k} \lambda(h) = 0$ for $n > 1$.

Now $\Phi(0) = \{1\}$ and $\Phi(1) = \{x - \alpha \colon \alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*\}$. Hence

$$\sum_{h \in \Phi_1} \lambda(h) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi(\alpha) \cdot \chi(\alpha) = G(\psi, \chi)$$

Therefore

$$\overline{L}(z, \lambda) = 1 + G(\psi, \chi) \cdot z \qquad \text{and} \qquad L(s, \chi) = 1 + q^{-s} \cdot G(\psi, \chi)$$

Therefore root of $\overline{L}(z, \lambda)$ is $-G(\psi, \chi)$.

Now we will calculate L_r where $r = [E\colon \mathbb{F}_q]$. From the definition of L_r in previous section we have

$$L_r = \sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi), \\ \deg(h) | r}} \deg(h) \cdot \chi(h)^{r/\deg(h)} = \sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi), \\ \deg(h) | r}} \deg(h) \cdot \lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right)$$

Now for any irreducible h let γ be a root of h in the splitting field of f. Let

$$h^{r/\deg(f)} = x^r - c_1 \cdot x^{r-1} + \cdots + (-1)^k c_r = \prod_{i=o}^{r-1} \left(X - \gamma^{q^i}\right)$$

Hence $c_1 = \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)$ and $c_r = \mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)$. Hence we have

$$\lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right) = \psi(c_r)\cdot\chi(c_1) = \psi\left(\mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)\right)\cdot\chi\left(\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)\right) = \psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$$

Now we can express $\deg(h)\cdot\lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right) = \sum_{\gamma\in E, h(\gamma)=0}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$. Therefore

$$L_r = \sum_{\substack{h\in\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\\ \deg(h)\mid k}} \deg(h)\cdot\lambda\left(h^{k/\deg(h)}\right) = \sum_{\substack{h\in\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\\ \deg(h)\mid k}}\ \sum_{\gamma\in E, h(\gamma)=0}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$$

Now all irreducible polynomials of $\mathbb{F}_q$ whose degree divides r with non-zero constant their roots in E are disjoint sets and partition E^*. Therefore we have

$$L_r = \sum_{\gamma\in E^*}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma) = G(\psi^{(r)},\chi^{(r)})$$

Since by Theorem 3.5.7 we have $L_r = -(-G(\psi,\chi))^r$. So we have the theorem. ■

An analogous lifting phenomenon holds for Jacobi sums. Using the relation between Jacobi and Gaussian sums established in Theorem 3.4.3 together with the Davenport-Hasse Theorem, one can compare the Jacobi sum of a tuple of characters over $\mathbb{F}_q$ with the Jacobi sum of their lifts to a finite extension. The following theorem makes this precise.

Theorem 3.6.2 Lifting of Jacobi Sums

Let $\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be multiplicative characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$, not all of which are trivial. Suppose $\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k$ are lifted to characters $\lambda_1(r),\ldots,\lambda_k^{(r)}$ respectively, of the finite extension field E of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with $[E:\mathbb{F}_q] = r$. Then

$$J\left(\lambda_1^{(r)},\ldots,\lambda_k^{(r)}\right) = (-1)^{(r-1)(k-1)}J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k)^r$$

Proof: Now if any λ_i is trivial then the lifted character $\lambda^{(r)}$ is also trivial over E. If Then by Theorem 3.4.6(ii) we get both sides to be 0. So suppose $\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k$ are non-trivial. Now we will use Theorem 3.4.3. Let $\chi\in\boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be any non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. So let $\chi^{(r)}$ be the lifted character of χ to E. If $\prod_{i=1}^k\lambda_i$ is non-trivial then we have

$$\begin{aligned}
J\left(\lambda_1^{(r)},\ldots,\lambda_k^{(r)}\right) &= \frac{\prod_{i=1}^k G\left(\lambda_i^{(r)},\chi^{(r)}\right)}{G\left(\prod_{i=1}^k\lambda_i^{(r)},\chi^{(r)}\right)}\\
&= \frac{\prod_{i=1}^k(-1)^{r-1}G(\lambda_i,\chi)^r}{(-1)^{r-1}G\left(\prod_{i=1}^k\lambda_i,\chi\right)^r} && [\text{By } \textit{Davenport} - \textit{Hasse Theorem}]\\
&= (-1)^{(s-1)(r-1)}\left[\frac{\prod_{i=1}^k G(\lambda_i,\chi)}{G\left(\prod_{i=1}^k\lambda_i,\chi\right)}\right]^r\\
&= (-1)^{(s-1)(r-1)}J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k)^r
\end{aligned}$$

Now the only case remaining is when $\prod_{i=1}^k\lambda_i$ is trivial. In that case we have

$$\begin{aligned}
J\left(\lambda_1^{(r)},\ldots,\lambda_k^{(r)}\right) &= -\frac{1}{q^r}\prod_{i=1}^k G\left(\lambda_i^{(r)},\chi^{(r)}\right)\\
&= -\frac{1}{q^s}\cdot(-1)^{(r-1)\cdot k}\prod_{i=1}^k G(\lambda_i,\chi)^r && [\text{By } \textit{Davenport} - \textit{Hasse Theorem}]\\
&= (-1)^{(r-1)(k-1)}\cdot J(\lambda_1,\ldots,\lambda_k)
\end{aligned}$$

So we have the theorem. ■

3.7 Kloosterman Sums

We now turn to a genuinely different family of exponential sums, introduced by Hendrik Kloosterman in 1926 in his refinement of the Hardy–Littlewood circle method for the representation of integers by positive definite quaternary quadratic forms. Instead of twisting two characters of different types, a Kloosterman sum twists a single additive character χ with the *inversion* map $\gamma \mapsto \gamma^{-1}$ on $\mathbb{F}_q^*$, producing a sum of the form $\sum_\gamma \chi(a\gamma + b\gamma^{-1})$.

Definition 3.7.1: Kloosterman Sums

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Then the Kloosterman Sum *associated to χ, a, b is defined as*

$$K(\chi; a, b) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1})$$

When one or both of the parameters a, b vanish, the Kloosterman sum collapses to an additive character sum on $\mathbb{F}_q^*$, which we have already computed in Theorem 3.2.2. If both $a = b = 0$ then for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, $\chi(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}) = \chi(0) = 1$. Hence $K(\chi; 0, 0) = q - 1$.

If exactly one of a, b is zero then we have either

$$K(\chi; a, b) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot \gamma) = -1 \text{ or } K(\chi; a, b) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(b \cdot \gamma^{-1}) = -1$$

So in both cases $K(\chi; a, b) = -1$. So we have the following observations:

Observation 3.12. *Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $ab = 0$. Then*

(i) $K(\chi; 0, 0) = q - 1$ if both $a = b = 0$;

(ii) if exactly one of a, b is 0 then $K(\chi; a, b) = -1$;

Now another property to notice is Kloosterman sum is always real since

$$\overline{K(\chi; a, b)} = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\chi}(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(-(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1})) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot (-\gamma) + b \cdot (-\gamma)^{-1}) = K(\chi; a, b)$$

Therefore we have another observation:

Observation 3.13. *For all additive characters $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ and $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_p$, the Kloosterman Sum is real i.e. $\overline{K(\chi; a, b)} = K(\overline{\chi}; a, b) = K(\chi; -a, -b) = K(\chi; a, b)$.*

Now we can express Kloosterman sums as product of two additive characters like Jacobi sums is for product of multiplicative characters. For any $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ let $\chi = \chi_c$ for some $c \in \mathbb{F}_q$ as defined in Theorem 3.2.1. Then

$$K\left(\chi_c; a, b\right) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi_c\left(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}\right) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi_{a \cdot c}(\gamma) \cdot \chi_{-b \cdot c}(\gamma) =: K\left(\chi_{ac}, \overline{\chi}_{bc}\right)$$

Observation 3.14. *The Kloosterman sum can equivalently be viewed as two-additive-character sum: for any $a, b, c \in \mathbb{F}_q$ and $\chi_a, \chi_b, \chi_c \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ (in the notation of Theorem 3.2.1),*

$$K\left(\chi_a, \chi_b\right) := K\left(\chi_1; a, -b\right) \qquad \textit{and} \qquad K\left(\chi_c; a, -b\right) = K\left(\chi_{ac}, \chi_{bc}\right)$$

When the ground field has odd characteristic there is a useful alternative expression for $K(\chi; a, b)$ as a sum of a single additive character against the quadratic character η evaluated on a quadratic polynomial. This representation is often the starting point for asymptotic bounds on Kloosterman sums in arithmetic contexts.

Lemma 3.7.1

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with q odd, let η be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ (extended by $\eta(0) = 0$), and let $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ be not both zero. Then

$$K(\chi; a, b) = \sum_{d \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(d) \cdot \eta(d^2 - 4ab)$$

Proof: If one of a, b is zero then by Observation 3.12(ii) we have $K(\chi; a, b) = -1$. And then at the right hand side we have the sum over $\eta(\alpha^2 - 4ab) = \eta(\alpha^2) = 1$ and therefore the sum is of $\chi(\alpha)$ over all non-zero alpha which by Theorem 3.2.2(i) gives $q - 1 = -1$. Therefore in this case the lemma is satisfied. So now assume $a \cdot b \neq 0$.

Let for any $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, denote $d = a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}$. Now for any $d \in \mathbb{F}_q$ let $Z(d)$ is the number of $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ such that $d = a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}$. Now for any $d \in \mathbb{F}_q$,

$$a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1} = d \iff a \cdot \gamma^2 - d \cdot \gamma + b = 0$$

Therefore if $P_d(X) = a \cdot X^2 - d\dot{X} + b \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a polynomial then $Z(d) =$ number of zeros of $P_d(X)$. Hence $Z(d) \leq 2$. Let Δ_d is the discriminant of P_d i.e. $\Delta_d = d^2 - 4ab$. Hence If $\Delta_d = 0$ then $Z(d) = 1$. If a non-zero square root of Δ_d exists in $\mathbb{F}_q$ then Δ_d is a quadratic residue i.e. $\eta(\Delta_d) = 1$ then $Z(d) = 2$ and if it doesn't exists then Δ_d is a quadratic non-residue i.e. $\eta(\Delta_d) = -1$ then $Z(d) = 0$. Therefore together we can write $Z(d) = \eta(\Delta_d) + 1$ with the extended definition of η by setting $\eta(0) = 0$. Therefore we have

$$K(\chi; a, b) = \sum_{d \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(d) \cdot Z(d) = \sum_{d \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(d) \cdot \cdot \eta(\Delta_d) = \sum_{d \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(d) \cdot \cdot \eta(d^2 - 4ab)$$

Hence we have the lemma. ■

One of the central structural result for Kloosterman sums asserts that the sequence of lifted sums $K(\chi^{(s)}; a, b)$, viewed as a function of s, is controlled by just two complex numbers ω_1, ω_2 – exactly the reciprocal roots of the associated L-function. This is the Kloosterman analogue of the Davenport-Hasse Theorem. We will use again the *Dirichlet L-functions* in section 3.5 to prove the following theorem

Theorem 3.7.2 Lifting of Kloosterman Sum

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $ab \neq 0$. Suppose χ is lifted to character $\chi^{(r)}$ of the finite extension field E of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with $[E : \mathbb{F}_q] = r$. Then there exist complex numbers w_1, w_2 (depending only on χ, a, b), which are either complex conjugates of each other or both real, such that for every positive integer r

$$K(\chi^{(r)}; a, b) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_{q^r}^*} \chi^{(r)}(a\gamma + b\gamma^{-1}) = -w_1^r - w_2^r,$$

Proof: Let G be the set of all rational functions $r(X) \in \mathbb{F}_q(X)$ such that for any $r \in G$, $r(X) = {}^{h_1(X)}/_{h_2(X)}$ where $h_1, h_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q[x]$ and both h_1, h_2 are monic. Let $\overline{G}$ the subgroup of G such that for any $r \in \overline{G}$, $r(X) = {}^{h_1(X)}/_{h_2(X)}$ where h_1, h_2 have non-zero constant term. We will define a multiplicative function $\lambda : G \to \mathbb{C}$ such that $|\lambda(r)| \leq 1$ for all $r \in G$ and $\lambda(1) = 1$. Let $r \in \overline{G}$ where $r(X) = \frac{h_1(X)}{h_2(X)}$ and in common splitting field E of h_1, h_2 they factor as

$$h_1(X) = \prod_{i=1}^{d_1} (X - \alpha_i) \qquad \text{and} \qquad h_2(X) = \prod_{j=1}^{d_2} (X - \beta_j)$$

Then we will define λ using χ in the following way:

$$\lambda(r) = \chi\left[a\left(\sum_{i=1}^{d_1} \alpha_i - \sum_{j=1}^{d_2} \beta_j\right) + b\left(\sum_{i=1}^{d_1} \frac{1}{\alpha_i} - \sum_{j=1}^{d_2} \frac{1}{\beta_j}\right)\right] \tag{3.10}$$

Then if $h \in \Phi_n$ such that $h(X) = X^n - c_1 \cdot X^{n-1} + \cdots + (-1)^n \cdot c_n$ then $\lambda(h) = \chi\left(a \cdot c_1 + b \cdot c_{k-1} \cdot c_k^{-1}\right)$. Now it is enough to show that the corresponding coefficients are additive if two polynomials are multiplied since χ is an additive character. Let $h_1 \in \Phi_{n_1}$ and $g_2 \in \Phi_{n_2}$ and

$$g_1(X) = X^{n_1} + \sum_{i=1}^{n_1} (-1)^i \cdot c_{1,i} \cdot X^{n_1-i}, \quad g_2(X) = X^{n_2} + \sum_{j=2}^{n_2} (-2)^j \cdot c_{2,j} \cdot X^{n_2-j} \text{ and } g_1 \cdot g_2 = X^{n_1+n_2} + \sum_{t=1}^{n_1+n_2} (-1)^t \cdot c_j \cdot X^{n_1+n_2-t}$$

Then by comparing coeffieicnets we have

$$c_1 = c_{1,1} + c_{2,1}, \quad c_{n_1+n_2} = c_{1,n_1} \cdot c_{2,n_2}, \quad \text{and} \quad c_{n_1+n_2-1} = c_{1,n_1} \cdot c_{2,n_2-1} + c_{1,n_1-1} \cdot c_{2,n_2}$$

Hence λ is indeed a multiplicative function. Now we extend λ to G by setting $\lambda(r) = 0$ for all $h \notin \overline{G}$.

Now for any $k \in \mathbb{Z}_0$,if (c_1, c_{k-1}, c_k) is fixed where $c_k \neq 0$, there are q^{k-3} possible choices for $c_2, \ldots, c_{k-2}$ such that all polynomials with coefficients c_i's give same value for $\chi(a \cdot c_1 + b \cdot c_{k-1} \cdot c_k^{-1}$. So we will show that for $k \geq 3$, $\sum_{h \in \Phi_k} \lambda(h) = 0$. So

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{g \in \Phi_k} \lambda(g) &= \sum_{c_1, \ldots, c_{k-1}} \sum_{c_k \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot c_1 + b \cdot c_{k-1} \cdot c_k^{-1}) \\
&= q^{k-3} \sum_{c_1, c_{k-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_k \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot c_1 + b \cdot c_{k-1} \cdot c_k^{-1}) \\
&= q^{k-3} \left(\sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(a \cdot c_1) \right) \left(\sum_{c_{k-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_k \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(b \cdot c_{k-1} \cdot c_k^{-1}) \right) = 0 \qquad \text{[By } \textit{Theorem 3.2.2(i)}\text{]}
\end{aligned}$$

Hence we have $\overline{L}(z, \lambda) = 1 + z \sum_{h \in \Phi_1} \lambda(h) + z^2 \sum_{h \in \Phi_2} \lambda(h)$. Now $\Phi_1 = \{X - \gamma \mid \gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*\}$. Therefore we have

$$\sum_{h \in \Phi_1} \lambda(h) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot \gamma + b \cdot \gamma^{-1}) = K(\chi; a, b)$$

And furthermore for Φ_2 we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{h \in \Phi_2} \lambda(h) &= \sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \lambda(X^2 - c_1 \cdot X + c_2) \\
&= \sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(a \cdot c_1 + b \cdot c_1 \cdot c_2^{-1}) \\
&= \sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{c_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(c_1(a + b \cdot c_2^{-1}))
\end{aligned}$$

So if $c_2 = -a^{-1}b$ then $a + b \cdot c_2^{-1} = 0$ and hence $\sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(0) = q$ and if $c_2 \neq -a^{-1}b$ then $\sum_{c_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(c_1(a + b \cdot c_2^{-1})) = 0$ by Theorem 3.2.2(i). So therefore $\sum_{h \in \Phi_2} \lambda(h) = q$ and thus we get $\overline{L}(z, \lambda) = 1 + k(\chi; a, b) \cdot z + q \cdot z^2$. Let $w_1, w_2 \in \mathbb{C}$ which are either complex conjugates or both real such that

$$\overline{L}(z, \lambda) = (1 - w_1 \cdot z)(1 - w_2 \cdot z)$$

Now we will calculate L_r where $r = [E \colon \mathbb{F}_q]$. From the definition of L_r in previous section we have

$$L_r = \sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi), \\ \deg(h) | r}} \deg(h) \cdot \chi(h)^{r/\deg(h)} = \sum_{\substack{h \in \mathrm{Irr}(\Phi), \\ \deg(h) | r}} \deg(h) \cdot \lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right)$$

Now for any irreducible h let γ be a root of h in the splitting field of f. Let

$$h^{r/\deg(f)} = x^r - c_1 \cdot x^{r-1} + \cdots + (-1)^k c_r = \prod_{i=o}^{r-1} \left(X - \gamma^{q^i}\right)$$

Hence $c_1 = \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)$ and $c_r = \mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)$. Hence we have

$$\lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right) = \psi(c_r)\cdot\chi(c_1) = \psi\left(\mathrm{N}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)\right)\cdot\chi\left(\mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\gamma)\right) = \psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$$

Now we can express $\deg(h)\cdot\lambda\left(h^{r/\deg(h)}\right) = \sum_{\gamma\in E, h(\gamma)=0}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$. Therefore

$$L_r = \sum_{\substack{h\in\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\\ \deg(h)\mid k}} \deg(h)\cdot\lambda\left(h^{k/\deg(h)}\right) = \sum_{\substack{h\in\mathrm{Irr}(\Phi),\\ \deg(h)\mid k}}\sum_{\gamma\in E, h(\gamma)=0}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma)$$

Now all irreducible polynomials of $\mathbb{F}_q$ whose degree divides r with non-zero constant their roots in E are disjoint sets and partition E^*. Therefore we have

$$L_r = \sum_{\gamma\in E^*}\psi^{(r)}(\gamma)\cdot\chi^{(r)}(\gamma) = G(\psi^{(r)},\chi^{(r)})$$

Since by Theorem 3.5.7 we have $L_r = -w_1^r - w_2^r$. So we have the theorem. ■

Assuming w_1, w_2 as above, every lifted Kloosterman sum is a symmetric function of w_1, w_2, which by Waring's identities can be rewritten purely in terms of $K = K(\chi; a, b)$ and q. This gives the following closed-form reduction of $K(\chi^{(s)}; a, b)$ to the ground-field sum.

Lemma 3.7.3 Reduction of Lifted Kloosterman Sums

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $ab \neq 0$. Then for every positive integer s,

$$K\left(\chi^{(s)}; a, b\right) = \sum_{j=0}^{\lfloor s/2\rfloor}(-1)^{s-j-1}\cdot\frac{s}{s-j}\cdot\binom{s-j}{j}\cdot q^j\cdot K(\chi; a, b)^{s-2j}.$$

Proof: Consider the polynomial $X_1^r + X_2^r$. Now by Waring's Formula we can express this polynomial in terms of elementary symmetric polynomials $\mathrm{ESym}_1, \ldots, \mathrm{ESym}_r$ which gives

$$\begin{aligned}
X_1^r + X_2^r &= \sum_{\substack{d_1,d_2\in\mathbb{Z}_0\\ d_1+2d_2=r}}(-1)^{d_2}\,\frac{r(d_1+d_2-1)!}{d_1!d_2!}\,\mathrm{ESym}_1(X_1,X_2)^{d_1}\cdot\mathrm{ESym}_2(X_1,X_2)^{d_2}\\
&= \sum_{j=0}^{\lfloor r/2\rfloor}(-1)^j\,\frac{(r-j-1)!r}{j!(s-2j)!}\,\mathrm{ESym}_1(X_1,X_2)^{s-2j}\cdot\mathrm{ESym}_2(X_1,X_2)^j\\
&= \sum_{j=0}^{\lfloor r/2\rfloor}(-1)^j\binom{r-j}{j}\,\frac{r}{s-j}\,\mathrm{ESym}_1(X_1,X_2)^{s-2j}\cdot\mathrm{ESym}_2(X_1,X_2)^j
\end{aligned}$$

Now we take $X_1 = w_1$ and $X_2 = w_2$ obtained from Theorem 3.7.2 we get $w_1^k + w_2^k = -K(\chi^{(k)}; a, b)$ for any $k \in \mathbb{N}$ and $w_1\cdot w_2 = q$. So by this replacing in the equation we get the result. ■

This lemma gives a relation between powers of Kloosterman sum and lifted Kloosterman sums. We can obtain a recursive relation between different lifts of Kloosterman sums very easily using this identiy

$$w_1^r + w_2^r = (w_1^{r-1} + w_2^{r-1})(w_1 + w_2) - (w_1^{r-2} + w_2^{r-2})w_1w_2$$

which gives us

$$K(\chi^{(r)}; a, b) = -K(\chi^{(r-1)}; a, b)\cdot K(\chi; a, b) - q\cdot K(\chi^{(r-2)}; a, b)$$

and so we have the corollary.

Corollary 3.7.4 Kloosterman Sum Recurrence Relation

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $ab \neq 0$. Then for every positive integer s, the lifted Kloosterman sums satisfy the recurrence

$$K\left(\chi^{(s)}; a, b\right) = -K\left(\chi^{(s-1)}; a, b\right) \cdot K(\chi; a, b) - K\left(\chi^{(s-2)}; a, b\right) \cdot q \qquad \text{for all } s \geq 2,$$

with the convention $K(\chi^{(0)}; a, b) := -2$ (and noting $K\left(\chi^{(1)}; a, b\right) = K(\chi; a, b)$).

3.8 Character Sums via the Quadratic Character

For certain special characters, the associated Gaussian sums can be evaluated explicitly. A very special multiplicative character to study is the quadratic character, η. We get a very celebrated formula for the Gaussian sum of η and the canonical additive character.

Theorem 3.8.1 Gaussian Sum of the Quadratic Character

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field with $q = p^r$ where p is an odd prime and $r \in \mathbb{N}$. Let η be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let χ_1 be the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$G(\eta, \chi_1) = \begin{cases} (-1)^{r-1} \cdot q^{1/2} & \text{if } p \equiv 1 \bmod 4 \\ (-1)^{r-1} \cdot i^r \cdot q^{1/2} & \text{if } p \equiv 3 \bmod 4 \end{cases}$$

In other words,

$$G(\eta, \chi_1) = (-1)^{r-1} \cdot i^{\frac{(p-1)^2}{4} r} \cdot q^{1/2}$$

Proof: Since η always takes values in ± 1 we have $\eta = \overline{\eta}$. Hence by using Lemma 3.3.2(iv) we have $G(\eta, \chi_1)^2 = \eta(-1)q$. Now if $q \equiv 1 \bmod 4$ then $\eta(-1) = 1$ and if $q \equiv 3 \bmod 4$ then $\eta(-1) = -1$. Hence

$$G(\eta, \chi_1) = \begin{cases} \pm\, q^{1/2} & \text{if } q \equiv 1 \bmod 4 \\ \pm\, i \cdot q^{1/2} & \text{if } q \equiv 3 \bmod 4 \end{cases} \tag{3.11}$$

Since $i^{(p-1)^2/4} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } q \equiv 1 \bmod 4 \\ 0 & \text{if } q \equiv 3 \bmod 4 \end{cases}$

Observation 3.15. *For any finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$, $G(\eta, \chi_1) = \pm\, i^{(q-1)^2/4} \cdot q^{1/2}$*

It remains to resolve the $\pm$ sign. We first prove this for $r = 1$ then extend to $r > 1$.

Step 1: Setting up the linear operator T. Let W be the vector space of all complex valued functions on $\mathbb{F}_p^*$, a $(p-1)$-dimensional vector space over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\mathcal{B} := \{f_1, \ldots, f_{p-1}\}$ where $f_j(k) = 1$ if $j = k$ and otherwise 0 be the standard basis of W. By the orthogonality of multiplicative characters in Theorem 3.2.5 the set $\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{M}_q} := \{\psi_0, \ldots, \psi_{p-2}\}$ as defined in Lemma 3.2.3 also forms a basis of W.

Let $\zeta_p = e^{2\pi i/p}$ be the pth root of unity. Hence if $\chi_k \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_p$ is as defined in Theorem 3.2.1, then $\chi_k(j) = \zeta_p^{jk}$ for all $j \in \mathbb{F}_p$. Define the linear operator $T : W \to W$ by

$$\forall\, h \in W,\ \forall\, k \in [p-1] \qquad (Th)(k) = \sum_{j=1}^{p-1} \zeta_p^{jk} h(j). \tag{3.12}$$

For each basis element ψ_i,

$$(T\psi_i)(k) = \sum_{j=1}^{p-1} \chi_k(j) \cdot \psi_i(j) = G(\psi_i, \chi_k) = \overline{\psi_i}(k) \cdot G(\psi_i, \chi_1) \quad \forall\, k \in \mathbb{F}_p^*,$$

where the last equality uses Lemma 3.3.2(i). Hence $T\psi_i = G(\psi_i, \chi_1) \cdot \overline{\psi_i}$ for every multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_p$.

Step 2: Computing $\det(T)$ via the character basis. Since $\overline{\psi} = \psi$ only for ψ_0 and $\eta = \psi_{p-1/2}$, the matrix of T in $\mathcal{B}_{\mathcal{M}_q}$ has two diagonal entries $G(\psi_0, \chi_1) = -1$ and $G(\eta, \chi_1)$; all other characters pair up as conjugates $(\psi, \overline{\psi})$, each contributing the block $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & G(\overline{\psi}, \chi_1) \\ G(\psi, \chi_1) & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ with determinant contribution $-\psi(-1)p$ by Lemma 3.3.2(iv). Using $\psi_j(-1) = (-1)^j$ (since $\psi(-1) = -1$ for the principal character),

$$\begin{aligned} \det(T) &= -G(\eta, \chi_1) \cdot (-p)^{(p-3)/2} \prod_{j=1}^{\frac{p-3}{2}} (-1)^j \\ &= (-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_1) \cdot p^{(p-3)/2} \cdot (-1)^{(p-1)(p-3)/8} \\ &= \pm(-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot i^{(p-1)(p-2)/2} \cdot p^{(p-2)/2}, \end{aligned}$$

where in the last step we substitute Observation 3.15 and simplify the exponent. Thus:

$$\det(T) = \pm(-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot i^{(p-1)(p-2)/2} \cdot p^{(p-2)/2}. \tag{3.13}$$

Step 3: Computing $\det(T)$ via the standard basis. From (3.12), the (j,k) entry of T in $\mathcal{B}$ is ζ_p^{jk}. Factoring and reducing modulo p (since $p \mid 1 + 2 + \cdots + (p-1)$), the determinant equals that of the Vandermonde matrix $V(\zeta_p, \zeta_p^2, \ldots, \zeta_p^{p-1})$:

$$\det(T) = \prod_{1 \le j < k \le p-1} \left(\zeta_p^k - \zeta_p^j\right).$$

Setting $\zeta_{2p} = e^{\pi i/p}$ so that $\zeta_{2p}^2 = \zeta_p$ and using $\zeta_{2p}^t - \zeta_{2p}^{-t} = 2i \sin \frac{t\pi}{p}$, we expand the Vandermonde product:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(T) &= \prod_{1 \le j < k \le p-1} \zeta_{2p}^{j+k} \left(\zeta_{2p}^{k-j} - \zeta_{2p}^{-(k-j)}\right) \\ &= \zeta_{2p}^{\sum_{j<k}(j+k)} \cdot i^{(p-1)(p-2)/2} \prod_{1 \le j < k \le p-1} \left(2 \sin \frac{\pi(k-j)}{p}\right). \end{aligned}$$

Computing the exponent sum $\sum_{1 \le j < k \le p-1}(j+k) = \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{2}$ gives $\zeta_{2p}^{\sum(j+k)} = (-1)^{(p-1)/2}$, so:

$$\det(T) = (-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot i^{(p-1)(p-2)/2} \cdot \prod_{1 \le j < k \le p-1} \left(2 \sin \frac{\pi(k-j)}{p}\right). \tag{3.14}$$

Step 4: Resolving the sign for $r = 1$. Comparing (3.13) and (3.14), the first two factors coincide. Since $k - j \in [p-1]$ for all $1 \le j < k \le p-1$, we have $\sin \frac{\pi(k-j)}{p} > 0$, so $\prod_{j<k} 2 \sin \frac{\pi(k-j)}{p} > 0$. Therefore the product on the right of (3.14) equals $p^{(p-2)/2}$, and matching with (3.13) forces the $\pm$ to be $+$:

$$G(\eta, \chi_1) = i^{(p-1)^2/4} \cdot p^{1/2}.$$

Step 5: Extension to $r > 1$ via character lifting. For $r > 1$, lift η and χ_1 from $\mathbb{F}_p$ to $\mathbb{F}_q$ ($q = p^r$) via $\eta^{(r)} = \eta \circ N$ and $\chi_1^{(r)} = \chi_1 \circ \mathrm{Tr}$, where N and Tr are the absolute norm and trace from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_p$ respectively. By Davenport-Hasse Theorem,

$$G(\eta^{(r)}, \chi_1^{(r)}) = (-1)^{r-1} G(\eta, \chi_1)^r = (-1)^{r-1} \left(i^{(p-1)^2/4} \cdot p^{1/2}\right)^r = (-1)^r \cdot i^{\frac{(p-1)^2 r}{4}} \cdot q^{1/2}.$$

Since $\eta^{(r)}$ is the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, this is the stated formula. ■

The proof of the above theorem gives us another important result.

Lemma 3.8.2 Vandermonde Determinant with Roots of Unity

If p is a odd prime and ζ_p is the pth root of unity. Let $V(\zeta_p, \zeta_p^2, \ldots, \zeta_p^{p-1})$ is the $p \times p$ Vandermonde Matrix. Then

$$\det\left(V(\zeta_p, \zeta_p^2, \ldots, \zeta_p^{p-1})\right) = (-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot i^{(p-1)(p-2)/2} \cdot p^{(p-2)/2}$$

As a striking application of the machinery developed around the quadratic character, we can now give a proof of one of the classical result of number theory – *Law of Quadratic Reciprocity.*

Theorem 3.8.3 Law of Quadratic Reciprocity

For any two distinct odd primes p, q we have

$$\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) \cdot \left(\frac{q}{p}\right) = (-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4}$$

Proof: Let χ_1 be the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_p$ and η is the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_p$. Then by Lemma 3.3.2(iv) we gave $G^2(\eta, \chi_1) = (-1)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot p$. So

$$G^q(\eta, \chi_1) = G(\eta, \chi_1) \cdot \left(G^2(\eta, \chi_1)\right)^{(q-1)/2} = (-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_1) \tag{3.15}$$

Now we calculate $G^q(\eta, \chi_1)$ in different way.

$$\begin{aligned}
G^q(\eta, \chi_1) &= \left(\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p^*} \eta(\alpha) \cdot \chi_1(\alpha)\right)^q \\
&\equiv \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p^*} \eta^q(\alpha) \cdot \chi_q^q(\alpha) \bmod q \\
&\equiv \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p^*} \eta(\alpha) \cdot \chi_q(\alpha) \bmod q \\
&\equiv G(\eta, \chi_q) \bmod q \\
&\equiv \eta(q) G(\eta, \chi_1) \bmod q && \text{[By } \textit{Lemma 3.3.2(i)}\text{]}
\end{aligned} \tag{3.16}$$

Now we already obtained $\left(\frac{q}{p}\right)$ in the right hand side above and $(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4}$ in (3.15). Since η and χ_1 are both non-trivial characters of $\mathbb{F}_p$ we have $|G(\eta, \chi_1)|^{=} p^{1/2}$ by Theorem 3.3.1 and so $G(\eta, \chi_1) \neq 0$. So now comparing (3.16) with (3.15) we get

$$(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \cdot G(\eta, \chi_1) \equiv \eta(q) \cdot G(\eta, \chi_1) \bmod q \iff (-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \equiv \eta(q) \bmod q$$

By Fermat's Little Theorem we have $p^{q-1} \equiv 1 \bmod q$ as p and q are two distinct primes. So we have

$$\begin{aligned}
&(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \equiv \eta(q) \bmod q \\
\implies &(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \equiv \eta(q) \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \bmod q \\
\implies &(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \equiv \eta(q) \cdot p^{(q-1)/2} \bmod q \\
\implies &(-1)^{(p-1)(q-1)/4} \equiv \left(\frac{q}{p}\right) \cdot \left(\frac{p}{q}\right) \bmod q
\end{aligned}$$

Since both sides are ± 1 we can remove the modulo q. And therefore we have the theorem. ■

We close the section with an elementary but remarkably clean evaluation of the quadratic character summed against a quadratic polynomial. Its value depends only on the leading coefficient and the discriminant, and it will play a basic role in many later arguments – most notably in extracting the quadratic character of the discriminant when counting solutions of quadratic equations over $\mathbb{F}_q$, and in the reformulation of Kloosterman sums in section 3.7.

Theorem 3.8.4

Let $f(X) = a_2X^2 + a_1X + a_0 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ with q odd and $a_2 \neq 0$, let $\Delta = a_1^2 - 4a_0a_2$ denote the discriminant of f, and let η be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ (extended by $\eta(0) = 0$). Then

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\alpha)) = \begin{cases} -\eta(a_2) & \text{if } \Delta \neq 0, \\ (q-1) \cdot \eta(a_2) & \text{if } \Delta = 0. \end{cases}$$

We will not prove this theorem now. We will discuss this again in section 5.2.

3.9 Jacobsthal Sums

Building further on the theme of character sums twisted by the quadratic character, we now introduce a classical family of sums first studied by Ernst Jacobsthal in 1907 in connection with the representation of primes $p \equiv 1 \bmod 4$ as sums of two squares. Unlike Gaussian and Jacobi sums, which are defined purely multiplicatively, Jacobsthal sums mix an additive shift with the quadratic character η of $\mathbb{F}_q$, which makes them particularly well suited to problems involving quadratic residues and the arithmetic of $\mathbb{F}_q^*$.

Definition 3.9.1: Jacobsthal Sums

For $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ where q is odd and for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ the Jacobsthal Sum *is defined as*

$$H_n(\alpha) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\gamma^{n+1} + \alpha \cdot \gamma) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\gamma) \cdot \eta(\gamma^n + \alpha)$$

Another associated sum we define is

$$I_n(\alpha) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\gamma^n + \alpha)$$

for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$.

Now for $n = 1$ we get $H_1(\alpha) = 1$ by Theorem 5.2.7 and by Theorem 3.2.2(i), $I_1(\alpha) = 0$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$

The sums H_n and I_n are closely related: in the following theorem we give a recursion relation between I_n and H_m for any $n, m \in \mathbb{N}$.

Lemma 3.9.1 Relation between H_n and I_m

For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and every $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$,

$$I_{2n}(\alpha) = I_n(\alpha) + H_n(\alpha)$$

Proof: For any $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$ let $Z(\beta)$ is the number of $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\gamma^2 = \beta$. Hence $Z(\beta) = 1 + \eta(\beta)$. Hence we have

$$\begin{aligned} I_{2n}(\alpha) &= \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\gamma^{2n} + \alpha) \\ &= \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta^n + \alpha) \cdot Z(\beta) \\ &= \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta^n + \alpha)(1 + \eta(\beta)) \\ &= \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta^n + \alpha) + \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta) \cdot \eta(\beta^n + \alpha) \\ &= I_n(\alpha) + H_n(\alpha) \end{aligned}$$

Hence we have the theorem. ■

3.9.1 Relations between Jacobsthal and Jacobi Sum

Although H_n and I_n are defined using only the quadratic character, they can be evaluated in terms of Jacobi sums for multiplicative characters of higher order. The key observation is that the count of nth-power roots in $\mathbb{F}_q^*$ is a sum of multiplicative characters of order dividing $\gcd(n, q-1)$, and regrouping the definition of I_n accordingly expresses it as a linear combination of Jacobi sums $J(\lambda^j, \eta)$.

Theorem 3.9.2 Jacobi Sum Representation of I_n

Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, and set $d = \gcd(n, q-1)$. Let $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{M}_q$ be a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ of order d. Then

$$I_n(\alpha) = \eta(\alpha) \sum_{j=1}^{d-1} \lambda^j(-\alpha) \cdot J(\lambda^j, \eta).$$

Proof: For any $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$ let $Z(\beta)$ is the number of $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\gamma^n = \beta$. Then we have

$$I_n(\alpha) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\gamma^n + \alpha) = \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta + \alpha) \cdot Z(\beta)$$

Suppose $\beta \neq 0$. Then by Theorem 3.2.5(iii) we have

$$Z(\beta) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q} \psi(\gamma^n)\overline{\psi}(\beta) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{M}_q} \overline{\psi}(\beta) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi^n(\gamma)$$

Now by Theorem 3.2.5(i), ψ^n is trivial then $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi^n(\gamma) = q-1$ and otherwise its 0. Now ψ^n is trivial if and only if $\psi = \overline{\lambda}^j$ for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, d-1\}$. Then we have

$$Z(\beta) = \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \overline{\lambda}^j(\beta)$$

Suppose $\beta = 0$ then $Z(\beta) = 1$ as 0 is the only solution. Therefore this also holds for $\beta = 0$. Hence we have

$$\begin{aligned}
I_n(\alpha) &= \sum_{\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta+\alpha) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \lambda^j(\beta) \\
&= \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \sum_{\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\beta+\alpha)\lambda^j(\beta) \\
&= \eta(-1) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \sum_{\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q} \eta(-(\beta+\alpha))\lambda^j(\beta) \\
&= \eta(-1) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} J_{-\alpha}(\lambda^j, \eta) \\
&= \eta(-1) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} (\lambda^j \cdot \eta)(-\alpha) J(\lambda^j, \eta) \\
&= \eta(\alpha) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \lambda^j(-\alpha) J(\lambda^j, \eta)
\end{aligned}$$

Hence we have the theorem. ■

The Jacobsthal sum H_n satisfies a similar Jacobi-sum representation, but now involving a character λ of order $2d$ rather than d, and with the parity of the power of 2 dividing $q-1$ relative to n playing a decisive role: when all the 2-power content of $q-1$ already divides n, the sum H_n vanishes identically.

Lemma 3.9.3 Jacobi Sum Representation of H_n

Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, and set $d = \gcd(n, q-1)$. If the largest power of 2 dividing $q-1$ also divides n, then $H_n(\alpha) = 0$. Otherwise, let $\lambda \in \mathcal{M}_q$ be a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ of order $2d$; then

$$H_n(\alpha) = \eta(\alpha) \cdot \lambda(-1) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \lambda^{2j+1}(\alpha) \cdot J(\lambda^{2j+1}, \eta).$$

Proof: Since the largest power of 2 dividing $q-1$ also divides n we have $d = \gcd(n, q-1) = \gcd(2n, q-1)$. Therefore by Theorem 3.9.2, $I_n(\alpha) = I_{2n}(\alpha)$. Therefore by Lemma 3.9.1 we get $H_n(\alpha) = 0$.

Now suppose that is not the case. Then $\gcd(2n, q-1) = 2d$. Then by Theorem 3.9.2 we get

$$I_{2n}(\alpha) = \eta(\alpha) \sum_{j=1}^{2d-1} \lambda^j(-\alpha) J(\lambda^j, \eta) \tag{3.17}$$

Since $\operatorname{ord}(\lambda^2) = d$ using the same theorem for $I_n(\alpha)$ and λ^2 we get

$$I_n(\alpha) = \eta(\alpha) \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \lambda^{2j}(-\alpha) J(\lambda^{2j}, \eta) \tag{3.18}$$

Therefore from Lemma 3.9.1 we have $H_n(\alpha) = I_{2n}(\alpha) - I_n(\alpha)$. So subtracting (3.18) from (3.17) we get the expression. ■

Therefore by Theorem 3.4.6 we get for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, $|I_n(\alpha)| \le (d-1)q^{1/2}$.

3.9.2 Yet Another Proof of Fermat's Two Square Theorem

We close this section with the classical application of Jacobsthal sum. Using H_2 one can compute the two integers A, B in the representation $p = A^2 + B^2$ (guaranteed by Theorem 3.4.12) directly, and moreover with a canonical sign choice determined by a congruence modulo 4. Here $p \equiv 1 \bmod 4$ is prime, η is the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_p$, and $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_p$ is a multiplicative character of $\mathbb{F}_p$ of order 4, so that $\lambda^2 = \eta$ and $\lambda^3 = \overline{\lambda}$.

By Theorem 3.9.3 applied with $n = 2$ and hence $d = \gcd(2, p-1) = 2$,

$$H_2(1) = \lambda(-1) \sum_{j=0}^{1} \lambda^{2j+1}(1) \cdot J(\lambda^{2j+1}, \eta) = \lambda(-1) \left(J(\lambda, \eta) + J(\lambda^3, \eta) \right).$$

Since $\lambda^3 = \overline{\lambda}$ and η is real, $J(\lambda^3, \eta) = \overline{J(\lambda, \eta)}$, so $H_2(1) = 2\lambda(-1) \cdot \Re J(\lambda, \eta)$. In the notation of Theorem 3.4.12, $J(\lambda, \eta) = A + iB$ with $A, B \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $p = A^2 + B^2$, so

$$\Re J(\lambda, \eta) = A = \tfrac{1}{2}\lambda(-1) \cdot H_2(1).$$

A similar computation starting from an $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p$ with $\eta(\alpha) = -1$ uses $\lambda(\alpha) = \pm i$ and $\lambda^3(\alpha) = -\lambda(\alpha)$ to give

$$H_2(\alpha) = \eta(\alpha)\lambda(-1) \left(\lambda(\alpha) J(\lambda, \eta) - \lambda(\alpha) \overline{J(\lambda, \eta)} \right) = -\lambda(-1)\lambda(\alpha) \cdot 2i \cdot \Im J(\lambda, \eta),$$

which identifies $\Im J(\lambda, \eta) = B$ up to the unit factor $-\lambda(-1)\lambda(\alpha) \in \{\pm 1, \pm i\}$; absorbing this factor gives $B = \frac{1}{2} H_2(\alpha)$ (up to sign).

To pin down the sign of A, we expand $H_2(1)$ directly. Pairing γ with $-\gamma$ and using $\eta(-1) = 1$ (since $p \equiv 1 \bmod 4$) gives

$$H_2(1) = \sum_{\gamma=1}^{p-1} \eta(\gamma) \cdot \eta(\gamma^2 + 1) = 2 \sum_{\gamma=1}^{(p-1)/2} \eta(\gamma) \cdot \eta(\gamma^2 + 1),$$

so $\frac{1}{2} H_2(1) = \sum_{\gamma=1}^{(p-1)/2} \eta(\gamma)\eta(\gamma^2 + 1)$. On the other hand Theorem 5.2.7 applied to $f(X) = X^2 + 1$ (discriminant $-4 \neq 0$ and $\eta(1) = 1$) gives $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_p} \eta(\gamma^2 + 1) = -1$, so $\sum_{\gamma=1}^{(p-1)/2} \eta(\gamma^2 + 1) = -1$ (excluding the zero term). Subtracting and reducing modulo 4, using the fact that $(\eta(\gamma) - 1)(\eta(\gamma^2 + 1) - 1) \equiv 0 \bmod 4$ whenever $\eta(\gamma^2 + 1) \neq 0$, one obtains after a short computation

$$\tfrac{1}{2} H_2(1) + 1 \equiv \tfrac{3-p}{2} - \lambda(-1) \bmod 4.$$

Since $\lambda(-1) = 1$ when $p \equiv 1 \bmod 8$ and $\lambda(-1) = -1$ when $p \equiv 5 \bmod 8$, in both cases $\frac{1}{2} H_2(1) + 1 \equiv 0 \bmod 4$, i.e. $\frac{1}{2} H_2(1) \equiv -1 \bmod 4$.

Hence setting $A = \frac{1}{2}\lambda(-1) H_2(1)$ and $B = \frac{1}{2} H_2(\alpha)$ (for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_p$ with $\eta(\alpha) = -1$), we obtain integers with $A^2 + B^2 = p$, A odd, B even, and the normalization $A \equiv -1 \bmod 4$. With this normalization A is uniquely determined: if $p = A^2 + B^2 = C^2 + D^2$ with A, C odd and $A \equiv C \equiv -1 \bmod 4$, then choosing $h, k \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $A \equiv hB$, $C \equiv kD \bmod p$ gives $h^2 + 1 \equiv k^2 + 1 \equiv 0 \bmod p$, hence $C \equiv \pm hD \bmod p$; writing $C_1 \equiv hD \bmod p$ and $C = \pm C_1$, we compute

$$p^2 = (A^2 + B^2)(C_1^2 + D^2) = (AC_1 + BD)^2 + (AD - BC_1)^2,$$

and both $AC_1 + BD \equiv (h^2 + 1)BD \equiv 0 \bmod p$ and $AD - BC_1 \equiv 0 \bmod p$. Dividing by p^2 gives $1 = (\pm 1)^2 + 0^2$, forcing $AD - BC_1 = 0$ and $|AC_1 + BD| = p$. Since $\gcd(A, B) = \gcd(C_1, D) = 1$, it follows that $A = \pm C_1$ and hence $A = \pm C$; the congruence $A \equiv C \equiv -1 \bmod 4$ then forces $A = C$.

Thus the Jacobsthal sum $\frac{1}{2}\lambda(-1) H_2(1)$ produces the canonical integer A in Fermat's representation $p = A^2 + B^2$, and $\frac{1}{2} H_2(\alpha)$ produces B up to sign.

3.10 Salié Sums

The Kloosterman sums of the previous section are notoriously difficult to evaluate in closed form – even their size is controlled only by the deep theorem of Weil. Remarkably, a very mild modification of the Kloosterman sum, obtained by inserting the quadratic character η as a weight, produces a family of sums for which exact evaluations *are* possible. These are the *Salié sums*, introduced by Hans Salié in 1931.

Definition 3.10.1: Salié Sum

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field with q odd, and let $\chi, \tau \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be non-trivial additive characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then the Salié sum *associated to χ and τ is defined as*

$$S(\chi, \tau) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma) \cdot \chi(\gamma) \cdot \tau(\gamma^{-1})$$

Theorem 3.10.1 Evaluation of Salié Sums

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite elements with q being odd and $\chi, \tau \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $\tau(\gamma) = \chi(a \cdot \gamma)$. Then we have

$$S(\chi, \tau) = G(\eta, \chi) \sum_{b\colon b^2 = 4a} \chi(b)$$

Proof: Since $\tau(\gamma) = \chi(a \cdot \gamma)$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we have $\chi(\gamma) \cdot \tau(\gamma^{-1}) = \chi(\gamma) \cdot \chi(a \cdot \gamma^{-1}) = \chi(\gamma + a\gamma^{-1})$, so $S(\chi, \tau) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\chi(\gamma + a\gamma^{-1})$.

Step 1: Multiplicative Fourier expansion. For $b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ let $\chi_b \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ denote the additive character $\chi_b(\gamma) = \chi(b\gamma)$, similar to as given by Theorem 3.2.1. Define $\varphi : \mathbb{F}_q^* \to \mathbb{C}$ by

$$\varphi(b) = S(\chi_b, \tau) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\chi(b\gamma + a\gamma^{-1}).$$

By Theorem 3.2.5, the multiplicative characters form an orthonormal basis for functions on $\mathbb{F}_q^*$, so we may expand

$$\varphi(b) = \sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{M}_q} \hat{\varphi}(\lambda)\lambda(b), \quad \text{where} \quad \hat{\varphi}(\lambda) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \varphi(b)\overline{\lambda}(b).$$

Step 2: Computing the Fourier coefficients. Substituting the definition of φ and interchanging the order of summation:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\varphi}(\lambda) &= \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\lambda}(b) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\chi(b\gamma + a\gamma^{-1}) \\ &= \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\chi(a\gamma^{-1}) \sum_{b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\lambda}(b)\chi(b\gamma).\end{aligned}$$

Substituting $b \mapsto b\gamma^{-1}$ in the inner sum gives $\sum_{b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\lambda}(b)\chi(b\gamma) = \lambda(\gamma) \sum_{b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\lambda}(b)\chi(b) = \lambda(\gamma) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi)$. Hence

$$\hat{\varphi}(\lambda) = \frac{G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi)}{q-1} \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\lambda(\gamma)\chi(a\gamma^{-1}).$$

Substituting $\gamma \mapsto \gamma^{-1}$ in the remaining sum:

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \eta(\gamma)\lambda(\gamma)\chi(a\gamma^{-1}) = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\eta}(\gamma)\overline{\lambda}(\gamma)\chi(a\gamma) = G(\overline{\eta} \cdot \overline{\lambda}, \chi_a)$$

where $\chi_a(\gamma) = \chi(a\gamma)$. Since η is real-valued, $\overline{\eta} = \eta$. By Lemma 3.3.2(i), $G(\lambda, \chi_a) = \overline{\lambda}(a)G(\lambda, \chi)$, so

$$G(\overline{\eta} \cdot \overline{\lambda}, \chi_a) = \eta(a)\lambda(a) \cdot G(\overline{\eta} \cdot \overline{\lambda}, \chi).$$

Altogether:

$$\hat{\varphi}(\lambda) = \frac{\eta(a)\lambda(a) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi) \cdot G(\overline{\eta} \cdot \overline{\lambda}, \chi)}{q-1}. \tag{3.19}$$

Step 3: Applying the Hasse-Davenport product formula. By Corollary 3.4.11 applied with $m = 2$, the quadratic character η, and $\overline{\lambda}$ in place of ψ, we have

$$G(\overline{\lambda}, \chi) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}\eta, \chi) = \lambda(4) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}^2, \chi) \cdot G(\eta, \chi).$$

Since $\overline{\eta} \cdot \overline{\lambda} = \overline{\lambda}\eta$, substituting into (3.19):

$$\hat{\varphi}(\lambda) = \frac{\eta(a)G(\eta, \chi)}{q-1} \cdot \lambda(a) \cdot \lambda(4) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}^2, \chi) = \frac{\eta(a)G(\eta, \chi)}{q-1} \cdot \lambda(4a) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}^2, \chi).$$

Step 4: Final Step. Since $\lambda(1) = 1$ for every $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$:

$$\begin{aligned} S(\chi, \tau) = \varphi(1) = \sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \hat{\varphi}(\lambda) &= \frac{\eta(a)G(\eta, \chi)}{q-1} \sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \lambda(4a) \cdot G(\overline{\lambda}^2, \chi) \\ &= \frac{\eta(a)G(\eta, \chi)}{q-1} \sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \lambda(4a) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \overline{\lambda}^2(\gamma)\chi(\gamma) \\ &= \frac{\eta(a)G(\eta, \chi)}{q-1} \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \chi(\gamma) \sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \lambda(4a\gamma^{-2}) \end{aligned}$$

By the orthogonality of multiplicative characters (Theorem 3.2.5(ii)):

$$\sum_{\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \lambda(4a\gamma^{-2}) = \begin{cases} q-1 & \text{if } \gamma^2 = 4a, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Hence $S(\chi, \tau) = \eta(a) \cdot G(\eta, \chi) \sum_{b: b^2 = 4a} \chi(b)$. If $\eta(a) = -1$ then $4a$ is a non-square so $b^2 = 4a$ has no solution and the sum is 0; if $\eta(a) = 1$ the factor is 1. In both cases:

$$S(\chi, \tau) = G(\eta, \chi) \sum_{b:\, b^2 = 4a} \chi(b).$$

Therefore we have the theorem. ■

Lemma 3.10.2 Bound on Salié Sums

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite elements with q being odd and $\chi, \tau \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $\tau(\gamma) = \chi(a \cdot \gamma)$. Then $|S(\chi, \tau)| \leq 2 \cdot q^{1/2}$.

Proof: Since $a \neq 0$, the equation $b^2 = 4a$ has either 0 or 2 solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q$. From Theorem 3.10.1 if 0 solutions, $S(\chi, \tau) = 0$ and if $\pm b_0$ are the two solutions, $S(\chi, \tau) = G(\eta, \chi)\,(\chi(b_0) + \chi(-b_0))$. Each term $G(\eta, \chi)\chi(\pm b_0)$ is a product of the Gauss sum with a root of unity. By Theorem 3.3.1, $|G(\eta, \chi)| = q^{1/2}$, so $|S(\chi, \tau)| \leq 2q^{1/2}$. ■

Chapter 4

Stepanov and Bombieri's Method

Chapter 5

Equations over Finite Fields

In this chapter we consider polynomial equations of the form $f_1(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = f_2(X_1, \ldots, X_n)$ with $f_1, f_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$. We study the number of solutions of such equations in $\mathbb{F}_q$. This equation is equivalent to equations of the form $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ where $f = f_1 - f_2$. From now on we use the notation $\mathcal{V}(f)$ to denote the set of solutions of $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ and $Z(f)$ denotes the number of solutions. Hence $Z(f) = |\mathcal{V}(f)|$. Similarly we define $\overline{Z}(f)$ and $\overline{\mathcal{V}}(F)$ to denote set of non-trivial solutions and number of non-trivial solutions of $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ respectively. For a system of polynomial equations $f_1 = 0, \ldots, f_k = 0$ with $f_1, \ldots, f_k \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ we write $\mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = \mathcal{V}(f_1) \cap \cdots \cap \mathcal{V}(f_k)$ for the set of common solutions and $Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = |\mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)|$ for their count. And similarly we define $\overline{Z}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$ and $\overline{\mathcal{V}}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$. This notion is coming the notation used in the discussion of affine varieties in algebraic geometry.

In some cases we can give exact formula for the number of solutions and in general case we can give bounds on the number of solutions. To find bounds on numbers we use multiplicative or additive characters applied on polynomial evaluations to get. So we look into character sums of polynomials too. The problem of evaluating such character sums explicitly is very difficult. That's where we try to get bounds.

5.1 Some Elementary Results

In this section we give some elementary results on the number of solutions. We present some classical theorems such as those of König-Rados, Chevalley, and Warning. We also establish elementary upper bounds for the number of solutions and results on the expected order of magnitude.

5.1.1 Univariate Polynomials

We start of with univariate polynomials. Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ is an univariate polynomial Naturally the number of solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q$ for the equation $f(X) = 0$ is basically the degree of $\gcd(f(X), X^q - X)$. Since checking if 0 is a solution or not is very easy to check we'll only consider non-zero solutions. So the number of non-zero solutions of $f(X) = 0$ is basically the degree of $\gcd(f(X), X^{q-1} - 1)$. Therefore we may always assume without loss of generality that $\deg(f) \leq q - 1$. Suppose

$$f(X) = a_{q-1} \cdot X^{q-1} + a_{q-2} \cdot X^{q-2} + \cdots + a_1 \cdot X + a_0$$

where $a_i \in \mathbb{F}_q$ for all $0 \leq i \leq q - 1$. Since for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ we have $\alpha^{q-1} = 1$ the variable X^{q-1} will always evaluate to be 1 for all non-zero values of X. Therefore the number of solutions of f is same as of the equation $a_{q-2} \cdot X^{q-2} + \cdots + a_1 \cdot X + (a_0 + a_{q-1}) = 0$. Therefore we can always assume $\deg(f) \leq q - 2$. So suppose we have a polynomial $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ such that

$$f(X) = a_{q-2} \cdot X^{q-2} + \cdots + a_1 \cdot X + a_0$$

where $a_i \in \mathbb{F}_q$ for all $0 \leq i \leq q - 2$.

Now we can also analyze the number of solutions of f using matrix methods. From f we can define the following matrix

$$M_f = \begin{bmatrix} a_0 & a_1 & \cdots & a_{q-2} \\ a_1 & a_2 & \cdots & a_0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{q-2} & a_0 & \cdots & a_{q-3} \end{bmatrix}$$

This matrix is a *left circulant matrix* i.e. each row is obtained from the preceding row by a cyclic shift of the entries to the left. The number of non-zero solutions of $f(X) = 0$ and the rank of the matrix M_f are very related.

Theorem 5.1.1 König-Rados Theorem

Let $f(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{q-2} a_i \cdot X^i \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be an univariate polynomial. Then

$$\overline{Z}(f) = q - 1 - \operatorname{rank}(M_f)$$

Proof: Since $\deg(f) \leq q-2$ we have $\overline{Z}(f) \leq q-2$. $\overline{Z}(f) = q-1$ rises only when f is a zero polynomial i.e. M_f is a zero matrix and in that case $\operatorname{rank}(M_f) = 0$ which satisfies the theorem. Let γ be the primitive element of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then consider the *Vandermonde Matrix*, $V(\gamma, \gamma^2, \ldots, \gamma^{q-1})$:

$$V = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ \gamma & \gamma^2 & \cdots & \gamma^{q-1} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \gamma^{q-2} & \gamma^{2(q-2)} & \cdots & \gamma^{(q-1)(q-2)} \end{bmatrix}$$

Then using $\gamma^{i\cdot(q-1)} = 1$ for all $i \in [q-1]$ we obtain

$$M_f \cdot V = \begin{bmatrix} f(\gamma) & f(\gamma^2) & \cdots & f(\gamma^{q-1}) \\ \gamma^{-1} f(\gamma) & \gamma^{-2} f(\gamma^2) & \cdots & \gamma^{-(q-1)} f(\gamma^{q-1}) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \gamma^{-(q-2)} f(\gamma) & \gamma^{-2(q-2)} f(\gamma^2) & \cdots & \gamma^{-(q-1)(q-2)} f(\gamma^{q-1}) \end{bmatrix}$$

Now for any $i \in [q-1]$ we have $f(\gamma^i) = 0$ if and only if the ith row becomes zero. Therefore the $\operatorname{rank}(M_f \cdot V) = q - 1 - \overline{Z}(f)$. Since V is the Vandermonde matrix V and $M_f \cdot V$ have the same rank. So the theorem follows. ■

In the next subsections we will give simple upper and lower bounds for solutions multivariate polynomial equations or system of polynomial equations.

5.1.2 Chevalley–Warning Theorem

We begin with two elementary lemmas about power sums that will serve as the key tools.

Lemma 5.1.2

Let k be a non-negative integer. Suppose for $k = 0$, $0^0 = 1$. Then

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \alpha^k = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } k = 0 \text{ or } q-1 \nmid k \\ -1 & \text{if } q-1 \mid k \end{cases}$$

Proof: For $k = 0$ the sum becomes $q \equiv 0 \bmod q$. So suppose $k > 0$. Let γ is the primitive element of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then we have

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \alpha^k = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \alpha^k = \sum_{j=0}^{q-2} \gamma^{j \cdot k} = \sum_{j=0}^{q-2} (\gamma^k)^j$$

Now if $q - 1 \mid k$ then $\gamma^k = 1$ so the sum evaluates to be -1. If $q - 1 \nmid k$ then $\sum_{j=0}^{q-2} (\gamma^k)^j = \frac{\gamma^{k(q-1)}-1}{\gamma^k - 1} = 0$. Hence we have the lemma. ■

So using this lemma we can prove if we take the sum over all evaluations of a polynomial then the sum evaluates to be zero.

Lemma 5.1.3

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with $\deg(f) < n(q-1)$. Then

$$\sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k) = 0$$

Proof: It suffices to prove this property for every monomial of f. So suppose $X_1^{k_1} \cdots X_n^{k_n}$ be a monomial of f where $k_1 + \cdots + k_n < n(q-1)$ and $k_i \in \mathbb{Z}_0$ for all $i \in [n]$. Since $k_1 + \cdots + k_n < n(q-1)$ then by Pigeon Hole Principle there exists $j \in [n]$ such that $k_j < q - 1$. Then

$$\sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} \alpha_1^{k_1} \cdots \alpha_n^{k_n} = \prod_{i=1}^{n} \left(\sum_{\alpha_i \in \mathbb{F}_q} \alpha^{k_i} \right)$$

Then for j, by Lemma 5.1.2 $\sum_{\alpha_j \in \mathbb{F}_q} \alpha^{k_j} = 0$. So we have the lemma. ■

The two lemmas above are the principal tools behind the Chevalley–Warning theorem. It asserts that whenever the total degree of a system is small relative to the number of variables, the number of common zeros is divisible by p — forcing, in particular, that a system with one solution must have a second.

Theorem 5.1.4 Chevalley–Warning Theorem

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with $\deg(f) < n$. Then the number of solutions of the equation $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ is divisible by the characteristic p of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Moreover, if $f(0, \ldots, 0) = 0$ then there exists a nontrivial solution in $\mathcal{V}(f)$ i.e. $\overline{\mathcal{V}}(f) \neq \emptyset$ or $\overline{Z}(f) \geq 1$.

Proof: We first construct a polynomial and then will use Lemma 5.1.3. So take the polynomial $F(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 1 - f^{q-1}(X_1, \ldots, X_n)$. By construction F always takes vale 0 or 1. Therefore for any $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we have

$$F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 1 \iff f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$$

So

$$\sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k) = Z(f) \bmod p$$

Now by Lemma 5.1.3 we have

$$\sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_k) = 0$$

Therefore $p \mid Z(f)$. So we have the first part.

Now since $f(0,\dots,0)=0$ we have $Z(f)\geq 1$. Since p is a prime $p\geq 2$. So by first part $p\mid Z(f)$. Hence $Z(f)\geq 2$. So we have the second part too. ■

Now the bound of $\deg(f)<n$ in Chevalley–Warning Theorem is the best possible bound for the theorem to work. We can construct a polynomial in $\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$ of degree n for which the theorem doesn't hold. Let $\{\alpha_1,\dots,\alpha_n\}$ is the basis of $E=\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Consider the following polynomial

$$f(X_1,\dots,X_n)=\prod_{j=0}^{n-1}\left(\alpha_1^{q^i}X_1+\cdots+\alpha_n^{q^i}X_n\right)=\prod_{j=0}^{n-1}\sum_{j=1}^{n}\alpha_j^{q^i}X_i$$

Since for all $i\in\{0,1,\dots,n-1\}$, $\alpha_j^{q^i}$ are conjugates of α_j for all $j\in[n]$ with respect to $\mathbb{F}_q$, f is a polynomial over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Suppose for any $(\gamma_1,\dots,\gamma_n)\in\mathbb{F}_q^n$ consider the element $\alpha_1\cdot\gamma_1+\cdots+\alpha_n\cdot\gamma_n\in E$. Then we evaluate f on $(\gamma_1,\dots,\gamma_n)$ and we get

$$f(\gamma_1,\dots,\gamma_n)=\prod_{i=0}^{n-1}\sum_{j=1}^{n}\alpha_j^{q^i}\cdot\gamma_j=\prod_{i=0}^{n-1}\left(\sum_{j=1}^{n}\alpha_j\cdot\gamma_j\right)^{q^i}=N_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha_1\cdot\gamma_1+\cdots+\alpha_n\cdot\gamma_n)$$

Hence $f(\gamma_1,\dots,\gamma)=0$ if and only if $N_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\alpha_1\cdot\gamma_1+\cdots+\alpha_n\cdot\gamma_n)=0$ which holds only for $\alpha_1\cdot\gamma_1+\cdots+\alpha_n\cdot\gamma_n=0$. Since $\{\alpha_1,\dots,\alpha_n\}$ forms a basis of E over $\mathbb{F}_q$ we have $f(\gamma_1,\dots,\gamma)=0$ if and only if $\gamma_j=0$ for all $j\in[n]$. Hence $Z(f)=1$. The Chevalley–Warning Theorem clearly doesn't hold in this case.

Now we can extend the Chevalley–Warning Theorem to a system of polynomial equations $f_1=0,\dots,f_k=0$ with $f_1,\dots,f_k\in\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$. In this case we are interested in the number of common solutions.

Theorem 5.1.5 Chevalley–Warning Theorem for Systems of Equations

Let $f_1,\dots,f_k\in\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$ with $\deg(f_1\cdots f_k)=\deg(f_1)+\cdots+\deg(f_k)<n$. Then $p\mid Z(f_1,\dots,f_k)$ where $p=\mathrm{char}(\mathbb{F}_q)$.

Moreover, if $(0,\dots,0)\in\mathcal{V}(f_1,\dots,f_k)$ then $\overline{\mathcal{V}}(f_1,\dots,f_k)\neq\emptyset$ i.e. $\overline{Z}(f_1,\dots,f_k)\geq 1$.

Proof: Again we construct a polynomial. Consider the polynomial $F\in\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$ such that $F=(1-f_1^{q_1})\cdots(1-f_k^{q-1})$. Therefore for any $\alpha_1,\dots,\alpha_n\in\mathbb{F}_q$ we have $F(\alpha_1,\dots,\alpha_n)=1$ if and only if $f_i(\alpha_1,\dots,\alpha_n)=0$ for all $i\in[k]$. Now $\deg(F)\leq\deg(f_1)+\cdots+\deg(f_k)<n(q-1)$. Now by applying Chevalley–Warning Theorem for F we get the theorem. ■

5.1.3 Lower Bounds on the Number of Solutions

In the next theorem we will show if we have a system of polynomial equations $f_1=0,\dots,f_k=0$ with $f_1,\dots,f_k\in\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$ then for any affine subspace W all its parallel shifts have same number of solutions modulo the characteristic of $\mathbb{F}_q$. If W_1 and W_2 are two affine subspaces of $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ of same dimension then we call they are parallel affine subspaces if they are obtained by translation from the same linear subspace.

Lemma 5.1.6 Parallel Shift Invariance of Solution Counts

Let $f_1,\dots,f_k\in\mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\dots,X_n]$. If W_1 and W_2 are two parallel affine subspaces of $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ of dimension d where $d=\deg(f_1)+\cdots+\deg(f_k)$ then

$$|W_1\cap\mathcal{V}(f_1,\dots,f_k)|\equiv|W_2\cap\mathcal{V}(f_1,\dots,f_k)|\bmod p$$

where $p=\mathrm{char}(\mathbb{F}_q)$.

Proof: Now if $W_1 = W_2$, we get $|W_1 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| = |W_2 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)|$. So we get the theorem. So we can assume $W_1 \neq W_2$. Now by change of coordinates we can take

$$W_1 = \{(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{F}_q^n \colon \alpha_i = 0,\ \forall\, i \in [n]\}$$
$$W_2 = \{(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{F}_q^n \colon \alpha_1 = 1 \text{ and } \alpha_i = 0,\ \forall\, 2 \leq i \leq n\}$$

Again we construct a polynomial $G \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ where

$$G(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = (-1)^{n-d}(X_1^{q-2} + \cdots X_1 + 1)(X_2^{q-1} - 1) \cdots (X_n^{q-1} - 1)$$

So $\deg(G) = (n-d)(q-1) - 1$.

Observation 5.1. *With the above construction of G for any $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{F}_q^n$*

(i) if $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in W_1$ then $G(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = -1$

(ii) if $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in W_2$ then $G(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 1$

(iii) if $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \notin W_1 \cup W_2$ then $G(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$

Then we construct the following polynomial $F \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ such that

$$F = (1 - f_1^{q-1}) \cdots (1 - f_k^{q-1})G$$

So now we have $\deg(F) \leq d(q-1) + (n-d)(q-1) - 1 = n(q-1) - 1$. Therefore for any $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{F}_q^n$, if $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in W_1 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$ then $F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 1$. If $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in W_2 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$ then $F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = -1$ and 0 elsewhere. So

$$\sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = |W_1 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| - |W_2 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)|$$

Now by using Chevalley–Warning Theorem on F we have the lemma. ■

The Lemma 5.1.6 above can be used to obtain a lower bound on $Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$: the Chevalley–Warning Theorem guarantees that $p \mid Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k)$ whenever $d < n$, but by counting how many parallel affine hyperplanes each must contain a solution we can say much more.

Theorem 5.1.7 Lower Bound via Parallel Shifts

Let $f_1, \ldots, f_k \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with $d = \deg(f_1) + \cdots + \deg(f_k) < n$. If $Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) \geq 1$ then $Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) \geq q^{n-d}$

Proof: We will prove this by analyzing two cases.

Case I: Let there exists an affine subspace W_1 of $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ with dimension d such that $|W_1 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \not\equiv 0 \bmod p$. Then by Lemma 5.1.6 for all parallel affine spaces W_2 of W_1 we have $|W_2 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \not\equiv 0 \bmod p$. In particular $|W_2 \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \geq 1$. Since W_1 is of dimension d there are q^{n-d} distinct affine subspaces parallel to W_1. Therefore

$$\mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = \bigsqcup_{\substack{W\colon \text{affine subspace} \\ \text{parallel to } W_1}} \Big(W \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)\Big)$$

For each such W we have $|W \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \geq 1$. Therefore

$$Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = \sum_{\substack{W\colon \text{affine subspace} \\ \text{parallel to } W_1}} |W \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \geq q^{n-d}$$

Therefore we have the theorem in this case.

Case II: We have $|W \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \equiv 0 \bmod p$. for all affine subspaces W of $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ of dimension d. Since $Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) \geq 1$ there exists $k \in [d]$ such that for any affine subspace W' of dimension k, $|W' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \equiv 0 \bmod p$ but there is an affine subspace W'' of dimension $(k-1)$ such that $|W'' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \not\equiv 0 \bmod p$. Now consider all affine subspaces W' of dimension k containing W''. There are exactly $\frac{q^{n-(k-1)}-1}{q-1}$ many such affine subspaces. For each such affine subspace W' we have

$$|(W' \setminus W'') \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| = |W' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| - |W'' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \not\equiv 0 \bmod p$$

So $|(W' \setminus W'') \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \geq 1$. Therefore we have

$$\mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = \Big(W'' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)\Big) \sqcup \bigsqcup_{\substack{W' \text{: affine subspace} \\ \text{of dimension } k \\ \text{contains } W''}} \Big((W' \setminus W'') \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)\Big)$$

Hence we have

$$Z(f_1, \ldots, f_k) = |W'' \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| + \sum_{\substack{W' \text{: affine subspace} \\ \text{of dimension } k \\ \text{contains } W''}} |(W' \setminus W'') \cap \mathcal{V}(f_1, \ldots, f_k)| \geq 1 + \frac{q^{n-(k-1)}-1}{q-1} > q^{n-d}$$

So we have the theorem. ■

The lower bound on the number of solutions above is best possible even for $k = 1$ i.e. for any positive integers d and n with $d < n$ there is a polynomial $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ of degree d such that $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ has exactly q^{n-d} solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$. Consider the polynomial defined in the support Chevalley–Warning Theorem, $\prod_{i=0}^{n-1} \sum_{j=1}^{n} \alpha_j^{q^i} X_j$ where $\{\alpha_j : j \in [n]\}$ was a basis of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$. But in this example we take the same polynomial but on d variables but the solution space is over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$. Hence our polynomial in this case is $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = g(X_1, \ldots, X_d) = \prod_{i=0}^{n-1} \sum_{j=1}^{d} \alpha_j^{q^i} X_j$. Since f had only one solution, g has a solution at $(\gamma_1, \ldots, \gamma_n)$ if $\gamma_i = 0$ for all $i \in [d]$. Therefore g has exactly q^{n-d} solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$.

5.1.4 Upper Bounds on the Number of Solutions

We now give upper bounds on the number of solutions of a polynomial equation. The first is the celebrated Schwartz–Zippel lemma, which bounds the probability of a random point being a root in terms of total degree.

Lemma 5.1.8 Schwartz-Zippel Lemma

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with $\deg(f) = d$ be a non-zero polynomial. If $S \subseteq \mathbb{F}_q$ be any subset then

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in S}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0] \leq \frac{d}{|S|}$$

This lemma immediately gives an upper bound of $d \cdot q^{n-1}$ solutions for the equations $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$. Hence

Corollary 5.1.9 Total Degree Solution Bound

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with $\deg(f) = d$ be a non-zero polynomial. Then the equation $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ has at most $d \cdot q^{n-1}$ solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$.

We can give another probabilistic upper bound when we control the degree of f in each variable separately rather than just the total degree.

Theorem 5.1.10 Individual Degree Bound

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ be a non-zero polynomial with $\deg_{X_i}(f) \leq d$ for all $i \in [n]$. Then for $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$ chosen uniformly at random from $\mathbb{F}_q^n$,

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0] \leq 1 - \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)^n$$

Proof: We proceed by induction on n. For the base case $n = 1$, since $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1]$ is non-zero with $\deg_{X_1}(f) \leq d$, it has at most d roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$. Hence $\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{x_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(x_1) = 0] \leq d/q = 1 - (1 - d/q)^1$.

Assume the bound holds for $n - 1$ variables. Let $t = \deg_{X_n}(f)$. Then write f as a polynomial in X_n with coefficients in $\mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_{n-1}]$:

$$f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = \sum_{i=0}^{t} f_i(X_1, \ldots, X_{n-1}) \cdot X_n^k.$$

Since $\deg_{X_j}(f) \leq d$ for each $j \in [n-1]$, every f_i satisfies $\deg_{X_j}(f_i) \leq d$.

Let $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}$ be uniformly random points on $\mathbb{F}_q$ and α_n be uniform on $\mathbb{F}_q$, independently. Then by induction hypothesis

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) = 0] \leq 1 - \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)^{n-1}$$

Now we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0] &\leq \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) = 0] + \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}, \alpha_n) = 0 \wedge f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) \neq 0] \\
&\leq \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) = 0] + \\
&\qquad \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}, \alpha_n) = 0 \mid f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) \neq 0] \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) \neq 0]
\end{aligned}$$

Let $p := \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) = 0]$. For the second term after fixing $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}$ we have $\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}, \alpha_n) = 0 \mid f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) \neq 0] \leq \frac{d}{q}$. Now

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) \neq 0] = 1 - \mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f_t(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{n-1}) = 0]$$

Therefore together we get

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0] \leq p + (1 - p)\frac{d}{q} = \frac{d}{q} + \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)p$$

By induction hypothesis $p \leq 1 - \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)^{n-1}$. Therefore we have

$$\mathop{\mathbb{P}}_{\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q}[f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0] \leq \frac{d}{q} + \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)\left[1 - \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)^{n-1}\right] = 1 - \left(1 - \frac{d}{q}\right)^n$$

So we have the lemma. ■

We can give another upper bound based on individual degrees of each variables. If degree of each variable is at most d then there can be at most $d(q^{n-1} - 1)$ many non-trivial solutions. For this we consider f to be *homogeneous* i.e. total degree of each monomial is same.

Theorem 5.1.11 Nontrivial Solution Bound for Homogeneous Polynomials

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ be a homogeneous with $\deg(f) = d \geq 1$. Then the equation $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = 0$ has at most $d(q^{n-1} - 1)$ non-trivial solutions.

Proof: We use double induction on n and d. For the base case $n = 1$ then $f = aX_1^d$ for some $a \neq 0$, so the only root is $X_1 = 0$, giving $\overline{Z}(f) = 0 \leq d(q^0 - 1) = 0$. If $d = 1$ then $f = a_1X_1 + \cdots + a_nX_n$ is a non-zero linear form whose zero set is an $(n-1)$-dimensional hyperplane, so $\overline{Z}(f) = q^{n-1} - 1 = d(q^{n-1} - 1)$.

Suppose $n > 1$, $d > 1$, and the bound holds for non-constant homogeneous polynomials in at most n variables of degree less than d and for those in fewer than n variables of degree at most d. We consider two cases.

Case 1: $X_1 \mid f$. Write $f = X_1 \cdot g$ where $g \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ is homogeneous of degree $d - 1$. Every nontrivial solution $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \overline{Z}(f)$ with $\alpha_i \in \mathbb{F}_q$ for all $i \in [n]$, satisfies $\alpha_1 = 0$ or $g(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$. Solutions with $\alpha_1 = 0$: any $(0, \alpha_2, \ldots, \alpha_n) \neq 0$ works, giving $q^{n-1} - 1$ solutions. Solutions with $\alpha_1 \neq 0$: these are nontrivial zeros of g, and by the induction hypothesis on d there are at most $(d-1)(q^{n-1} - 1)$. Hence

$$\overline{Z}(f) \leq (q^{n-1} - 1) + (d-1)(q^{n-1} - 1) = d(q^{n-1} - 1).$$

Case 2: $X_1 \nmid f$. Write $f = \sum_{k=0}^{d} f_k(X_2, \ldots, X_n) \cdot X_1^k$ with f_k homogeneous of degree $d - k$. Since $X_1 \nmid f$ we have $f_0 \neq 0$, so for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $f(\alpha, X_2, \ldots, X_n)$ is a non-zero polynomial of degree d in $n-1$ variables we have by Schwartz–Zippel Lemma it has at most $d \cdot q^{n-2}$ zeros in $\mathbb{F}_q^{n-1}$. Now summing over $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ gives at most $(q-1) \cdot d \cdot q^{n-2}$ nontrivial solutions with $\alpha_1 \neq 0$. For solutions with $\alpha_1 = 0$: $f(0, X_2, \ldots, X_n) = f_0(X_2, \ldots, X_n)$ is a nonzero homogeneous polynomial in $n-1$ variables of degree d, so by the induction hypothesis on n it has at most $d(q^{n-2} - 1)$ nontrivial zeros. Altogether, $\overline{Z}(f) \leq (q-1)d \cdot q^{n-2} + d(q^{n-2} - 1) = d\left(q^{n-1} - q^{n-2} + q^{n-2} - 1\right) = d(q^{n-1} - 1)$. ■

5.2 Character Sums with Polynomials

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a non-constant polynomial. In this section we will look sums of the form

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(f(\alpha))$$

Such sums are called *Weil Sums.*

Definition 5.2.1: Weil Sum

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a non-constant polynomial. The Weil sum *associated to χ and f is*

$$W(\chi, f) := \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(f(\alpha)).$$

More generally, for a multiplicative character $\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ and a rational function $f \in \mathbb{F}_q(X)$, the Weil sum *is*

$$W(\psi, \chi, f) := \sum_{\substack{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha \text{ not a pole of } f}} \psi(\alpha)\, \chi(f(\alpha)).$$

Weil sums are extremely difficult to evaluate. One usually has to be satisfied with estimates for the absolute value of the sum. In certain cases it is easier to find the character sums exactly.

5.2.1 Additive Character Sums

The first family of Weil sums we evaluate exactly are those of the form $\chi(ac^n + b)$, where the polynomial is a shifted monomial. The key is to factor the sum over c using multiplicative characters of order $d = \gcd(n, q-1)$.

Theorem 5.2.1 Weil Sum of a Shifted Monomial

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and let $\lambda \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ be a multiplicative character of order $d = \gcd(n, q-1)$. Then for any $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $a \neq 0$,

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(a \cdot \gamma^n + b) = \chi(b) \sum_{j=1}^{d-1} \overline{\lambda}^j(a)\, G(\lambda^j, \chi).$$

Proof: Let $\tau \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ defined by $\tau(\gamma) = \chi(a \cdot \gamma)$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Then we get

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(a \cdot \gamma^n + b) = \chi(b) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(a \cdot \gamma^n) = \chi(b) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \tau(\gamma^n)$$

Now by Observation 3.9(ii) we get $\tau(\gamma^n) = \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} G(\overline{\psi}, \tau) \cdot \psi(\gamma^n)$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Therefore we get

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \tau(\gamma^n) &= \tau(0) + \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} G(\overline{\psi}, \tau) \cdot \psi(\gamma^n) \\ &= \tau(0) + \frac{1}{q-1} \sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} G(\overline{\psi}, \tau) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi^n(\gamma)\end{aligned}$$

Now if ψ^n is trivial then $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q^*} \psi^n(\gamma) = q-1$ and if ψ^n is non-trivial then $\sum_{\psi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q} \psi^n(\gamma) = 0$ by Theorem 3.2.5(i). Now ψ^n is trivial if and only if $\operatorname{ord}(\psi) \mid d$. Since $\operatorname{ord}(\overline{lm}) = d$, the characters ψ with order dividing d are exactly λ^j for all $0 \leq j \leq d-1$. Therefore

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \tau(\gamma^n) = 1 + \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} G(\lambda^j, \tau) = \sum_{j=1}^{d-1} G(\lambda^j, \tau) = \sum_{j=1}^{d-1} \overline{\lambda}^j(a) \cdot G(\lambda^j, \chi)$$

Hence we have the theorem. ∎

From Theorem 3.3.1 we have the absolute value of $G(\psi, \chi)$ to be $q^{1/2}$ if χ, ψ are non-trivial additive and multiplicative characters respectively. So we get the absolute value of the above character sum to be at most $(d-1)q^{1/2}$. Therefore as an immediate consequence we get the following bound on the absolute value of such sums.

Theorem 5.2.2 Bound on Weil Sum of a Shifted Monomial

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{X}}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and $d = \gcd(n, q-1)$. Then for any $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $a \neq 0$,

$$\left| \sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(ac^n + b) \right| \leq (d-1)\sqrt{q}.$$

So if $\gcd(n, q-1) = 1$ then the sum at right hand side is over no elements. So the sum evaluates to be zero. So we have the following corollary:

Corollary 5.2.3

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. If $\gcd(n, q-1) = 1$ then for any $a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $a \neq 0$,

$$\sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(ac^n + b) = 0.$$

For quadratic polynomials in odd characteristic the Weil sum can be evaluated exactly in terms of a Gaussian sum and the quadratic character.

Theorem 5.2.4 Weil Sum of a Quadratic Polynomial

Let $\chi \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$ be a non-trivial additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ with q odd, and let $f(X) = a_2X^2 + a_1X + a_0 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ with $a_2 \neq 0$. Then

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(f(\gamma)) = \chi\left(a_0 - a_1^2(4a_2)^{-1}\right)\, \eta(a_2)\, G(\eta, \chi),$$

where $\eta \in \boldsymbol{\mathcal{M}}_q$ is the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Proof: Since f is a quadratic polynomial we can express f as in the form of Theorem 5.2.1 for degree 2.

$$f(X) = a_2X^2 + a_1X + a_0 = a_2\left(X + a_1 \cdot (2a_2)^{-1}\right)^2 + \left(a_0 - a_1^2(4a_2)^{-1}\right)$$

Let $\overline{\gamma} = \gamma + a_1(2a_2)^{-1}$ and $\beta = a_0 - a_1^2(4a_2)^{-1}$. Then we have

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(f(\gamma)) = \sum_{\overline{\gamma} \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(a_2 \cdot \overline{\gamma}^2 + \beta)$$

So by Theorem 5.2.1

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi(f(\gamma)) = \chi(\beta) \cdot \eta(a_2) \cdot G(\eta, \chi)$$

Hence we have the result. ■

For polynomials whose monomials are all *affine p-polynomials* i.e. powers of $p = \mathrm{char}(\mathbb{F}_q)$, the sum collapses to either 0 or a full power of q depending on a linear condition on the parameter b.

Theorem 5.2.5 Weil Sum of an Affine p-Polynomial

Let $p = \mathrm{char}(\mathbb{F}_q)$ and let

$$f(X) = a_rX^{p^r} + a_{r-1}X^{p^{r-1}} + \cdots + a_1X^p + a_0X + a \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$$

be an affine p-polynomial over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let $\chi_b \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$, $b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, be a non-trivial additive character as defined in Theorem 3.2.1. Then

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_b(f(\gamma)) = \begin{cases} \chi_b(a) \cdot q & \text{if } ba_r + b^p a_{r-1} + \cdots + b^{p^{r-1}} a_1^{p^{r-1}} + b^{p^r} a_0^{p^r} = 0, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Proof: We can bring out the $\chi_b(a)$ factor from $\chi_b(f(\gamma))$ as a is the constant term. Consider the following polynomial $F(X) = b \cdot f(X)$. So we have

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_b(f(\gamma)) = \chi_b(a) \sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_1(F(\gamma))$$

where χ_1 is the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Let τ be the additive character defined as $\tau(\gamma) = \chi_1(F(\gamma))$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Then by Theorem 3.2.2(i) we have

$$\sum_{\gamma} \tau(\gamma) = \begin{cases} q & \text{if } \tau \text{ is trivial} \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

So now it suffices to characterize those affine p-polynomials $F(X)$ for which τ is trivial. Let $q = p^s$ and let Tr is the absolute trace function from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_p$. Then τ is trivial if and only if $\mathrm{Tr}(F(\gamma)) = 0$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$. Therefore we get

$$\tau \text{ is trivial} \iff \sum_{j=0}^{s-1} F^{p^j}(X) \equiv 0 \bmod \langle X^q - X \rangle$$

Now we have

$$\sum_{j=0}^{s-1} F^{p^j}(X) = \sum_{j=0}^{s-1} \left(\sum_{i=0}^{r} b \cdot a_i \cdot X^{p^i} \right)^{p^j} = \sum_{j=0}^{s-1} \sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^j} \cdot a_i^{p^j} \cdot X^{p^{i+j}} \equiv \sum_{k=0}^{s-1} \left(\sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^{k-i}} a_i^{p^{k-i}} \right) X^{p^k} \bmod \langle X^q - X \rangle$$

Therefore we get

$$\sum_{j=0}^{s-1} F^{p^j}(X) \equiv 0 \bmod \langle X^q - X \rangle \iff \sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^{k-i}} a_i^{p^{k-i}} = 0, \ \forall\, 0 \le k \le s-1$$

Now for all $j \in \{0, \ldots, s-1\}$ we have

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^{k-i}} a_i^{p^{k-i}} = 0 \iff \left(\sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^{k-i}} a_i^{p^{k-i}} \right)^{p^{r-k}} = 0 \iff \sum_{i=0}^{r} b^{p^{r-i}} a_i^{p^{r-i}} = 0$$

So we get the Theorem. ■

In the above theorem the case when q is even is also studies while in Theorem 5.2.4 its not been studied. Now for the above theorem if f is a quadratic polynomial we can extend Theorem 5.2.4 for q is even case and we get the following corollary:

Corollary 5.2.6 Weil Sum of Quadratic Polynomial in Even Characteristic

Let $f(X) = a_2X^2 + a_1X + a_0 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ with q even, and let $\chi_b \in \boldsymbol{\chi}_q$, $b \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, be as defined in Theorem 5.2.5. Then

$$\sum_{c \in \mathbb{F}_q} \chi_b(f(c)) = \begin{cases} \chi_b(a_0) \cdot q & \text{if } a_2 = ba_1^2, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

5.2.2 Quadratic Character Sums

When the character is the quadratic character η, the sums $\sum_c \eta(f(c))$ can be evaluated by completing the square (for quadratic f) or by the continued fraction algorithm (for polynomials with no roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$).

Theorem 5.2.7 Quadratic Character Sum of a Quadratic Polynomial

Let $f(X) = a_2X^2 + a_1X + a_0 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ with q odd and $a_2 \neq 0$, let $\Delta = a_1^2 - 4a_0a_2$ denote the discriminant of f, and let η be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ (extended by $\eta(0) = 0$). Then

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\gamma)) = \begin{cases} -\eta(a_2) & \text{if } \Delta \neq 0, \\ (q-1) \cdot \eta(a_2) & \text{if } \Delta = 0. \end{cases}$$

Proof: Since $4a_2^2 = (2a_2)^2$ we have $\eta(4a_2) = 1$. So we multiply the sum by $\eta(4a_2)^2$ and the sum stays the same. So we get for any $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$

$$\eta(f(\gamma))\eta(4a_2^2 \cdot f(\gamma)) = \eta(a_2) \cdot \eta(4a_2^2 \cdot \gamma^2 + 4a_1a_2 \cdot \gamma + 4a_2a_1) = \eta(a_2) \cdot \eta\left((2a_2 \cdot \gamma + a_1)^2 - \Delta\right)$$

This gives $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\gamma)) = \eta(a_2) \sum_{\overline{\gamma} \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(\overline{\gamma}^2 - \Delta)$ where for any $\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q$ define $\overline{\gamma} = 2a_2 \cdot \gamma + a_1$. Now if $\Delta = 0$ then $\eta(\overline{\gamma}^2) = 1$ and hence $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\gamma)) = -\eta(a_2)$.

So suppose $\Delta \neq 0$. Let for any $\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $Z(\beta)$ is the number of solutions of $\overline{\gamma} \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $\overline{\gamma}^2 = \beta^2 - \Delta$. Then $\sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} Z(\beta)$ is the total number of ordered pairs $(\overline{\gamma}, \beta) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$ such that $\overline{\gamma}^2 - \beta^2 = \Delta$. Now

$$\overline{\gamma}^2 - \beta^2 = \Delta \iff (\overline{\gamma} + \beta)(\overline{\gamma} - \beta) = \Delta$$

Since $\Delta \neq 0$, both $\overline{\gamma} + \beta$ and $\overline{\gamma} - \beta$ are nonzero. Take $u = \overline{\gamma} + \beta$ and $v = \overline{\gamma} - \beta$. Then there is a one-one correspondence for each $(\overline{\gamma}, \beta) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$ such that $\overline{\gamma}^2 - \beta^2 = \Delta$ and each $(u, v) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$ such that $u \cdot v = \Delta$. For any $u \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, we automatically get the value v hence number of such $(u, v) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$ such that $u \cdot v = \Delta$ is $q - 1$. Therefore $\sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{F}_q} Z(\beta) = q - 1$. So we have the result. ■

5.2.3 Weil Sums of Continued Fractions

There is a remarkable connection between Weil sums for the quadratic character η and the *continued fraction algorithm* for rational functions over $\mathbb{F}_q$. We collect the necessary algebraic facts about continued fractions of rational functions in Appendix B.1; here we set up the specific expansion needed for the application to character sums and state the main results.

For q odd, put $G(X) = X^q - X$, let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a polynomial of positive degree with no roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$, and set $F(X) = f(X)^{(q-1)/2}$. Consider the continued fraction expansions

$$\frac{F(X) - 1}{G(X)} = [A_0, A_1, \ldots, A_s] \qquad \text{and} \qquad \frac{F(X) + 1}{G(X)} = [a_0, a_1, \ldots, a_t]$$

with P_i, Q_i and p_i, q_i the corresponding numerator/denominator sequences from Appendix B.1. It is clear that $A_0 = a_0$. Define n_f to be the largest integer m such that $A_i = a_i$ for $i = 0, 1, \ldots, m$.

Lemma 5.2.8

For q odd, put $G(X) = X^q - X$, let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a polynomial of positive degree with no roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$, and set $F(X) = f(X)^{(q-1)/2}$. Let

$$\frac{F(X) - 1}{G(X)} = [A_0, A_1, \ldots, A_s] \qquad \textit{and} \qquad \frac{F(X) + 1}{G(X)} = [a_0, a_1, \ldots, a_t]$$

Then either $n_f = s = t - 1$ or $n_f = t = s - 1$.

Proof: Let P_i, Q_i are defined as above from $[A_0, \ldots, A_s]$ and p_i, q_i are defined from $[a_0, \ldots, a_t]$. Then using Corollary B.1.2 and Corollary B.1.5 we have

$$\frac{P_s}{Q_s} = \frac{F(X) - 1}{G(X)} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \frac{p_t}{q_t} = \frac{F(X) + 1}{G(X)}$$

So we get

$$Q_s(X) = \frac{\alpha_1 \cdot G(X)}{\gcd(F(X) - 1, G(X))}, \quad q_t(X) = \frac{\alpha_2 \cdot G(X)}{\gcd(F(X) + 1, G(X))} \quad \text{for some } \alpha_1, \alpha_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q^* \tag{5.1}$$

Since f has no roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$, for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $f^{q-1}(\alpha) = 1$. So $G(X) \mid f^{q-1}(X) - 1$ i.e. $G(X) \mid (F(X) - 1)(F(X) + 1)$. So

$$\gcd(G(X), F(X) - 1) \cdot \gcd(G(X), F(X) + 1) = G(X)$$

Therefore $Q_s(X) \cdot q_t(X) = \alpha \cdot G(X)$ with $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$. Let $n = n_f < s$ and $n < t$. Therefore by Lemma B.1.3 we get

$$\frac{F(X)-1}{G(X)} = \frac{P_{n+1} + \beta_{n+1} \cdot P_n}{Q_{n+1} + \beta_{n+1} \cdot Q_n}, \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{F(X)+1}{G(X)} = \frac{p_{n+1} + \gamma_{n+1} \cdot p_n}{q_{n+1} + \gamma_{n+1} \cdot q_n}$$

with $\beta_{n+1}, \gamma_{n+1}$ being rational functions with negative degree. Therefore

$$\frac{2}{G(X)} = \frac{F(X)+1}{G(X)} - \frac{F(X)-1}{G(X)} = \frac{H(X)}{(Q_{n+1} + \beta_{n+1} \cdot Q_n)(q_{n+1} + \gamma_{n+1} \cdot q_n)} \tag{5.2}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} H = \underbrace{p_{n+1} \cdot Q_{n+1} - P_{n+1} \cdot q_{n+1}}_{H_0} &+ \beta_{n+1}(\underbrace{p_{n+1} \cdot Q_n - P_n \cdot q_{n+1}}_{H_1}) + \gamma_{n+1}(\underbrace{p_n \cdot Q_{n+1} - P_{n+1} \cdot q_n}_{H_2}) \\ &+ \beta_{n+1} \cdot \gamma_{n+1}(\underbrace{p_n \cdot Q_n - P_n \cdot q_n}_{H_3}) \end{aligned} \tag{5.3}$$

Now by definition of n we have $P_i = p_i$ and $Q_i = q_i$ for all $-1 \le i \le n$. By Lemma B.1.4 we have $H_1 = (-1)^n$ and $H_2 = (-1)^{n+1}$ and $H_3 = 0$. So now we have to calculate H_0.

$$\begin{aligned} H_0 &= p_{n+1} \cdot Q_{n+1} - P_{n+1} \cdot q_{n+1} \\ &= (A_{n+1} \cdot p_n + p_{n-1})(A_{n+1} \cdot Q_n + Q_{n-1}) - (A_{n+1} \cdot P_n + P_{n-1})(a_{n+1} \cdot q_n + q_{n-1}) \\ &= a_{n+1}(p_n \cdot Q_{n-1} - P_n \cdot q_{n-1}) + A_{n+1}(p_{n-1} \cdot Q_n - q_{n-1} \cdot P_n) \\ &= (-1)^{n-1} a_n - (-1)^{n-1} A_{n+1} \\ &= (-1)^n (A_{n+1} - a_{n+1}) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $H = (-1)^n (A_{n+1} - a_{n+1} + \beta_{n+1} - \gamma_{n+1})$. Now by definition of n, $A_{n+1} \neq a_{n+1}$. So $\deg(H) \ge 0$. Therefore from the equation (5.2) we get $G(X) \cdot H(X) = 2(Q_{n+1} + \beta_{n+1} \cdot Q_n)(q_{n+1} + \gamma_{n+1} \cdot q_n)$. By the definition of G we have $\deg(G) + \deg(H) \ge q$. On the other hand, $\deg(G) + \deg(H) = \deg(Q_{n+1}) + \deg(q_{n+1}) \le \deg(Q_s) + \deg(q_t) \le q$. Therefore we have $\deg(H) = 0$. So $\deg(A_{n+1}) = \deg(a_{n+1})$. And hence $\deg(Q_{n+1}) = \deg(q_{n+1}) = q/2$. But we have q to be odd. Hence contradiction ↯ So we have either $n = s$ or $n = t$. Suppose $n = s$. Then $t > s$ and therefore we can write

$$\frac{F(X)+1}{G(X)} = \frac{p_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot p_s}{q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot q_s}$$

Therefore we get new equality for (5.2)

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{2}{G(X)} &= \frac{F(X)+1}{G(X)} - \frac{F(X)-1}{G(X)} \\ &= \frac{p_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot p_s}{q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot q_s} - \frac{P_s}{Q_s} \\ &= \frac{Q_s \cdot p_{s+1} - P_s \cdot q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1}(Q_s \cdot p_s - P_s \cdot q_s)}{Q_s(q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot q_s)} \\ &= \frac{(-1)^s}{Q_s(q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot q_s)} && \text{[By Lemma B.1.4]} \end{aligned}$$

So we have $(-1)^s \cdot G = 2 \cdot Q_s(q_{s+1} + \gamma_{s+1} \cdot q_s)$. Again we will compare the degrees. And since $\deg(G) = q$ we have $\deg(Q_s) + \deg_{q_{s+1}} = q$. On the other hand we have $\deg(Q_s) + \deg_{q_{s+1}} \le \deg(Q_s) + \deg(q_t) = q$. Therefore $\deg(q_{s+1}) = \deg(q_t)$. Since degrees of q_i increases strictly we have $t = s + 1$. Similarly, if $n = t$ then we get $t + 1 = s$. ■

So now we can derive the Weil sum of quadratic character for any polynomial f which has no rooots in $\mathbb{F}_q$ where q is odd.

Theorem 5.2.9 Weil Sum via Continued Fractions

Let $\eta \in \mathcal{M}_q$ be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, q odd, and let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ be a polynomial of positive degree with no roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\gamma)) = \begin{cases} \deg(a_s) & \text{if } n_f = s, \\ -\deg(A_s) & \text{if } n_f = t, \end{cases}$$

where A_s and a_s are obtained from the continued fraction expansions above.

Proof: We define the following two sets $Z_1 := |\{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q : \eta(f(\gamma)) = 1\}|$ and $Z_{-1} := |\{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q : \eta(f(\gamma)) = -1\}|$. Then basically we have $\sum_{\gamma \in \mathbb{F}_q} \eta(f(\gamma)) = Z_1 - Z_{-1}$. Since $\eta(f(\gamma)) = 1$ if and only if $F(\gamma) = f^{(q-1)/2}(\gamma) = 1$ we have $Z_1 = \deg(\gcd(F(X) - 1, X^q - X))$ and hence by (5.1) we have $Z_1 = q - \deg(Q_s)$.

Similarly $\eta(f(\gamma)) = -1$ if and only if $F(\gamma) = -1$. Hence $Z_{-1} = \deg(\gcd(F(X) + 1, X^q - X)) = q - \deg(q_t)$. So if $n_f = t = s - 1$ then $q_t = Q_{s-1}$. And therefore $q_t = Q_{s-1}$. So $Z_1 - Z_{-1} = -\deg(Q_s) + \deg(Q_{s-1}) = \deg(A_s)$. In case of $n_f = s = t - 1$ we get $Z_1 - Z_{-1} = \deg(q_t) - \deg(q_{t-1}) = \deg(a_t)$. So the result follows. ■

This result breaks down if f has roots in $\mathbb{F}_q$. Suppose $f(X) = x$. Then the character sum has the value 0 by Theorem 3.2.5(i). But $\frac{F(X)-1}{X^q - X} = [0, X^{(q+1)/2} + X]$ and $\frac{F(X)+1}{X^q - X} = [0, X^{(q+1)/2} - X]$. So $s = t = 1$ and $\deg(A_s) = \deg(a_t) = q{+}1/2$.

In the next section we turn to a statistical perspective and study the average number of solutions of polynomial equations over $\mathbb{F}_q$. We will show that the average value of $Z(f)$ over all polynomials f of bounded degree is exactly q^{n-1}, and then compute the variance of the solution count around this mean.

5.3 Average Number of Solutions

We now investigate the *average number of solutions* of a polynomial equations. Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$. Then define $\Omega_d := \mathbb{F}_q^{\leq d}[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ and $\omega(d)$ be the set of $n-$tuples $(i_1, \ldots, i_n) \in \mathbb{Z}_0$ such that $i_1 + \cdots + i_n \leq d$. Then

Observation 5.2. *With the definitions of Ω_d and $\omega(d)$ as above we have $|\Omega_d| = q^{|\omega(d)|}$.*

Lemma 5.3.1 Average of Solution Count

With the notations of Ω_d and $\omega(d)$ as defined above we have

$$\frac{1}{|\Omega_d|} \sum_{f \in \Omega_d} Z(f) = q^{n-1}$$

Proof: We have

$$\sum_{f \in \Omega_d} Z(f) = \sum_{f \in \Omega_d} \sum_{\substack{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0}} 1 = \sum_{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q} \sum_{\substack{f \in \Omega_d \\ f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0}} 1$$

Let for any $f \in \Omega_d$

$$f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = \sum_{(i_1, \ldots, i_n) \in \omega(d)} f_{i_1, \ldots, i_n} X_1^{i_1} \cdots X_n^{i_n} \quad f_{i_1, \ldots, i_n} \in \mathbb{F}_q, \ \forall\ (i_1, \ldots, i_n) \in \omega(d)$$

Then for a fixed $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we get to choose the coefficients $f_{i_1, \ldots, i_n}$ for all $(i_1, \ldots, i_n) \in \omega(d) \setminus \{(0, \ldots, 0)\}$ arbitrarily and then determining the constant term $f_{0, \ldots, o}$ to make $f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$. Thus the number of $f \in \omega_d$ with $f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$ is equal to $q^{|\omega(d)|-1}$. Therefore $\sum_{f \in \Omega_d} Z(f) = q^n \cdot q^{|\omega(d)|-1} = |\Omega_d| \cdot q^{n-1}$. So we have the lemma. ■

The proof of the above lemma gives us the following observation:

Observation 5.3. *For any $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n \in \mathbb{F}_q$, the number of polynomials $f \in \Omega_d$ such that $f(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) = 0$ is $q^{|\omega(d)|-1}$.*

The above lemma implies that a polynomial equation in n variables has on average q^{n-1} solutions in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$. So we now consider average deviation from the average number of solutions, q^{n-1}.

Theorem 5.3.2 Variance of Solution Count

With the notations of Ω_d and $\omega(d)$ as defined above we have

$$\frac{1}{|\Omega_d|}\sum_{f\in\Omega_d}\left(Z(f)-q^{n-1}\right)^2 = q^{n-1}-q^{n-2}$$

Proof: Let $\alpha = (\alpha_1,\ldots,\alpha_n), \beta = (\beta_1,\ldots,\beta_n) \in \mathbb{F}_q^n$ be any two points. Then we get

$$\sum_{f\in\Omega_d} Z(f)^2 = \sum_{f\in\Omega_d}\left(\sum_{\substack{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q^n\\ f(\alpha)=0}} 1\right)^2 = \sum_{f\in\Omega_d}\sum_{\substack{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q^n\\ f(\alpha)=0}}\sum_{\substack{\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q^n\\ f(\beta)=0}} 1 = \sum_{\alpha,\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q^n}\sum_{\substack{f\in\Omega_d\\ f(\alpha)=f(\beta)=0}} 1$$

Now if $\alpha = \beta$ then by Observation 5.3 we have $\sum_{f\in\Omega_d,\, f(\alpha)=0} 1 = q^{|\omega(d)|-1}$. Now suppose $\alpha \neq \beta$. This gives two linear equations for the coefficients of f. Therefore there are $q^{|\omega(d)|-2}$ polynomials $f \in \Omega_d$ such that $f(\alpha) = f(\beta) = 0$. Hence we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{f\in\Omega_d} Z(f)^2 = &= \sum_{\alpha\in\mathbb{F}_q^n}|\Omega_d|\cdot q^{-1} + \sum_{\alpha,\beta\in\mathbb{F}_q^n,\alpha\neq\beta}|\Omega_d|\cdot q^{-2} && \text{[By Observation 5.2]}\\ &= q^n\cdot|\Omega_d|\cdot q^{-1} + q^n(q^n-1)|\Omega_d|\cdot q^{-2}\\ &= |\Omega_d|\left(q^{n-1}+q^{2n-2}-q^{n-2}\right)\end{aligned}$$

So now we get

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{f\in\Omega_d}(Z(f)-q^{n-1})^2 &= \sum_{f\in\Omega_d} Z(f)^2 + 2\cdot q^{n-1}\sum_{f\in\Omega_d} Z(f) + q^{2n-2}\sum_{f\in\Omega_d} 1\\ &= |\Omega_d|\left(q^{2n-2}+q^{n-1}-q^{n-2}\right) - 2\cdot q^{n-1}\cdot|\Omega_d|\cdot q^{n-1} + q^{2n-2}\cdot|\Omega_d|\\ &= |\Omega_d|(q^{n-1}-q^{n-2})\end{aligned}$$

So we have the result. ■

From this result we can expect that $|Z(f)-q^{n-1}|$ is often $O\left(q^{(q-1)/2}\right)$. Later we will see instances of such expected behavior for various polynomial equations. In the next sections we will talk about character sums over polynomial evaluations.

5.4 Quadratic Forms

In this section we will study about quadratic forms and its equivalent forms which are easier to study than a general quadratic form. We will give bounds on the deviation of number of solutions from average number of solutions. Before all of that let's see what is a quadratic form.

Definition 5.4.1: Quadratic Forms

A quadratic form over $\mathbb{F}_q$ is a degree-2 homogeneous *polynomial or the zero polynomial.*

If $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1,\ldots,X_n]$ is a quadratic form. Now if q is odd then for any $i,j \in [n]$ we write $a_{i,j}X_iX_j = \frac{1}{2}a_{i,j}X_iX_j + \frac{1}{2}a_{ij}X_jX_i$ which leads to the representation

$$f(X_1,\ldots,X_n) = \sum_{i,j\in[n]} a_{i,j}X_iX_j \quad \text{for all } a_{i,j}\in\mathbb{F}_q \text{ with } a_{i,j} = a_{j,i}.$$

From this formulation we can represent f by a matrix denoted by C_f where $(i,j)^{th}$ entry of C_f is $a_{i,j}$. This matrix is called the *coefficient matrix*.

Observation 5.4. *Since $a_{i,j} = a_{j,i}$ we have $C_f^\top = C_f$.*

So if X denotes the column vector of all variables then $f = X^\top C_f X$. With this representation now we can talk about equivalence of two quadratic forms.

Definition 5.4.2: Equivalent Quadratic Forms

Let $f, g \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ be two quadratic forms over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then f and g are said to be equivalent *if f can be transformed into g by a non-singular linear transformation of the variables.*

So let $f, g \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ are two equivalent quadratic forms. Let X be the variable vector for f and $\tilde{X}$ be the variable vector for g. Then $f = X^\top C_f X$ and $g = \tilde{X}^\top C_g \tilde{X}$. Suppose M is the non-singular linear transformation of variables i.e. $\tilde{X} = MX$. For odd q we have

$$\tilde{X}^\top C_g \tilde{X} = g = (MX)^\top C_f (MX) = X^\top (M^\top C_f M) X,$$

so $C_g = M^\top C_f M$.

Observation 5.5. *If $f, g \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ (q odd) are two quadratic forms then f and g are equivalent if and only if there exists an invertible matrix $M \in \mathbb{F}_q^{n \times n}$ such that $C_g = M^\top C_f M$.*

We will use another terminology to make our life easier. If $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ is a quadratic form then for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ we will say f *represents* α if $f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = \alpha$ has a solution.

To calculate and understand the number of solutions of quadratic forms we define the integer-valued function $\vartheta : \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{Z}$ by $\vartheta(\alpha) = -1$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ and $\vartheta(0) = q - 1$. Then we have the following properties of ϑ function.

Lemma 5.4.1

For any finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$ we have

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q} \vartheta(\alpha) = 0,$$

and for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ and integers $1 \le k \le m$,

$$\sum_{\substack{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_m \in \mathbb{F}_q \\ \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_m = \alpha}} \vartheta(\alpha_1) \cdots \vartheta(\alpha_k) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } 1 \le k < m \\ \vartheta(\alpha) \cdot q^{m-1} & \text{if } k = m. \end{cases}$$

5.4.1 Odd Characteristic Quadratic Forms

Lemma 5.4.2 Reduction by Representation

Let q be odd and $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ be a quadratic form with $n \ge 2$. If f represents $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$ then f is equivalent to $\alpha \cdot X_1^2 + g(X_2, \ldots, X_n)$ where g is a quadratic form in $n-1$ variables.

Theorem 5.4.3 Diagonal Form of Quadratic Forms over $\mathbb{F}_q$

Every quadratic form over $\mathbb{F}_q$, q odd, is equivalent to a diagonal form.

Lemma 5.4.4 Solutions of a Two-Variable Diagonal Quadratic Form

For odd q, let $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$, $a_1, a_2 \in \mathbb{F}_q^*$, and let $\eta \in \mathcal{M}_q$ be the quadratic character of $\mathbb{F}_q$. Then

$$Z\left(a_1X_1^2 + a_2X_2^2 = \alpha\right) = q + \vartheta(\alpha)\eta(-a_1a_2).$$

Theorem 5.4.5 Solution Count for Non-degenerate Diagonal Quadratic Forms

Let f be a non-degenerate quadratic form in $\mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with n even and q odd. Then for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$,

(i) If n is even $Z\left(f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = \alpha\right) = q^{n-1} + \vartheta(\alpha) \cdot q^{(n-2)/2} \cdot \eta\left((-1)^{n/2} \cdot \det(f)\right)$.

(ii) if n is odd $Z\left(f(X_1, \ldots, X_n) = \alpha\right) = q^{n-1} + q^{(n-1)/2} \cdot \eta\left((-1)^{(n-1)/2} \cdot \det(f)\right)$.

5.4.2 Even Characteristic Quadratic Forms

Lemma 5.4.6 Reduction for Quadratic Forms in even characteristic

A non-degenerate quadratic form $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ with q even and $n \geq 3$ is equivalent to $X_1X_2 + g(X_3, \ldots, X_n)$ where g is a quadratic form in $n-2$ variables.

Theorem 5.4.7 Canonical Forms for even characteristic

Let $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \ldots, X_n]$ be a non-degenerate quadratic form with q even.

(i) If n is odd then f is equivalent to $X_1X_2 + X_3X_4 + \cdots + X_{n-2}X_{n-1} + X_n^2$.

(ii) If n is even then f is either equivalent to $X_1X_2 + \cdots + X_{n-1}X_n$, or to $X_1X_2 + \cdots + X_{n-3}X_{n-2} + X_{n-1}^2 + a \cdot X_n^2$ where $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$ satisfies $\mathrm{Tr}(a) = 1$.

Lemma 5.4.8 Solutions of a Two-Variable Quadratic Form in even characteristic

For even q, let $a, \alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $\mathrm{Tr}(a) = 1$. Then

$$Z\left(X_1^2 + X_1X_2 + aX_2^2 = \alpha\right) = q - \vartheta(\alpha).$$

Theorem 5.4.9 Solution Counts for Canonical Quadratic Forms in even characteristic

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field with q even. Then for any $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_q$:

(i) If n is odd,

$$Z\left(X_1X_2 + \cdots + X_{n-2}X_{n-1} + X_n^2 = \alpha\right) = q^{n-1} + \vartheta(\alpha) \cdot q^{(n-1)/2}.$$

(ii) If n is even then:

(a) $Z\left(X_1X_2 + \cdots + X_{n-1}X_n = \alpha\right) = q^{n-1} + \vartheta(\alpha) \cdot q^{(n-2)/2}$;

(b) for $a \in \mathbb{F}_q$ with $\mathrm{Tr}(a) = 1$, $Z\left(X_1X_2 + \cdots + X_{n-3}X_{n-2} + X_{n-1}^2 + a \cdot X_n^2 = \alpha\right) = q^{n-1} - \vartheta(\alpha) \cdot q^{(n-2)/2}$.

5.5 Diagonal Equations

5.6 Special L-functions

We write alternate proof of Davenport-Hasse Theroem from Schmidt 2.6,7,8,9,10

Chapter 6

Pseudopolynomials

Chapter 7

Decoding from Quadratic Character Evaluations

Chapter 8

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Chapter A

Appendix

A.1 Meromorphic and Analytic Continuation

The analytic continuation of the Riemann zeta function, and more generally of Dirichlet L-functions, requires the notion of a meromorphic function. We record the relevant definitions and a motivating example here.

Definition A.1.1: Zero, Pole, Order, Residue

Assume f has a convergent Laurent series expansion about z_0:

$$f(z) = a_n(z-z_0)^n + a_{n+1}(z-z_0)^{n+1} + \cdots = \sum_{m=n}^{\infty} a_m(z-z_0)^m,$$

with $a_n \neq 0$. If $n > 0$ we say f has a zero of order n *at z_0; if $n < 0$ we say f has a* pole of order $-n$ *at z_0. If $n = -1$ we say f has a* simple pole with residue a_{-1}. *We denote the order of f at z_0 by* $\operatorname{ord}_f(z_0) = n$.

Definition A.1.2: Meromorphic Function

We say f is meromorphic at z_0 *if there exists a disk about z_0 of radius r and an integer n_0 such that for all z with $|z-z_0| < r$,*

$$f(z) = \sum_{n \geq n_0} a_n(z-z_0)^n.$$

If f is meromorphic at each point in a region, we say f is meromorphic *on that region. If $n_0 \geq 0$, we say f is* ***analytic****.*

A canonical example illustrates the notion of continuation. Consider the geometric series $G(r) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} r^n$, which converges for $|r| < 1$ and equals $\frac{1}{1-r}$ there. Define $H(r) = \frac{1}{1-r}$; then H is well defined for all $r \neq 1$ and agrees with G wherever G converges. Since H is defined on a strictly larger domain and has a simple pole at $r = 1$ (with residue -1), we call H a **meromorphic continuation** of G. Had H no poles, we would call it an **analytic continuation**. A function that is analytic at every point of $\mathbb{C}$ — equivalently, one whose Taylor expansion converges everywhere, so that it has no poles anywhere — is said to be **entire**.

A.2 Fermat's Little Theorem

Fermat's Little Theorem is one of the oldest results in elementary number theory, recorded in a 1640 letter from Pierre de Fermat to Frénicle de Bessy. It underlies essentially every computation we perform in the multiplicative group $\mathbb{F}_p^*$

– from the very existence of the canonical additive character of $\mathbb{F}_q$ (where $q = p^r$), through the character congruence $\psi(l) \equiv l^f \pmod{P}$ used in the arithmetic proof of the Davenport–Hasse relation, down to the mod-q reduction of Gauss sums appearing in the proof of the Law of Quadratic Reciprocity. We record it here for completeness.

Theorem A.2.1 Fermat's Little Theorem

Let p be a prime. Then for every integer a we have

$$a^p \equiv a \pmod{p},$$

and in particular, if $p \nmid a$ then $a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.

Proof: The non-zero residues modulo p form a group $\mathbb{F}_p^* = \{1, 2, \ldots, p-1\}$ under multiplication of order $p-1$. By Lagrange's theorem every element of a finite group satisfies $g^{|G|} = e$, so $a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$ for every $a \in \mathbb{F}_p^*$, i.e. every a with $p \nmid a$. Multiplying both sides by a gives $a^p \equiv a \pmod{p}$ for such a; and the congruence $a^p \equiv a \pmod{p}$ is trivially true when $p \mid a$, so it holds for every integer a. ∎

Chapter B

Appendix

B.1 Continued Fractions over Finite Fields

Let $r_0, r_1 \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ with $r_1 \neq 0$. Applying the Euclidean algorithm yields a sequence

$$r_i = A_i r_{i+1} + r_{i+2}, \quad i = 0, 1, \ldots, s,$$

where $0 \leq \deg(r_{i+1}) < \deg(r_i)$ for $i = 1, \ldots, s$ and $r_{s+2} = 0$. Here $A_0, A_1, \ldots, A_s \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$, with $A_1, \ldots, A_s$ of positive degree. This gives the *continued fraction expansion*

$$\frac{r_0}{r_1} = A_0 + \cfrac{1}{A_1 + \cfrac{1}{A_2 + \cdots}} =: [A_0, A_1, A_2, \ldots, A_s].$$

Define polynomials $P_i, Q_i \in \mathbb{F}_q[X]$ for $i = -1, 0, 1, \ldots, s$ by the recurrences

$$\begin{aligned} P_{-1} &= 1, \quad P_0 = A_0, \quad P_i = A_i P_{i-1} + P_{i-2} \quad (i = 1, \ldots, s), \\ Q_{-1} &= 0, \quad Q_0 = 1, \quad Q_i = A_i Q_{i-1} + Q_{i-2} \quad (i = 1, \ldots, s). \end{aligned}$$

It is clear that $\deg(P_{i-1}) < \deg(P_i)$ and $\deg(Q_{i-1}) < \deg(Q_i)$ for $i = 1, \ldots, s$. We extend the definition of degree by $\deg(f/g) = \deg(f) - \deg(g)$ for a rational function f/g.

Lemma B.1.1 Rational Approximants via Convergents

For any rational function ρ of nonnegative degree,

$$[A_0, A_1, \ldots, A_{i-1}, \rho] = \frac{\rho P_{i-1} + P_{i-2}}{\rho Q_{i-1} + Q_{i-2}} \quad \textit{for } i = 1, \ldots, s+1.$$

Proof: We proceed by induction on i. For $i = 1$ both sides equal $A_0 + \rho^{-1} = \rho^{-1}(A_0\rho + 1) = (\rho P_0 + P_{-1})/(\rho Q_0 + Q_{-1})$. Suppose the identity holds for some i, $1 \leq i \leq s$. Since $A_i + \rho^{-1}$ has positive degree, applying the inductive hypothesis gives

$$[A_0, \ldots, A_i, \rho] = \frac{(A_i + \rho^{-1})P_{i-1} + P_{i-2}}{(A_i + \rho^{-1})Q_{i-1} + Q_{i-2}} = \frac{\rho P_i + P_{i-1}}{\rho Q_i + Q_{i-1}},$$

using the recurrence relations. ■ ■

Corollary B.1.2 Convergents Formula

For $i = 0, 1, \ldots, s$ we have $[A_0, A_1, \ldots, A_i] = P_i/Q_i$.

Lemma B.1.3 Representation of r_0/r_1 via Convergents

For $i = 0, 1, \ldots, s$ we have

$$\frac{r_0}{r_1} = \frac{P_i + \beta_i P_{i-1}}{Q_i + \beta_i Q_{i-1}},$$

where $\beta_i = r_{i+2}/r_{i+1}$ is a rational function of negative degree.

Proof: We proceed by induction. For $i = 0$, $(P_0 + \beta_0 P_{-1})/(Q_0 + \beta_0 Q_{-1}) = (A_0 + r_2/r_1)/(1) = (A_0 r_1 + r_2)/r_1 = r_0/r_1$. The inductive step follows from the recurrences and $\beta_i^{-1} = A_{i+1} + \beta_{i+1}$. ■ ■

Lemma B.1.4 Determinant Identity for Convergents

For $i = 0, 1, \ldots, s$ we have $P_i Q_{i-1} - P_{i-1} Q_i = (-1)^{i-1}$.

Proof: Induction. For $i = 0$: $P_0 Q_{-1} - P_{-1} Q_0 = 0 \cdot 0 - 1 \cdot 1 = -1 = (-1)^{-1}$. Assuming the identity at i,

$$P_{i+1} Q_i - P_i Q_{i+1} = (A_{i+1} P_i + P_{i-1}) Q_i - P_i (A_{i+1} Q_i + Q_{i-1}) = -(P_i Q_{i-1} - P_{i-1} Q_i) = (-1)^i. \blacksquare$$

■

Corollary B.1.5 Coprimality of Convergents

For $i = 0, 1, \ldots, s$ we have $\gcd(P_i, Q_i) = 1$.

Proof: If $d_i = \gcd(P_i, Q_i)$ then Lemma B.1.4 shows d_i divides $(-1)^{i-1}$, so $d_i = 1$. ■ ■

B.2 Waring's Formula

Waring's Formula expresses each power-sum symmetric polynomial $s_k = x_1^k + x_2^k + \cdots + x_n^k$ as an explicit polynomial in the elementary symmetric polynomials $\sigma_1, \ldots, \sigma_n$. It is the source of the closed-form reduction of lifted Kloosterman sums $K(\chi^{(s)}; a, b)$ to the ground-field sum $K(\chi; a, b)$ in Theorem 3.7.3: applying Waring's formula to $\omega_1^s + \omega_2^s$ with $\sigma_1 = \omega_1 + \omega_2 = -K(\chi; a, b)$ and $\sigma_2 = \omega_1 \omega_2 = q$ produces the binomial-coefficient expansion. We state the general identity here for reference.

Theorem B.2.1 Waring's Formula

Let $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ be indeterminates, let

$$\sigma_j = \sum_{1 \le i_1 < i_2 < \cdots < i_j \le n} x_{i_1} x_{i_2} \cdots x_{i_j} \qquad (j = 1, \ldots, n)$$

be the elementary symmetric polynomials in $x_1, \ldots, x_n$, and let

$$s_k = x_1^k + x_2^k + \cdots + x_n^k$$

be the kth power-sum. Then for every integer $k \geq 1$,

$$s_k = \sum (-1)^{i_2+i_4+i_6+\cdots} \cdot \frac{(i_1+i_2+\cdots+i_n-1)! \cdot k}{i_1! \cdot i_2! \cdots i_n!} \cdot \sigma_1^{i_1}\sigma_2^{i_2}\cdots\sigma_n^{i_n},$$

where the summation runs over all n-tuples $(i_1, \ldots, i_n)$ of non-negative integers satisfying $i_1 + 2i_2 + \cdots + ni_n = k$. Each coefficient of $\sigma_1^{i_1}\sigma_2^{i_2}\cdots\sigma_n^{i_n}$ is an integer.

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